FollowYou

User manual

Follow spots from the lights you already have

VERSION 3.1.0

Sceneproff
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01

Welcome to FollowYou

FollowYou turns the lights you already have into follow spots. You move a point on a stage plan, a joystick, a phone or a camera picture: every moving head on that spot aims at the performer with the right zoom, focus and intensity, and static lights like front PARs fade up wherever the performer goes.

What FollowYou does

A classic follow spot needs a person behind a big light at the back of the room. FollowYou does the same job with the rig you already have. You tell FollowYou where the performer is, and it lights them in two ways:

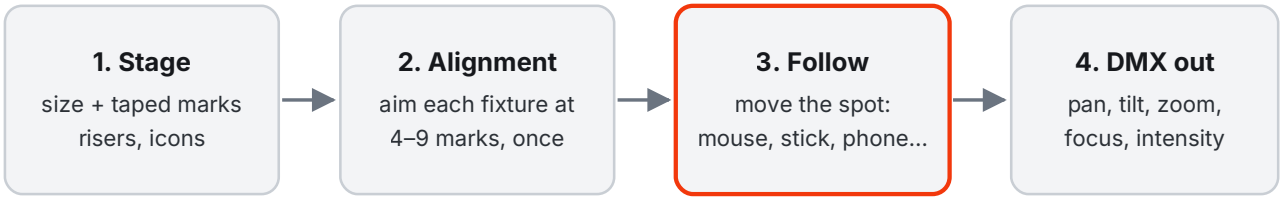
- **Moving heads aim at the performer.** FollowYou works out the pan and tilt for every moving head on that spot, from wherever each one hangs, plus zoom, focus and intensity.
- **Static lights fade up around them.** PARs, fresnels and LED washes become follow washes: each covers an area of the stage and comes up when a performer walks into it, handing over smoothly to the next. That's a working follow with no moving heads at all, or a soft base under the movers.

On top of that:

- **One performer, many fixtures.** A spot can drive one fixture or a whole wall of them. Front, side and back light all land on the same person, and a fixture whose view is blocked by a speaker stack or a set wall dims by itself.
- **Several performers.** Each performer gets their own spot, with their own colour, level and beam size.
- **Any way of driving it.** Mouse on the stage plan, a joystick, a MIDI controller, a phone or tablet, a second station, or a camera with **auto-track**.
- **Works with your desk.** FollowYou can sit between the lighting desk and the nodes. The desk keeps colour, gobos and everything else; FollowYou only takes the channels it follows with.
- **Built for show day.** Record moves in rehearsal and play them back from the desk or timecode, train operators in practice mode, run a backup station, and check everything with one Ready button.

How it works, in one minute

Everything in FollowYou happens on a **stage plan** in metres. Before the show you tape a few marks on the floor and aim each fixture at them once. From those marks FollowYou calculates where each fixture hangs and how it is turned: that is the **alignment**. After that, any point on the stage (at any height) can be turned into pan and tilt for every aligned fixture. Static follow washes don't need aligning: you simply draw the area each one lights on the plan.



Steps 1 and 2 are done once per venue and saved in the show file.

From taped marks to DMX: the stage and alignment are set up once per venue.

What you need

WHAT	DETAILS
A Windows PC	Windows 10 or 11, 64-bit. FollowYou is one program: no Python or other software to install.
A way to send DMX	An Art-Net or sACN node, or a USB DMX interface (ENTTEC DMX USB Pro or compatible, or an Open DMX / FTDI cable).
Fixtures	**Moving heads** (any with pan and tilt) for follow spots, and/or **any fixture with a dimmer** (PARs, fresnels, LED washes) as follow washes. A fixture profile describes each type's channels; 19 moving-head profiles come with FollowYou and you can make your own.
A licence	A FollowYou USB key or a licence file. Without one, FollowYou runs in DEMO mode (see Licence).
Optional	A MIDI controller, a joystick, a webcam or capture card for auto-track, phones or a second PC for more operators.

About this manual

This manual is for FollowYou **3.0**. It is also built into FollowYou: press F1 (or **Menu → User manual**) and it opens in your web browser at the chapter for the tab you are on, without needing internet. If you are new, read Quick start first: it takes you from an empty show to a working follow spot. The chapters after that go into each part of the program. The appendices have every key, a show-day checklist and troubleshooting.

Conventions used here:

- **Menu → Customise → Console look** means: press **Menu** (top left), pick **Customise**, then **Console look**. Or press Ctrl+K and type "look".
- Ctrl+L means: hold Ctrl and press L.
- **Bold** words are buttons, tabs or settings as they are named on screen.
- Positions are always given as seen from FOH (front of house), looking at the stage.

> **TIP**
> Words like *spot*, *active spot*, *main station* and *executor* have a specific meaning in FollowYou. The Glossary explains them all.

02

Installing, licence and updates

Install FollowYou once, unlock it with a USB key or a licence file, and it keeps itself up to date between shows.

Installing FollowYou

With the installer (recommended)

1. Download **FollowYou-Setup-x.y.z.exe** from the FollowYou download page (the QR code on your licence card goes there).
2. Run it. Windows may say *"Windows protected your PC"*: click **More info → Run anyway**.
3. Choose the folder (the default is `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\FollowYou`, which needs no administrator rights) and whether you want a desktop shortcut.
4. Start FollowYou from the Start menu or the desktop.

FollowYou is one program, `FollowYou.exe`. Nothing else needs installing and it does not need the internet to run.

Portable (zip)

Unzip the `FollowYou` folder somewhere permanent, for example `Documents\FollowYou`, and start **FollowYou.exe**. Handy for a show PC where you can't run installers.

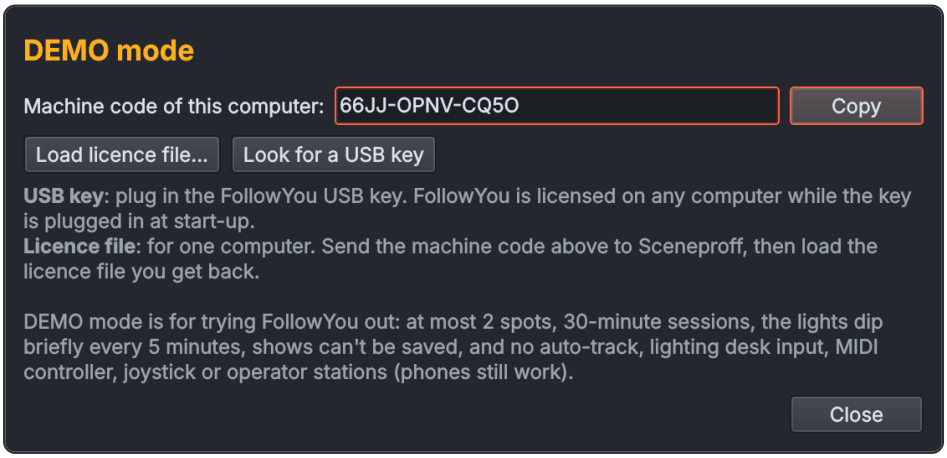
Installing a newer version, and uninstalling

- Run a newer installer over the old one, or let FollowYou offer the update itself (see Updates). Your fixture profiles are kept, including ones you edited; only new profiles are added. Settings, MIDI, joystick and your last show carry over.
- Installing over a version from before 2.4 (which ran on Python) cleans up the old files by itself.
- **Uninstalling** (Start menu, or Windows **Settings → Apps**) asks whether to delete your fixture profiles (the default is to keep them) and whether to remove FollowYou's firewall rules. Show files are never touched.

> **ERRORS**
> If something goes wrong, FollowYou shows a message and writes the details to `logs\FollowYou.log` in the FollowYou folder. Send that file to Sceneproff support with a description of what happened.

Licence

FollowYou is unlocked with either a **FollowYou USB key** or a **licence file**. Open **Menu → Licence** to see which one you have.



Menu → Licence. Without a licence it shows DEMO mode and this computer's machine code.

USB key

Plug the key in **before** you start FollowYou, and FollowYou is licensed on any computer. This is the best choice when the show PC changes from gig to gig.

- The key is tied to that one stick. Copying its files to another stick doesn't work.
- If the stick is pulled out during a show, nothing stops. FollowYou stays licensed until it is closed, and the status bar says *USB key removed*.
- Plugged it in after starting? Press **Look for a USB key** in the Licence window.

> **KEEP THE KEY SAFE**
> The USB key is the licence. Treat it like the key to a road case: label it, and keep it with the show PC or on your keyring.

Licence file

A licence file unlocks **one computer**.

1. Open **Menu → Licence**. It shows this computer's **machine code**. Press **Copy**.
2. Send the machine code to Sceneproff.
3. You get a licence file back (`.fylicence`, with a green key icon). **Double-click** it, or use **Load licence file...** in the Licence window.

A new Windows installation gives the computer a new machine code, so ask for a new file after reinstalling Windows.

Licence types

The Licence window shows the type: **Internal**, **Free trial**, **Rental** or **Purchased**. Free trial and rental licences usually have an end date. After that date FollowYou starts in DEMO mode.

Operator stations (a second PC that drives spots through the main station) don't need a licence of their own: they use the main station's.

DEMO mode

Without a licence FollowYou runs in DEMO mode, made for trying it out:

- Sessions last 30 minutes. Then FOLLOW turns off and the output goes dark; restart FollowYou to carry on. The status bar shows the minutes left.
- The lights dip briefly every 5 minutes.
- Shows can't be saved (shows made on a licensed station still open).
- At most 2 spots.
- No auto-track, lighting desk input, MIDI controller, joystick or operator stations. Phones still work.
- The title bar and the presentation screen say DEMO.

Plug in a USB key or load a licence file and everything opens up straight away, without a restart.

Updates

When the station is online, FollowYou checks for a new version a little after it starts, and then every few hours. If there is one, a **blue bar** appears under the top bar with **What's new / install...**, **Later** and **Skip this version**.

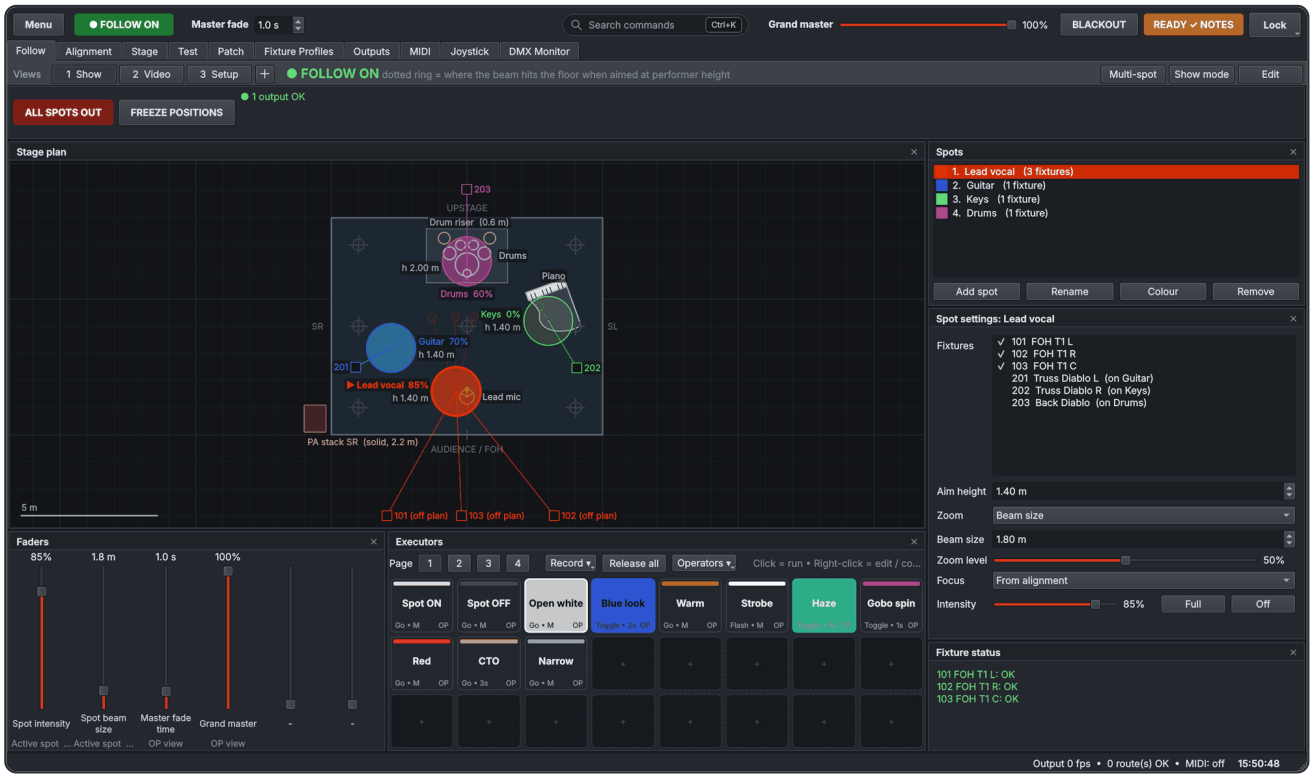
- The bar only shows while **FOLLOW is off** and the desk isn't locked, so it never pops up in the middle of a show. Offline stations never see it.
- **Install** downloads the new version and checks that it really comes from Sceneproff. Updates are signed, so a changed or fake file is refused. It then asks to save the show, closes FollowYou and starts the installer. Your profiles, shows and settings are kept.
- **Menu → Check for updates** checks straight away.
- Switch off **Menu → Check for updates by itself** to turn the check off on a station.

> **SHOW DAY**
> Don't update on show day. Update on a prep day, open your show and do a quick check before the next gig.

03

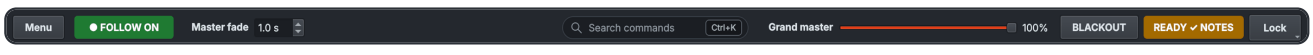
A tour of the window

The top bar is always there, whatever tab you are on. Everything else is in the Menu (top left) or one Ctrl + K away. Below it, the tabs take you from setting up the rig to running the show.



The main window on the Follow tab (the **Show** view), with four spots following.

The top bar

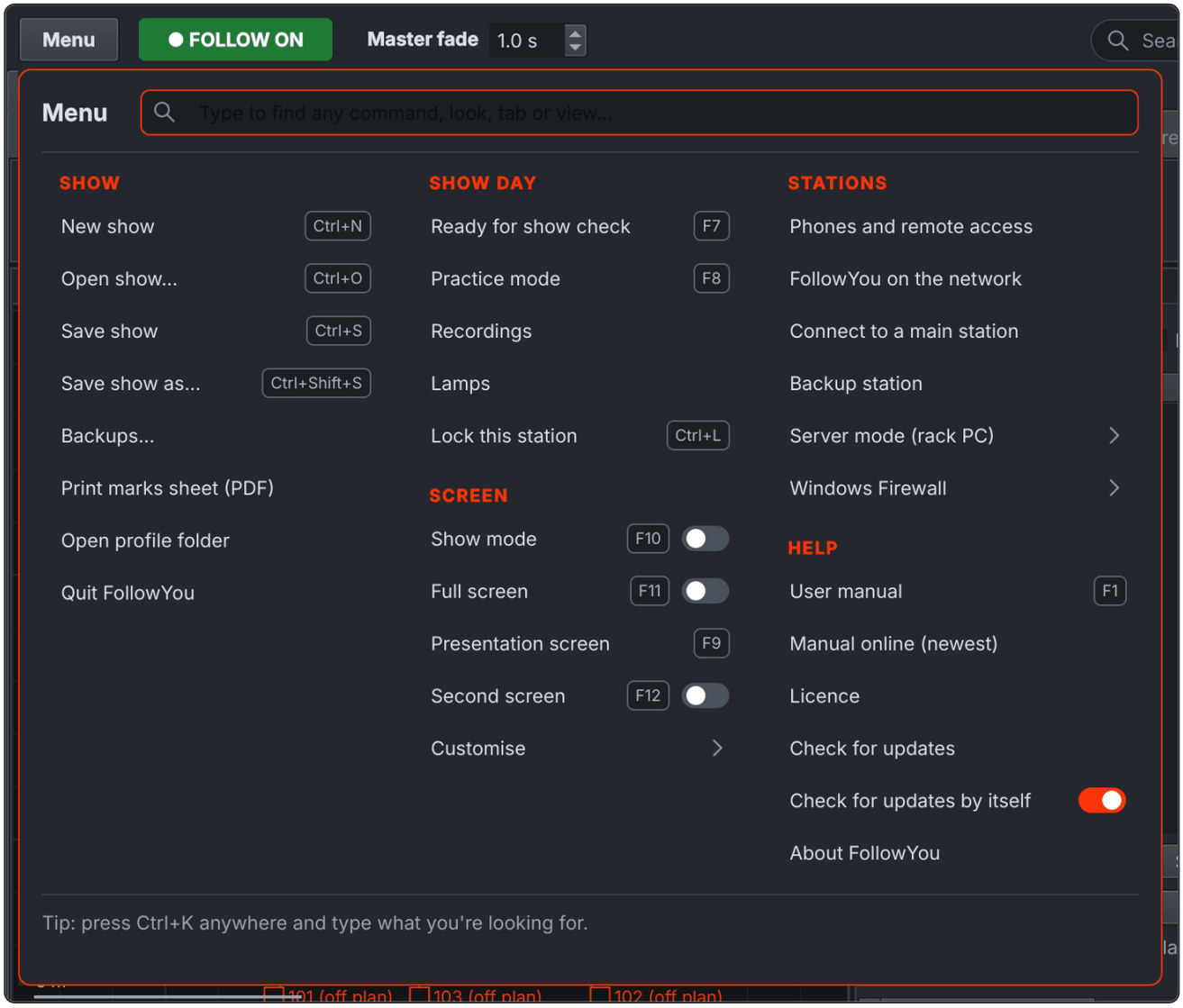


CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Menu	Everything that isn't on a tab: shows, show-day tools, stations, the screen, help. See The Menu.
FOLLOW ON / OFF	The main switch. While FOLLOW is on, every fixture on a spot is driven by FollowYou. FollowYou always starts with FOLLOW off.

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Master fade	The fade time used by spot on/off (Space), Full/Off, ALL SPOTS OUT and executors that use the master fade.
Search commands	Type to find any command, console look, tab or view (Ctrl+K from anywhere).
Grand master	Scales every intensity FollowYou sends.
BLACKOUT	All intensities FollowYou sends go to zero until you press it again.
READY	The Ready for show check: green when everything is set for the show (F7).
Lock	Locks the station so nothing changes by accident. The arrow next to it has **Lock all** and **Lock password...**. See Lock.

A **red bar** appears under the top bar if an output has a problem for more than a second (a USB interface unplugged, the network gone), whatever tab you are on. A **blue bar** means an update is available (only shown while FOLLOW is off).

The Menu



The Menu (top left). Hover a row to read what it does at the bottom.

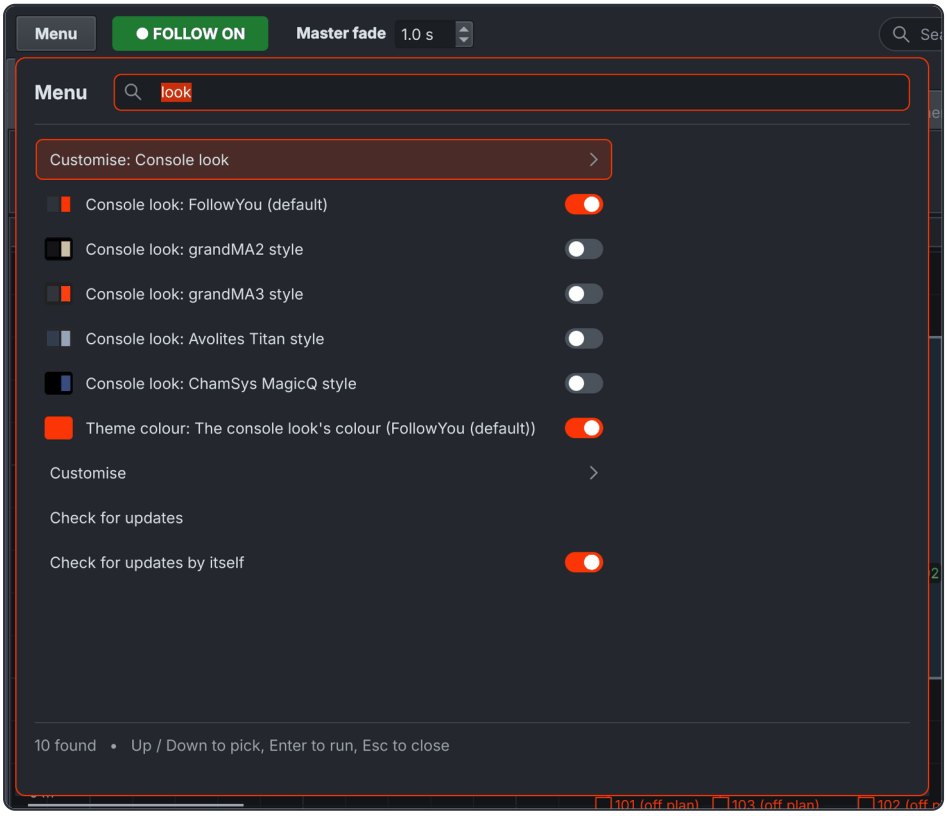
There are no File / View / Tools / Help menus. **Menu** opens one panel with everything in groups:

GROUP	ITEMS
Recent shows	The last five shows you opened or saved: click one to open it.
Show	New show (Ctrl+N), Open show... (Ctrl+O), Save show (Ctrl+S), Save show as... (Ctrl+Shift+S), Backups..., Print marks sheet (PDF), Open profile folder, Quit FollowYou.
Show day	Ready for show check (F7), Practice mode (F8), Recordings, Lamps, Lock this station (Ctrl+L).
Stations	Phones and remote access, FollowYou on the network, Connect to a main station, Backup station, Server mode (rack PC) ▸, Windows Firewall ▸.
Screen	Show mode (F10), Full screen (F11), Presentation screen (F9), Second screen (F12), Customise ▸ (console look, theme colour, icons, clock, Edit Follow view).

GROUP	ITEMS
Help	User manual (F1), Manual online (newest), Licence, Check for updates, Check for updates by itself, About FollowYou.

Rows with ▸ open a page of their own; the arrow at the top (or Backspace) goes back. Switches (Show mode, Full screen, the clock…) show whether they're on.

Search: Ctrl+K



Press Ctrl+K anywhere (or click **Search commands**) and type: “save”, “phone”, “ma2”, “patch”, “video”, “backup”. Everything is found: commands, console looks, theme colours, the tabs, the Follow views and the Follow panels. ↑ / ↓ pick, Enter runs, Esc closes.

The tabs

TAB	USED FOR	CHAPTER
Follow	Running the show: the stage plan, spots, executors, faders and safety.	Following
Alignment	Aiming each moving head at the marks; follow washes (static lights that follow); solid objects and off-stage.	Alignment, Follow washes
Stage	Stage size, marks, risers, icons and stage layouts.	The stage
Test	Driving any parameter of any fixture by hand.	Test tab
Patch	Adding fixtures and setting their addresses.	Patch

TAB	USED FOR	CHAPTER
Fixture Profiles	The profile library: channels, ranges and physical data.	Fixture profiles
Outputs	Art-Net, sACN and USB DMX outputs, and lighting desk input.	Outputs
MIDI	MIDI controller, global controls, controller lights.	MIDI controllers
Joystick	Joystick or gamepad, calibration and mapping.	Joystick
DMX Monitor	A live view of every channel FollowYou sends.	DMX Monitor

The status bar

The bottom line of the window shows the output rate (frames per second), how many outputs are OK, the MIDI state and the time of day (turn the clock on or off with **Menu → Customise → Clock in the status bar**). In DEMO mode it also shows the minutes left of the session; with a USB key that was pulled out it says *USB key removed*.

What the colours mean

Status colours are the same in every theme and console look, so they always mean the same thing:

- **Green**: OK, running, receiving.
- **Amber**: warning, needs attention, waiting.
- **Red**: error or danger.

Spot colours belong to the spots (change them with **Colour** in the Spots panel). The accent colour (selected rows, slider fills) comes from the theme.

04

Quick start: your first follow spot

From an empty show to a working follow spot. Allow about 15 minutes for the first fixture; each extra fixture takes a couple of minutes.

> **BEFORE YOU START**
> Rig and address the fixtures, connect the DMX node or USB interface, and have a roll of tape and a tape measure ready.

1. Patch the fixtures

1. Go to the **Patch** tab and press **Add fixtures...**.
2. Pick the **Profile** and **Mode** the fixture runs in, the **Quantity**, the **Universe** and **Start address**. **Next free** finds the first free address.
3. Press OK. The Status column turns green when the addresses don't overlap.

No profile for your fixture? See Making a profile.

2. Send DMX

1. Go to **Outputs** and press **Add output**.
2. Pick the **Type**: *Art-Net*, *sACN (E1.31)*, *USB DMX (Enttec Pro)* or *USB DMX (Enttec Open DMX)*.
3. Set the **Out universe** and the **Destination IP** (Art-Net/sACN) or the **USB port**.
4. Press **Apply**. The Status column and the Safety panel show green when the output runs.

Check it: in the **Test** tab, select a fixture and press **Highlight**. It should open up at full.

3. Set up the stage and tape the marks

1. Go to **Stage**. Enter the **Width (across)** and **Depth** in metres.
2. Pick **3 × 3 grid (9 marks, best accuracy)** and press **Generate marks**.
3. Tape a cross on the stage floor for every mark, measured from the centre line (X) and the downstage edge (Y). The table shows each mark's position.

> **ACCURACY STARTS HERE**
> The follow is only as good as the tape. Measure carefully, and put the cross in the middle of where you'd stand.

4. Align each fixture

1. Go to **Alignment → Moving heads**. Select the fixture and tick **Light up the fixture**.
2. Select a mark (in the list, or click it on the plan).
3. Drag the pad until the centre of the beam sits exactly on the tape. Hold **Shift** for 10× finer; arrow keys nudge.
4. Press **Store** (or **Enter**). It jumps to the next mark.
5. After 4 marks the fixture is solved, and FollowYou pre-aims at each next mark for you. Store all 9 if you can.

The **Result** box shows the accuracy: under 0.5° is good. Repeat for every fixture you want to follow with.

5. Make a spot and follow

1. Go to **Follow**. A new show has one spot, *Spot A*; press **Add spot** for more and **Rename** them after the performers.
2. In **Spot settings**, tick the fixtures that belong to this spot.
3. Turn **FOLLOW ON** in the top bar.
4. Press **Space** to bring the spot up over the master fade, then click and drag on the plan. The fixtures follow.

> **LIGHT LANDS BEHIND THE DOT?**
> That's correct on an empty stage. The spot aims at the performer's chest (Aim height 1.4 m), so on the floor the beam lands further upstage. Tick **Floor test** in Options to aim at the floor while you check the alignment, and untick it for the show.

6. Add follow washes (optional)

Static front lights can follow too. Patch them, then in **Alignment → Follow washes** tick them, press **Light this wash** and drag each area on the plan to where its light lands. With FOLLOW on they now fade up wherever the performers go. See Follow washes and solid objects.

7. Save the show

Press **Ctrl**+**S**. The show file (`.fyshow`) holds everything: patch, outputs, stage, alignment, spots, executors and a copy of every profile used. Next time at the same venue, open it and you're ready.

Where to go next

- Put presets on buttons: Executors and faders.

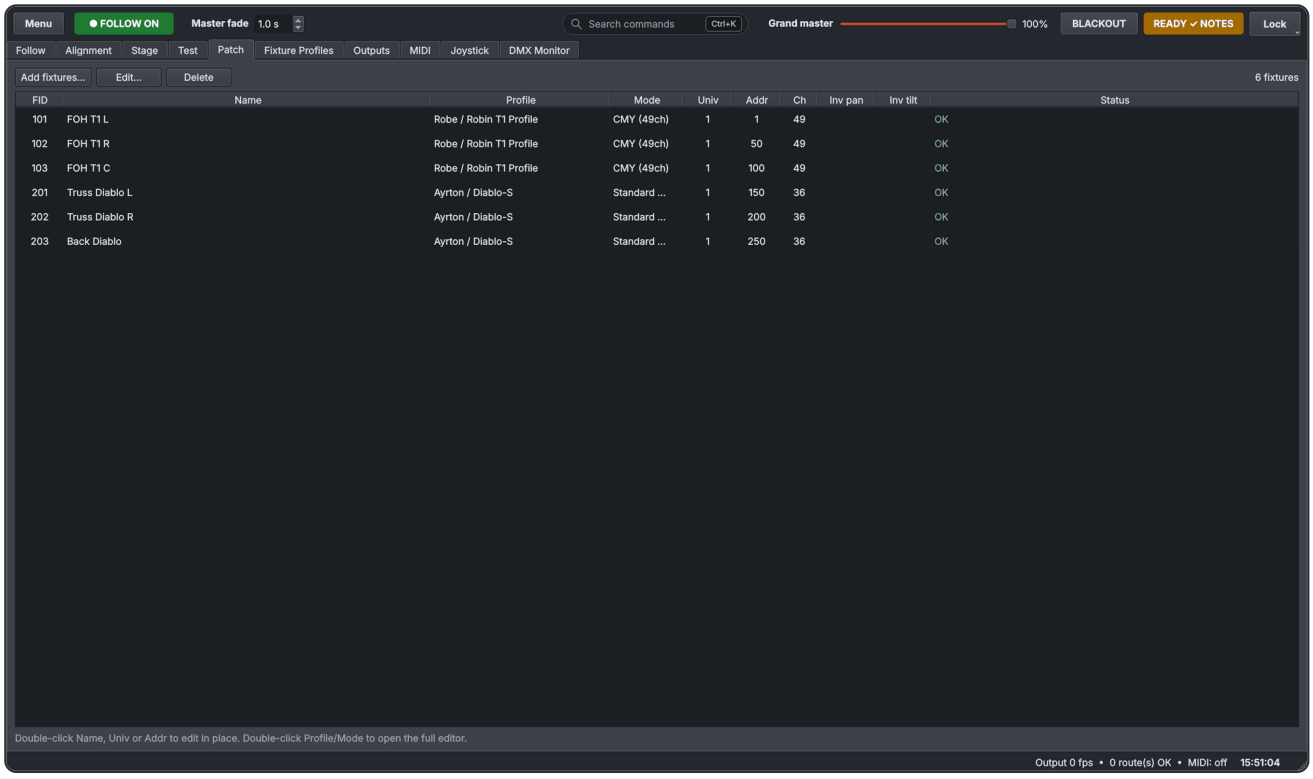
- Drive it with hardware: MIDI controllers and Joystick.
- Let a camera do the following: Video and auto-track.
- Hand spots to other operators: Phones, tablets and operator stations.

05

Patch and fixture profiles

The patch says which fixtures you have and where they are addressed. Profiles say what each fixture's channels do and how far it pans, tilts and zooms.

The Patch tab



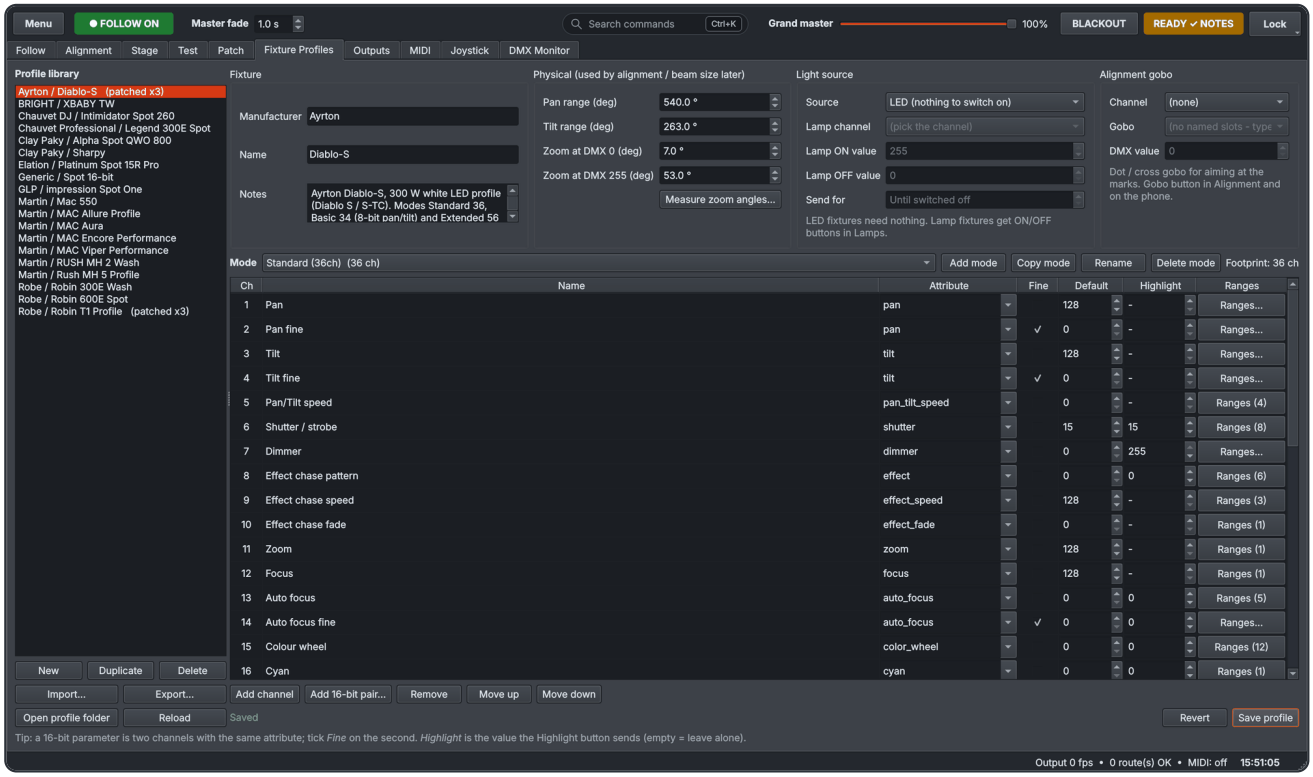
The Patch tab. Status turns green when a fixture's addresses are free.

Each row is one fixture: **FID** (fixture number), **Name**, **Profile**, **Mode**, **Univ**(erse), **Addr**(ess), **Ch**(annel count), **Inv pan**, **Inv tilt** and **Status**.

- **Add fixtures…** adds one or many at once: pick the profile and mode, the **Quantity**, the **First FID**, a **Name prefix** (“Spot” gives Spot 1, Spot 2…), the **Universe**, the **Start address** and the **Gap between fixtures**. **Next free** finds the first free address.
- **Edit…** changes one fixture. Double-click Name, Univ or Addr to edit in place; double-click Profile or Mode to open the full editor.
- **Delete** removes the selected fixtures.
- **Invert pan / Invert tilt**: for fixtures hung or set up the other way round. You rarely need these for following, because the alignment works out the direction by itself.

> **LIGHTING DESK INPUT**
> If FollowYou sits between your desk and the nodes, patch the fixtures at the **same universe and address** as on the desk.

Fixture profiles



The Fixture Profiles tab: library on the left, physical data and light source at the top, channels below.

A profile is a `.json` file in the profile library. FollowYou comes with these 19:

Ayrton Diablo-S · BRIGHT XBABY TW · Chauvet DJ Intimidator Spot 260 · Chauvet Legend 300E Spot · Clay Paky Alpha Spot QWO 800 · Clay Paky Sharpy · Elation Platinum Spot 15R Pro · Generic Spot 16-bit · GLP impression Spot One · Martin MAC 550 · Martin MAC Allure Profile · Martin MAC Aura · Martin MAC Encore Performance · Martin MAC Viper Performance · Martin RUSH MH 2 Wash · Martin RUSH MH 5 Profile · Robe Robin 300E Wash · Robe Robin 600E Spot · Robe Robin T1 Profile

> **CHECK BEFORE THE SHOW**
> The Robe, Clay Paky, GLP, Elation, Chauvet DJ, MAC Aura / Encore / Viper and RUSH MH 5 profiles come from the Open Fixture Library. Check them against your fixture's DMX chart (firmware versions differ), and measure the zoom angles where the profile notes say so.

Library buttons

- **New**, **Duplicate**, **Delete**: make, copy or remove a profile. Duplicate an existing profile that's close to your fixture: it's the quickest way to a new one.
- **Import...** / **Export...**: share profiles between PCs.
- **Open profile folder**: opens the folder with the `.json` files (also in **Menu → Open profile folder**). Copy profiles in and press **Reload**.
- **Save profile** stores your changes; **Revert** throws them away.

Making a profile

Open the fixture's user manual at the DMX protocol table and pick the mode you run the fixture in. Fill in the **Manufacturer**, **Name** and any **Notes**, then add one row per DMX channel, in order. **Add 16-bit pair…** adds a coarse and fine channel in one go.

COLUMN	WHAT TO PUT IN
Name	Anything readable, e.g. “Colour wheel”.
Attribute	What the channel does: `pan`, `tilt`, `dimmer`, `zoom`, `focus`, `shutter`, `color_wheel` … or type your own. FollowYou follows with pan, tilt, zoom, focus, dimmer and shutter, so those must be right.
Fine	Tick on the *second* channel of a 16-bit pair (e.g. “Pan fine”).
Default	The value sent when nothing controls the channel (pan/tilt usually 128 = centre). For the **shutter**, use its open value: the dimmer then does all the fading, and the light isn't cut by a closed shutter.
Highlight	The value the **Highlight** button sends (shutter open, dimmer 255, colour open). The Follow tab uses the shutter's Highlight value as “open”. Leave it at - (empty) to ignore.
Ranges	Named slots, e.g. colour wheel *Red 10–19*. They become quick-pick presets in the Test tab and in executors.

A profile can have several **modes** (Add mode, Copy mode, Rename, Delete mode), one per DMX mode of the fixture.

Physical

- **Pan range** and **Tilt range** (degrees), e.g. 540° / 265°. Used by the alignment. Small errors are corrected automatically.
- **Zoom at DMX 0** and **Zoom at DMX 255** (degrees). Used by *Beam size*. For the Ayrton Diablo-S the spec sheet gives 7°–53°, narrow at DMX 0. Some fixtures are the other way round: the Legend 300E Spot is 20° at DMX 0 and 4° at 255.

Measure zoom angles…

If the manual doesn't give the zoom angles, measure them. Point the fixture at a wall or the floor, enter the **Distance lens to wall/floor**, then measure the **Beam width at Zoom DMX 0** and **at Zoom DMX 255**. FollowYou works the angles out.

Light source

Leave LED fixtures on **LED**. For lamp fixtures, pick **Lamp / bulb**, the **Lamp channel** (often called Control, Lamp or Reset), the **Lamp ON value** and **Lamp OFF value**, and **Send for**: *Until switched off*, or a number of seconds if the manual says e.g. “hold 5 s”. See Lamps.

Alignment gobo

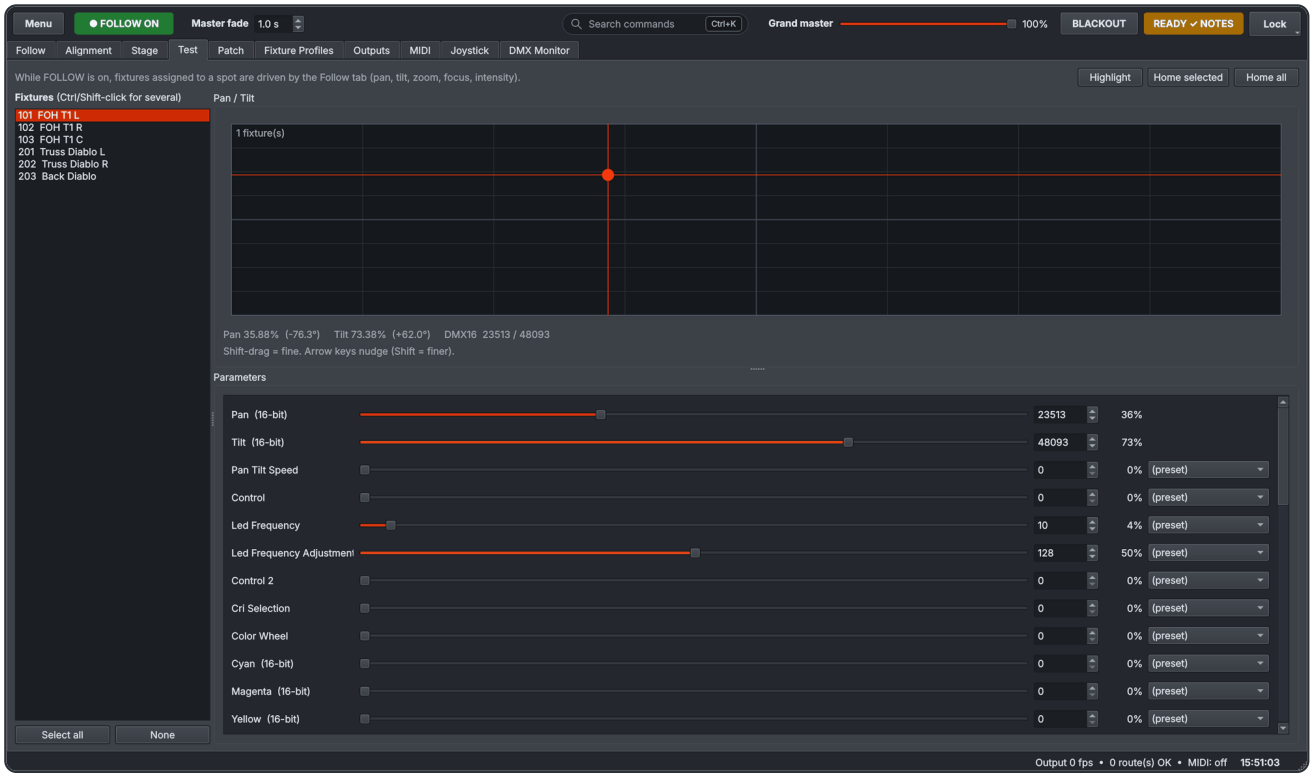
Optional, and very helpful. Pick the gobo wheel **Channel**, then the **Gobo** from the channel's named slots, or type its **DMX value**. Choose a small dot or cross. The Alignment tab and the phone then get a Gobo toggle for that fixture: a small dot is much easier to centre on the tape than a full beam.

Profiles and show files

Each PC has its own profile library, and every show file keeps a copy of the profiles it uses. If a show was saved with a different version of a profile than the one on this PC (for example you measured the zoom angles on one PC and not the other), FollowYou lists the differences when the show opens and asks which to use.

- **Use the show's versions** updates this PC's library and keeps the old file in `profiles\backup`.
- If you keep this PC's versions, the show behaves the way those profiles say (e.g. no beam size without zoom angles).

The Test tab



The Test tab: select fixtures on the left, drive pan/tilt on the pad and every parameter with a slider.

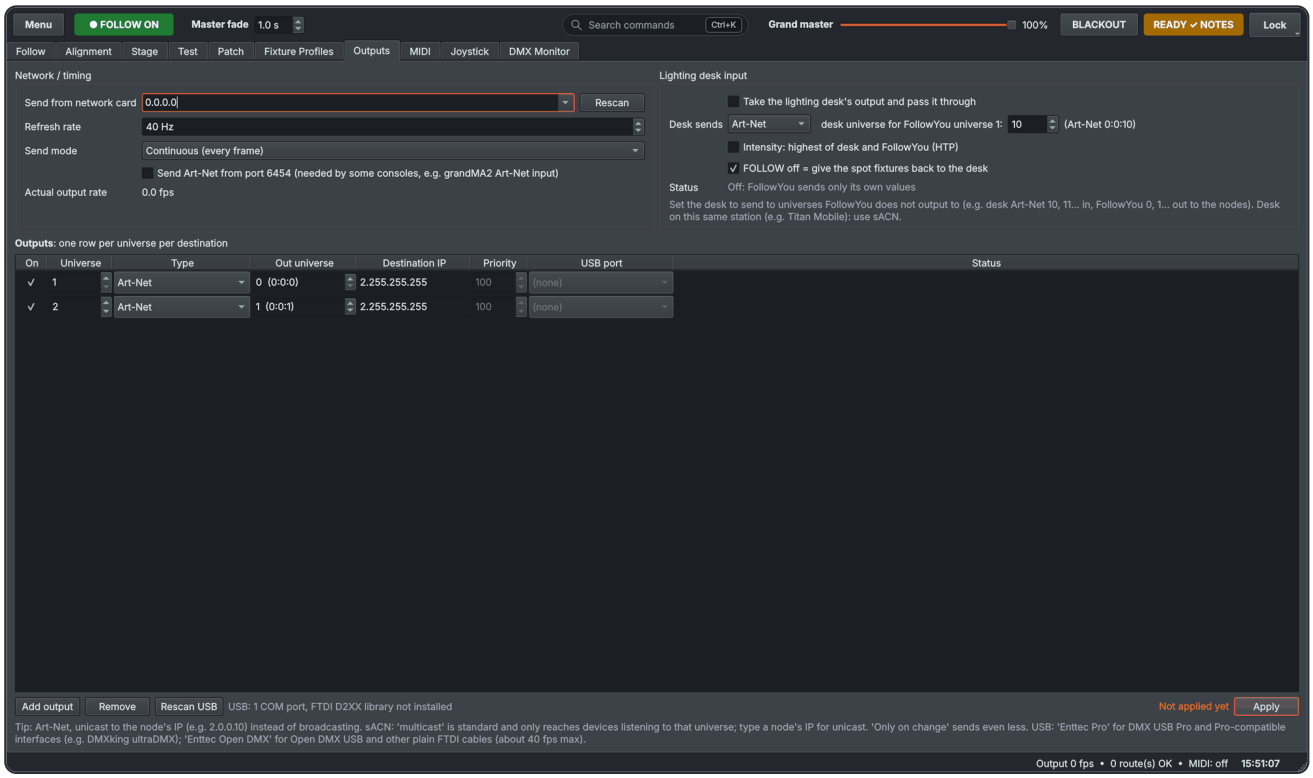
- Select one or more fixtures (Ctrl/Shift-click for several, or **Select all**).
- Drag the **Pan / Tilt** pad; Shift-drag is fine, arrow keys nudge.
- Every parameter gets a slider. Channels with named ranges get a *preset* list.
- **Highlight** sends the Highlight values; **Home selected** / **Home all** send the defaults.

While FOLLOW is on, fixtures on a spot are driven by the Follow tab (pan, tilt, zoom, focus, intensity), so the Test tab only changes their other parameters.

06

Outputs and lighting desk input

FollowYou sends DMX over Art-Net, sACN or a USB interface, and can take your lighting desk's output and pass it through.



The Outputs tab: network and timing at the top left, lighting desk input at the top right, one row per output below.

Outputs

Each row sends one FollowYou universe to one destination. Press **Add output**, fill in the row and press **Apply** (“Not applied yet” reminds you).

COLUMN	MEANING
On	Tick to send. Untick to stop that output without deleting it.
Universe	The FollowYou universe (as used in the Patch).
Type	Art-Net, sACN (E1.31), USB DMX (Enttec Pro) or USB DMX (Enttec Open DMX).
Out universe	The universe on the wire. Art-Net: a 15-bit port address shown as Net:Sub:Uni. sACN: 1–63999.

COLUMN	MEANING
Destination IP	Art-Net: the node's IP, or broadcast (e.g. 2.255.255.255). sACN: `multicast`, or a node's IP for unicast.
Priority	sACN only, 0–200, default 100. When a receiver gets the same universe from several sources, the highest priority wins.
USB port	USB types only: the interface (see below).
Status	Whether the output is running, and why not.

Send one universe to two places (a node and a visualiser, say) by adding two rows with the same Universe.

Network / timing

- **Send from network card**: pick the network card the nodes are on (**Rescan** after plugging in a cable).
- **Refresh rate**: 10–44 Hz. The actual rate is shown next to it.
- **Send mode**: *Continuous (every frame)*, or *Only on change (+1 s keep-alive)* to send a universe only when something changed, plus once a second.
- **Send Art-Net from port 6454**: needed by some consoles, e.g. grandMA2 Art-Net input. Normally FollowYou never claims port 6454 for sending, so a visualiser on the same PC keeps working.

Art-Net and sACN tips

- Art-Net: unicast straight to the node's IP (e.g. 2.0.0.10) instead of broadcasting.
- sACN: `multicast` is standard and only reaches devices listening to that universe.
- FollowYou keeps the same sACN source ID between starts. When you switch an sACN output off, or close FollowYou, it tells receivers the stream has ended, so they drop it straight away instead of holding the last look for about 2.5 seconds.

USB DMX interfaces

- **USB DMX (Enttec Pro)**: ENTTEC DMX USB Pro / Pro Mk2 (port 1), DMXking ultraDMX Micro / ultraDMX2 PRO, and other Enttec Pro protocol interfaces.
- **USB DMX (Enttec Open DMX)**: ENTTEC Open DMX USB and other plain FTDI "Open DMX" cables. These have no processor, so FollowYou makes the DMX signal itself and keeps repeating it (about 40 frames a second, the most DMX allows with a full universe).

The USB port list shows two kinds of entries:

- **COM ports**, e.g. `COM4 USB Serial Port`.
- **FTDI direct** devices, e.g. `ftdi:A700ABCD FT232R USB UART [A700ABCD] - FTDI direct`. These use FTDI's own driver (the same way QLC+ does) and work even when the interface has no COM port. **Pick this one for an Enttec interface** if you can. It needs the FTDI driver (`ftd2xx.dll`), which is installed if QLC+ can see the interface.

The line next to **Rescan USB** says what was found, e.g. "USB: 0 COM ports, 1 FTDI device", or that the FTDI driver is missing.

ONLY ONE PROGRAM AT A TIME

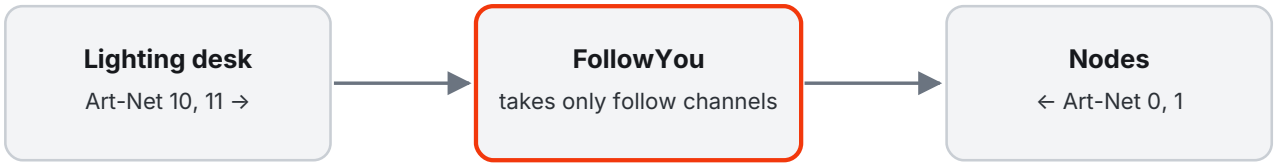
Close QLC+ (or any other lighting software) before using a USB interface, otherwise the status says the device is in use. The Pro and the Open DMX use the same USB chip: choosing the wrong type outputs nothing. The serial number in brackets tells two interfaces apart.

SMOOTHER OPEN DMX

Set the port's latency timer to 1 ms: Device Manager → the COM port → Port Settings → Advanced → Latency Timer.

Lighting desk input

FollowYou can sit between your lighting desk (Avolites Titan, grandMA, ChamSys, any desk with Art-Net or sACN out) and the nodes. The desk keeps control of everything; FollowYou only takes over the channels it actually drives.



The desk sends to universes FollowYou does not output to.

1. On the desk, send Art-Net or sACN to universes **FollowYou does not output to**. For example the desk sends Art-Net 10 and 11, and FollowYou outputs 0 and 1 to the nodes. If the desk runs on the same PC as FollowYou (e.g. Titan Mobile), use **sACN**.
2. In **Lighting desk input**, tick **Take the lighting desk's output and pass it through**, pick Art-Net or sACN and the **desk universe for FollowYou universe 1**. The next desk universe becomes FollowYou universe 2, and so on. Press **Apply**.
3. The status line shows each universe: green = receiving from the desk (with its IP or name), amber = nothing received yet, or the desk stopped.

What FollowYou takes over

- **Fixtures on a spot while FOLLOW is on**: pan, tilt, zoom, focus, intensity and shutter.
- Anything you set yourself in FollowYou: executors, the Test tab, Highlight, the alignment and lamp commands.

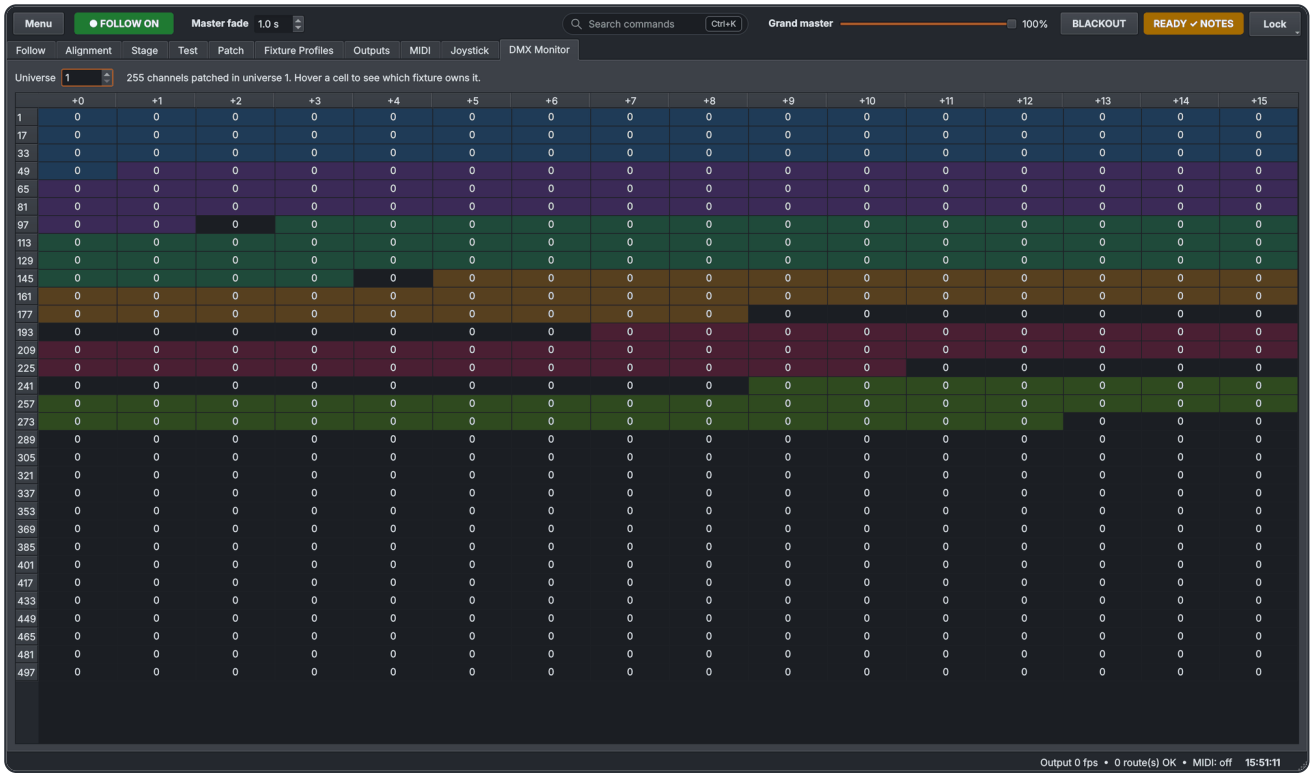
Everything else (colour, gobos, prism, frost, and all fixtures not on a spot) comes straight from the desk.

Options

- **FOLLOW off = give the spot fixtures back to the desk** (on by default): switching FOLLOW off hands pan, tilt, zoom, focus and intensity of the spot fixtures back to the desk.
- **Intensity: highest of desk and FollowYou (HTP)**: off (default) means FollowYou decides the intensity of the fixtures it follows with; on means the desk can bring them up too.
- **Grand master and BLACKOUT** in FollowYou only affect the intensities FollowYou sends. The desk's own levels pass through as they are.

- If the desk stops sending, FollowYou **keeps its last look**, like a node would, and the Safety panel says so.
- FollowYou ignores its own output, so a wrong universe can't loop. If the desk and FollowYou use the same universe, the status says so in red.

DMX Monitor



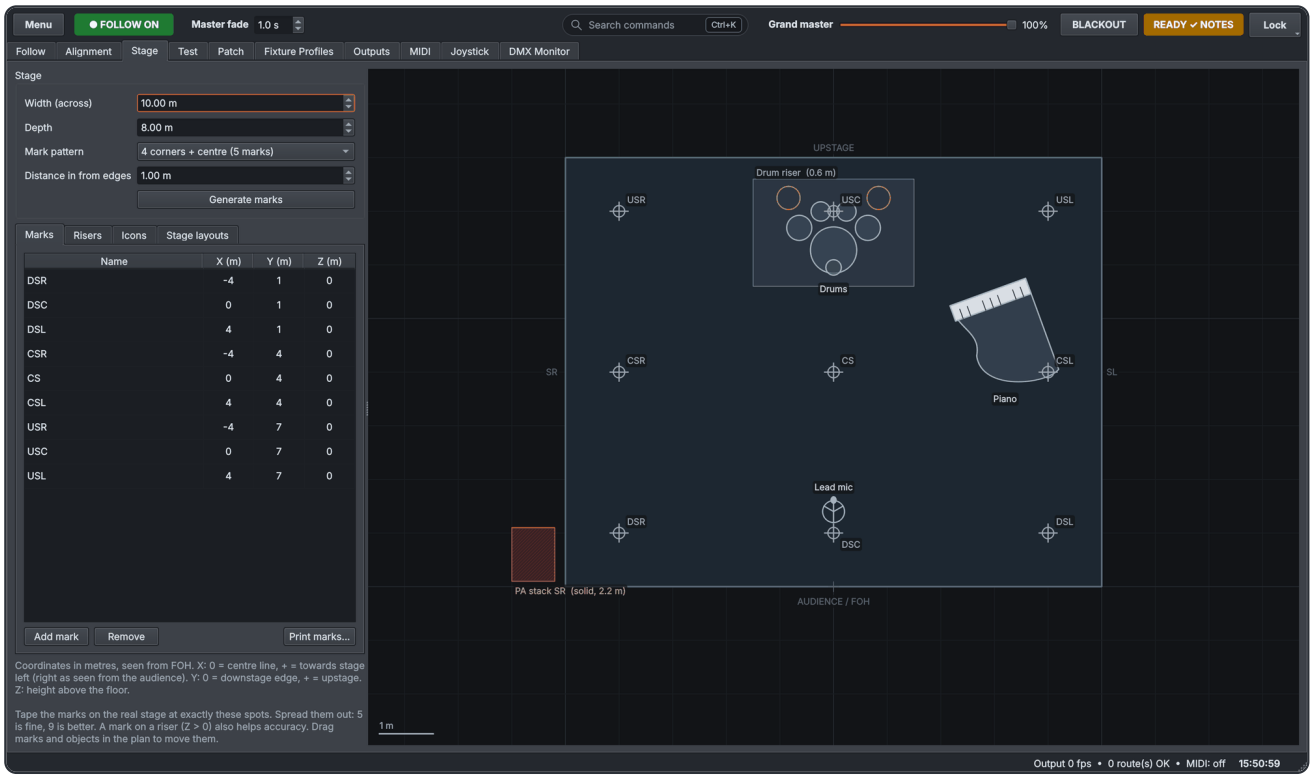
The DMX Monitor: every channel of a universe, coloured by the fixture patched there.

Pick a **Universe** to see the 512 values FollowYou sends, live. Channels are coloured by the fixture they belong to; hover over a cell to see which fixture and parameter it is. Use it to check that a fixture really gets what you expect before blaming the fixture or the cable.

07

The stage

The Stage tab describes the floor in metres: its size, the taped marks, risers, icons and stored stage layouts.

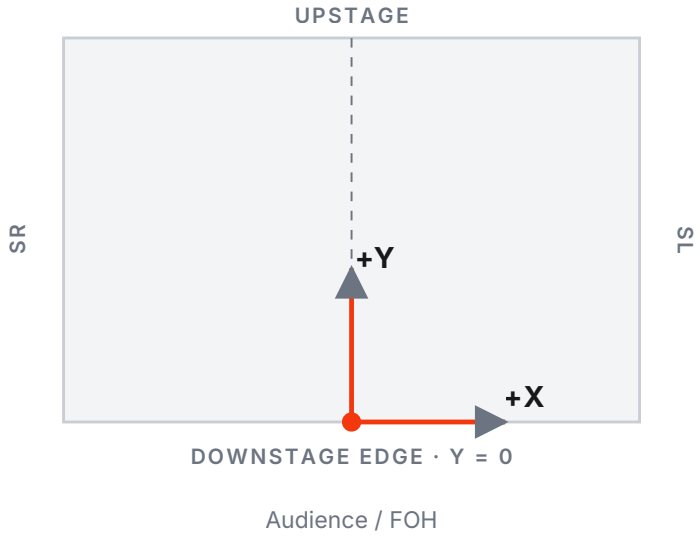


The Stage tab with nine marks, a drum riser, a piano and a PA stack.

Coordinates

All positions are in metres, **as seen from FOH**:

- **X** = 0 is the centre line; + is towards stage left (the audience's right).
- **Y** = 0 is the downstage edge; + is upstage.
- **Z** is height above the stage floor.



X = 0 on the centre line, Y = 0 at the downstage edge.

Stage size and marks

1. Enter the stage **Width (across)** and **Depth** in metres.
2. Pick a **Mark pattern**: *3 × 3 grid (9 marks, best accuracy)* or *4 corners + centre (5 marks)*.
3. Set **Distance in from edges** (how far the outer marks are from the edges) and press **Generate marks**.
4. Tape the marks on the real stage at exactly those positions. Use a tape measure from the centre line (X) and the downstage edge (Y).

The marks are named the way crews say them: **DSR**, **DSC**, **DSL** (downstage right, centre, left), **CSR**, **CS**, **CSL**, **USR**, **USC**, **USL**. Generating marks again moves marks with the same name rather than replacing them, so the alignment stored on them is kept. You can also add, edit and remove marks by hand (**Add mark**, or drag them on the plan).

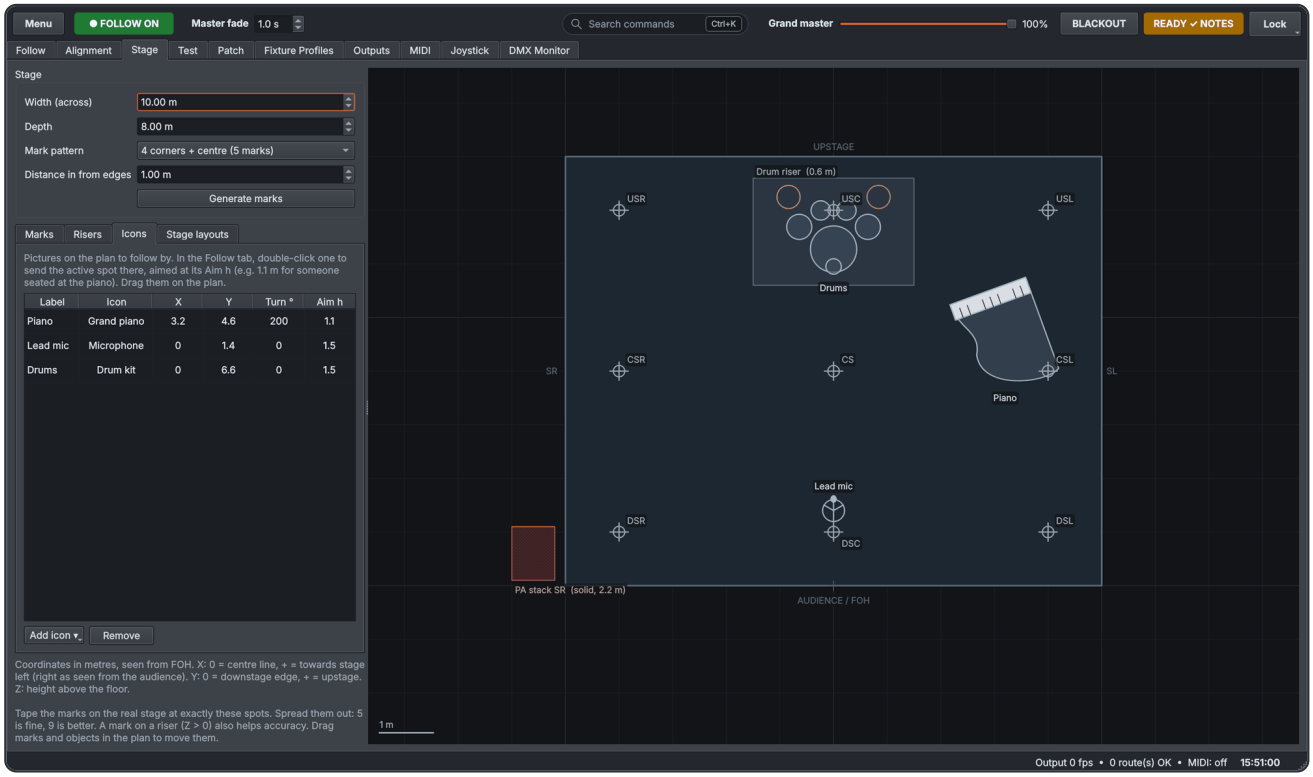
> **BETTER HEIGHT ACCURACY**
> Add one extra mark on top of a riser and set its Z to the riser's height. Marks at different heights help the alignment work out exactly how high each fixture hangs.

Risers

A riser is anything a performer stands on: a drum riser, a podium, a step. Add it in the **Risers** tab with its position, size and **height**. When a spot moves onto a riser, the aim point is raised by the riser height automatically.

Things that *block* light (speaker stacks, pillars, set walls) are **solid objects**; they're set up under **Alignment → Solid objects & off-stage**.

Icons



Icons put the band's positions on the plan. Double-click one in the Follow tab to send the active spot there.

Add icon ▾ puts a picture on the plan: grand piano, keyboard, guitar, drum kit, microphone, podium / lectern, chair, table, DJ booth, monitor wedge, screen, or a plain position star. Drag them on the plan, name them, turn them, and set **Aim h**: the height a spot sent there aims at (1.1 m for someone seated at the piano).

Icons show on the Follow tab, the operator stations and the 3D view. In the Follow tab, **double-click an icon** to send the active spot there: it glides over the master fade.

Stage layouts

For shows with scenery changes. A stage layout stores the risers, solid objects and icons.

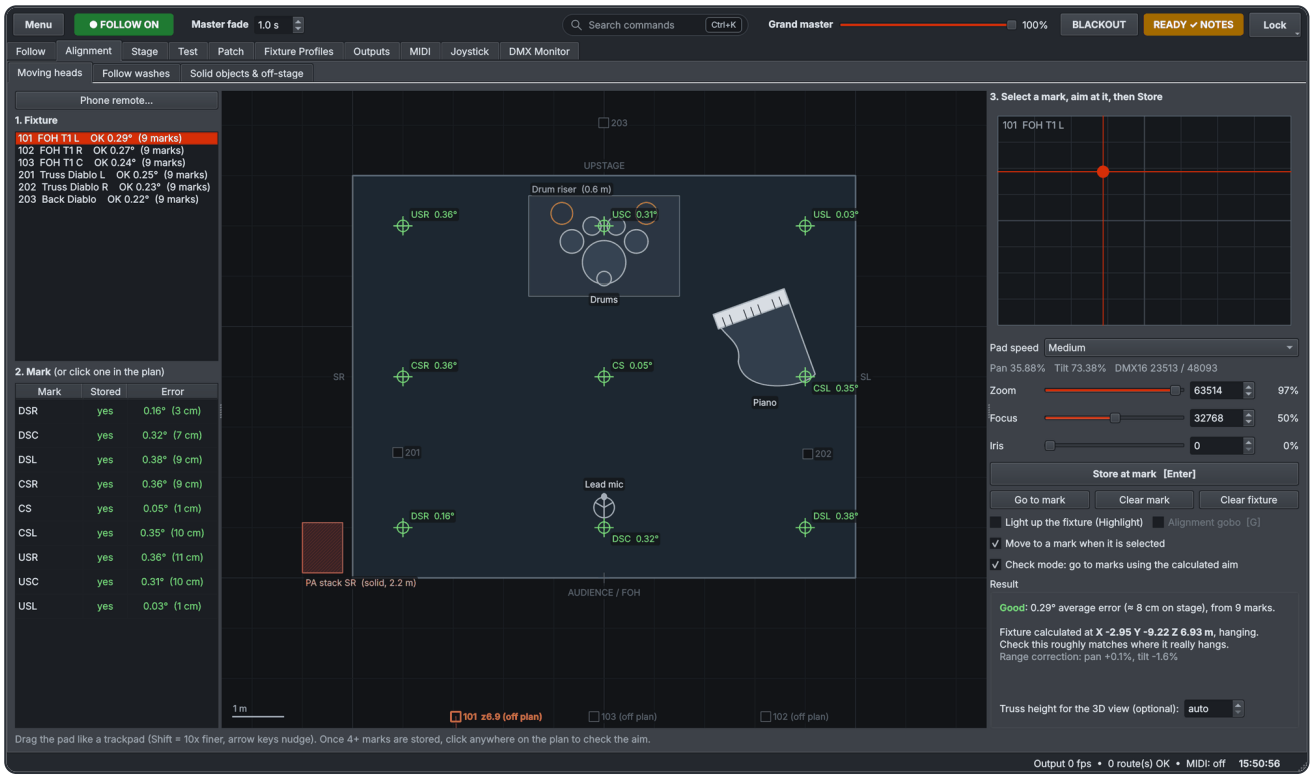
- **Save as new…** stores the stage as it is now.
- **Update** overwrites the selected layout.
- **Recall** (or double-click) puts it on stage.
- During the show, **Layout ▾** in the Follow tab recalls one with a click.

The marks and the alignment are not part of a layout, so they stay as they are.

08

Alignment

Aim each fixture at a few taped marks, once per venue. FollowYou works out where it hangs and how it is turned, and from then on it can aim at any point on stage.



Alignment → Moving heads: 1. pick the fixture, 2. pick a mark, 3. aim and store. The Result box is at the bottom right.

Aligning a moving head

1. Select the fixture in list **1** and tick **Light up the fixture**.
2. Select a mark in list **2**, or click it on the plan.
3. Drag the pad like a trackpad until the centre of the beam sits exactly on the tape. **Pad speed** changes how fast it moves; hold **Shift** for 10× finer. Arrow keys nudge. Set zoom and focus too if you want them stored for that mark.
4. Press **Store** (or **Enter**). It jumps to the next mark.
5. After 4 marks the fixture is solved. From then on, selecting a new mark pre-aims the fixture there, so you only touch it up and store.

Aiming aids

- **Iris** (if the fixture has one) makes the spot smaller and sharper, so it's easier to put exactly on the tape. It's only an aiming aid: it isn't stored, and it goes back to how it was when you pick another fixture or leave Alignment.
- **Alignment gobo** (G) puts a dot or cross gobo in, if the profile has one set (see Alignment gobo). It comes out again when you untick it, pick another fixture or leave Alignment.

> **WORK IN THE DARK**
> Align with the other lights off or low, and from a spot where you can see the tape clearly. Even better: align from the stage with your phone (see below).

Reading the result

The **Result** box shows the accuracy and where FollowYou thinks the fixture hangs. Check that position roughly matches reality: it's the quickest sanity check.

- **Under 0.5°** is good.
- If one mark has a much bigger error than the others, re-store that one, or check the tape is where the Stage tab says it is.
- **4 marks** always fit exactly, so the error can't be measured. Store a 5th (ideally all 9) before trusting it.
- **Suspicious** means the solve needed a huge range correction to fit. That almost always means one mark was stored aimed at the wrong spot. Re-store (or clear) the mark with the biggest error.

Pan and tilt range come from the fixture profile. Small errors in them are corrected automatically (“Range correction”).

Check mode

On by default. Once a fixture is solved, selecting a mark aims there using the same calculation the Follow tab uses, so what you see is the real accuracy. If it's off, nudge it onto the tape and press Store again. Clicking anywhere on the plan aims at that point on the floor, again using the calculation.

Truss height for the 3D view

Optional. The calculated height is sometimes a little off, which the 3D view on the presentation screen shows. Type the real truss height in **Truss height for the 3D view** and the fixture is drawn hanging from that height. It's only for the drawing: the follow doesn't use it. Leave it on *auto* and nothing needs measuring.

> **WHILE FOLLOW IS ON**
> The fixture you are working on in the Alignment tab is paused from following automatically, so you can align with the show running.

Aligning from your phone

Walk on stage and align without carrying the station.

1. **Menu → Phones and remote access** (or **Phone remote…** above the fixture list). Tick **Remote access on** and pick *Phone: alignment (walk the stage)*.

2. Connect the phone to the **same Wi-Fi** as the station. No Wi-Fi at the venue? Turn on Windows **Mobile hotspot** and join that, then pick the hotspot network in the window (usually 192.168.137.1).
3. Scan the QR code with the phone camera, or type the address shown. Enter the 4-digit PIN once.
4. On the phone: pick the fixture, tap **Light**, tap a mark (on the plan or in the list), drag the pad until the beam is on the tape, press **STORE**. Two fingers on the pad = 10× finer. The arrow buttons nudge, and repeat while held. Zoom, focus and iris are under the pad.

The station jumps to **Alignment → Moving heads** and shows the same fixture and mark as the phone. Both stay usable, and a phone can't move a fixture that was just changed on the station.

- **Direction & options**: if dragging moves the beam the wrong way from where you're standing, flip left/right, flip up/down or swap them. This is saved per fixture on that phone. You can also turn the plan round so the audience is at the top, as you see it from the stage.
- Phone browser menu → **Add to Home screen** gives a full-screen app icon.
- The phone can't connect? Windows Firewall is the usual cause: see Windows Firewall.

Follow washes and solid objects

The other two sub-tabs of Alignment, **Follow washes** (static fixtures that come up wherever a performer is) and **Solid objects & off-stage** (things that block light), have their own chapter: Follow washes and solid objects.

09

Follow washes and solid objects

Not every light in the rig moves. Follow washes let static fixtures (front PARs, fresnels, LED washes) take part in the follow: each one covers an area of the stage and fades up when a performer walks into it. Solid objects do the opposite: they dim a moving head when something is in the way.

What follow washes are for

A follow wash is a static fixture tied to an area of the stage. When a spot walks into that area, the wash comes up. When the spot walks out, it fades down again. Nothing moves; the light simply “follows” by handing over from one fixture to the next.

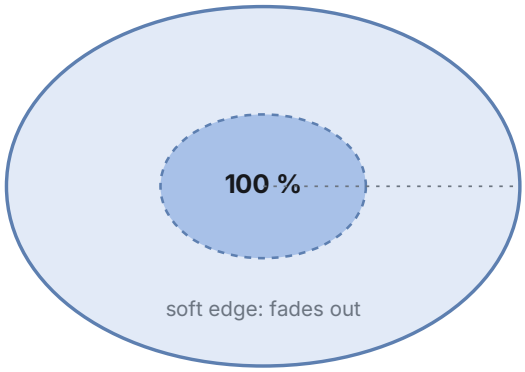
- **Front light without movers.** A row of front PARs or fresnels, each focused on its own zone, gives a performer an even front light wherever they go, and the rest of the stage stays dark. That's a working follow with no moving heads at all.
- **A base under the movers.** The moving heads do the tight, punchy spot; the washes fill in a soft, wider front light around it.
- **Specials.** A wash can be tied to one performer only, so the piano special only comes up for the piano player.
- **Area colour.** LED washes over parts of the stage that open up where the band is playing.

Follow washes need **no alignment**: they don't move, so FollowYou only needs to know which area each one lights. You draw that area on the stage plan.

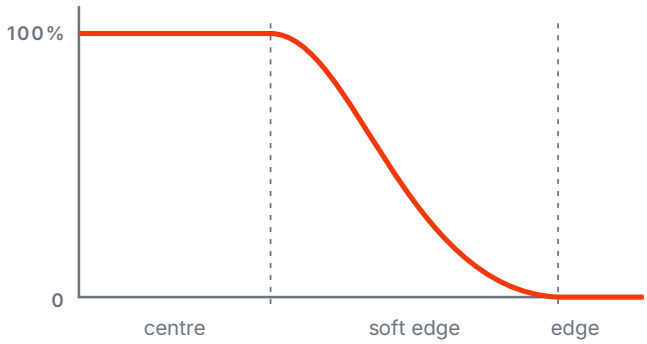
Which fixtures can be follow washes

- **Any fixture with a dimmer**: LED PARs, fresnels and profiles on dimmers, LED washes and battens, or a moving head you park in one place.
- The fixture must be **patched** with a profile that has a `dimmer` channel. The profiles that come with FollowYou are moving heads, so for a PAR you make a small profile once: **New** in Fixture Profiles, one row per channel, attribute `dimmer` on the dimmer channel (and `red`, `green`, `blue`, `white` or whatever else it has). See Making a profile.
- A fixture that is on a spot is skipped: it can't be a spot fixture and a follow wash at the same time.

How the level is worked out



outside the area: 0 %



level of the wash, from the centre of its area to the edge

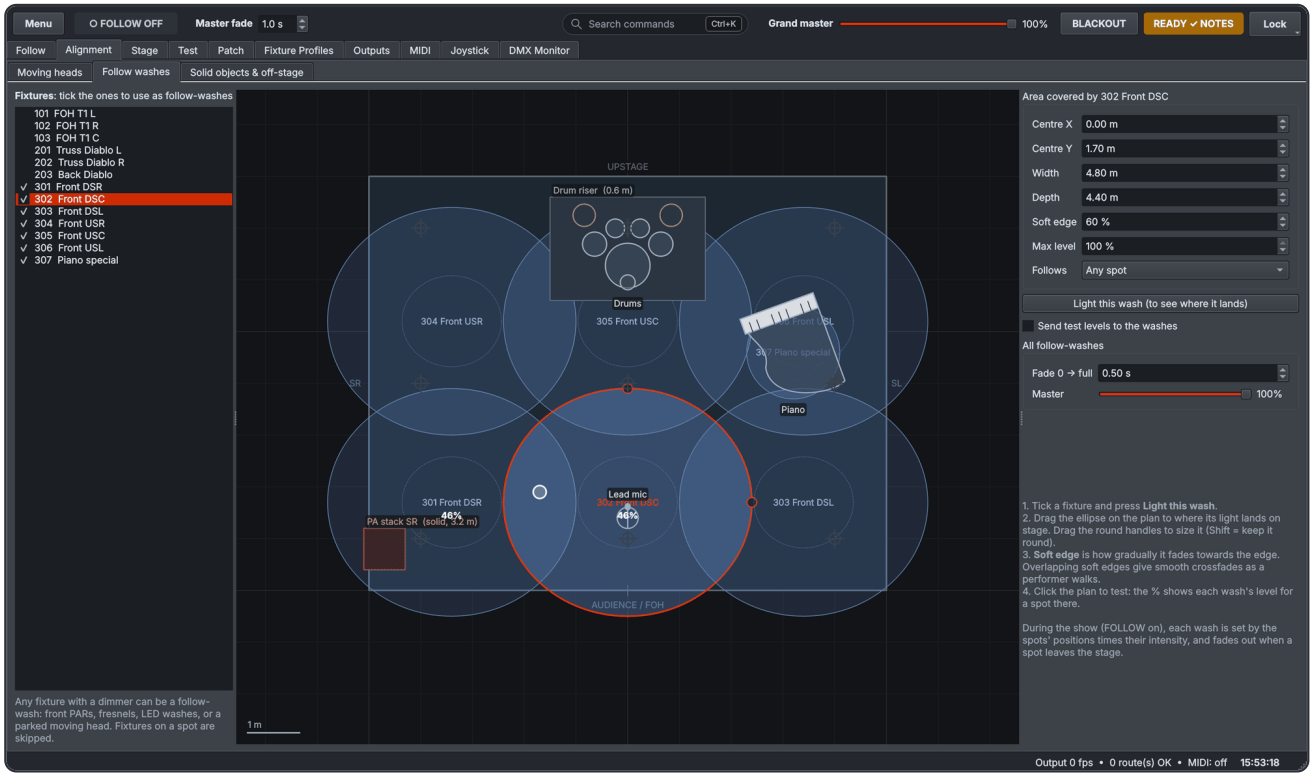
Inside the inner part of the area the wash is at full. Over the soft edge it fades smoothly to zero.

For every wash, many times a second, FollowYou works out:

wash level = how central the spot is in the area × the spot's intensity × the wash's **Max level** × the follow-wash **Master**

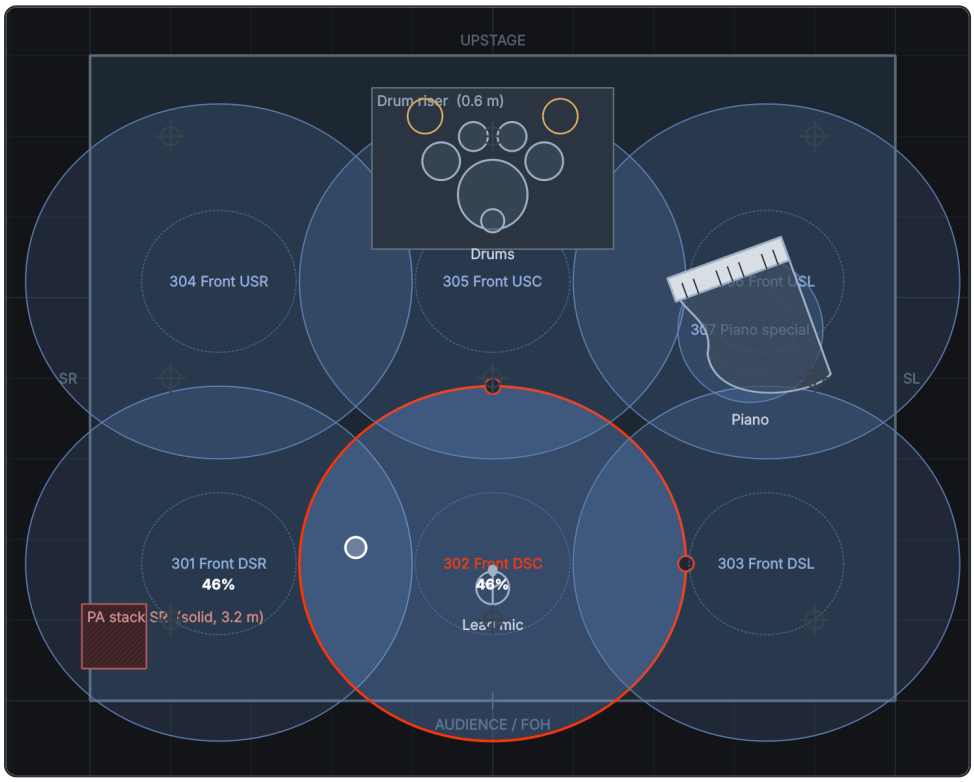
- **How central** is 100 % in the middle part of the area and fades smoothly to 0 % over the **soft edge**, as in the drawing.
- The **spot's intensity** counts: a spot at 50 % brings its washes to 50 %; a spot that is off doesn't bring up any washes. So Space, Full/Off, faders and ALL SPOTS OUT fade the washes together with the spot.
- With **several spots** in one area, the wash takes the **highest** level any of them asks for.
- When a spot walks **off the stage**, its washes fade out with it (see Off-stage fade).
- **Fade 0 → full** limits how fast a wash may change: with 0.5 s, a wash takes half a second to go from dark to full. Slower feels softer and hides small jumps; faster keeps up with a running performer.
- FollowYou drives the wash's **dimmer** (and opens its shutter, if it has one). Colour and everything else stay as they are: set them with an executor, the Test tab, or from your lighting desk.
- Washes only run while **FOLLOW is on**.

Setting up follow washes



Alignment → Follow washes: fixtures on the left, the areas on the plan, the selected area's settings on the right.

1. Go to **Alignment → Follow washes** and **tick** the fixtures to use as follow washes. Each one gets an area on the plan.
2. Select a wash and press **Light this wash (to see where it lands)**. Only that fixture comes up, at full.
3. Look where its light lands on the stage, then **drag the ellipse** on the plan to the same place. Drag the **round handles** to size it; hold **Shift** to keep it round. Or type **Centre X**, **Centre Y**, **Width** and **Depth** in metres.
4. Set the **Soft edge**. Around 50–60 % works well for front light.
5. Repeat for the next wash. Make neighbouring areas **overlap** by their soft edges, so a performer walking from one to the next gets a smooth crossfade instead of a dip.
6. **Test**: click or drag on the plan. Each area shows the level its wash would have for a performer standing there. Tick **Send test levels to the washes** to see the real lights do it.



Testing a position halfway between two front zones: both washes come up to about half, so the performer is lit evenly while crossing.

Settings for each wash

SETTING	WHAT IT DOES
Centre X / Centre Y	The middle of the area, in stage metres (X = 0 is the centre line, Y = 0 the downstage edge).
Width / Depth	The size of the area across and up/downstage. Match it to where the light actually lands at performer height.
Soft edge	How much of the area fades. 0 % = hard edge (full right up to the edge, then off); 100 % = fades all the way from the centre.
Max level	The highest level this wash ever goes to. Use it to balance a brighter fixture against the others, or to keep a special subtle.
Follows	*Any spot*, or one spot only. A wash that follows one spot ignores everyone else.

Settings for all washes

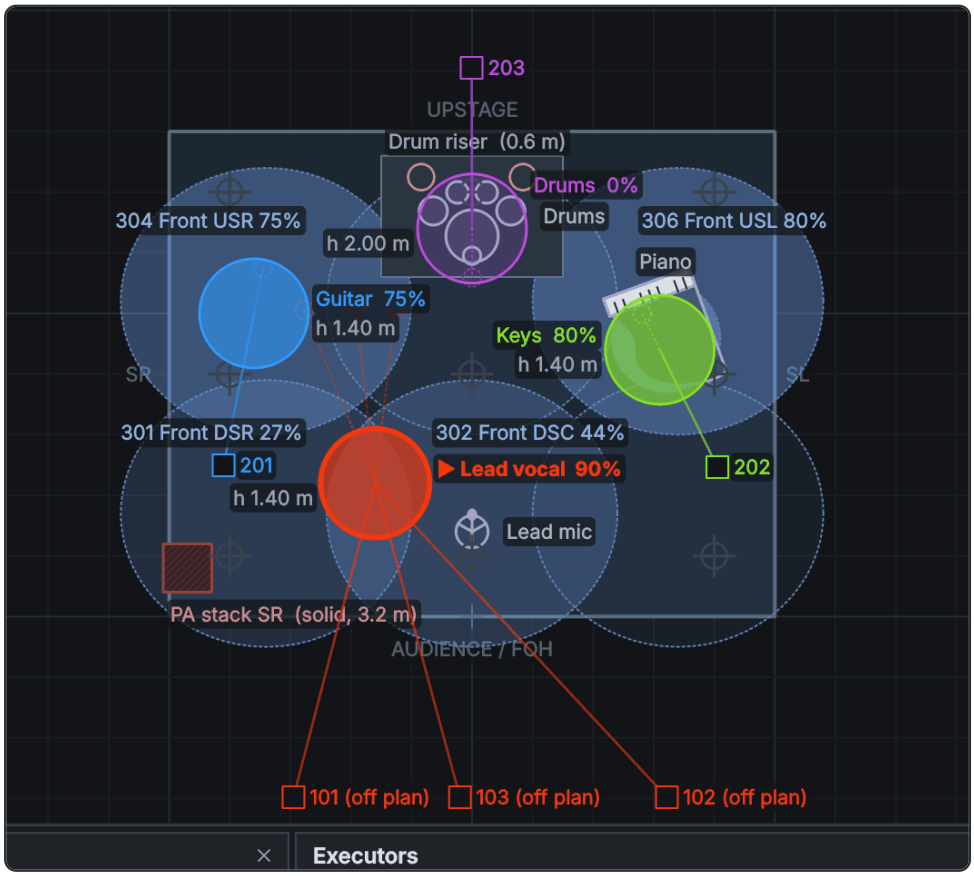
SETTING	WHAT IT DOES
Fade 0 → full	How fast washes may change, in seconds from dark to full.
Master	Scales every follow wash. Also in the Follow tab (*Follow washes* in Options), on a fader (*Follow-wash master*), on the APC mini's fader 8 and the nanoKONTROL2's knob 1.

Example: front light in six zones

A 10 × 8 m stage with six LED PARs on the FOH truss, focused in a 3 × 2 grid, plus a PAR as a piano special. This is the setup in the screenshots.

WASH	CENTRE X, Y	WIDTH × DEPTH	SOFT EDGE	FOLLOWS
301 Front DSR / 302 DSC / 303 DSL	−3.4 / 0 / 3.4, 1.7	4.8 × 4.4 m	60 %	Any spot
304 Front USR / 305 USC / 306 USL	−3.4 / 0 / 3.4, 5.2	4.8 × 4.4 m	60 %	Any spot
307 Piano special	3.2, 4.6	1.8 × 1.8 m	40 %, Max level 90 %	Keys only

1. Patch the PARs with a simple PAR profile and tick them in Follow washes.
2. Light each one, drag its area to where it lands, set the sizes above. Zone centres 3.4 m apart with 4.8 m wide areas overlap by about 1.4 m: right for a smooth handover.
3. Set the piano special to follow the *Keys* spot only, so the singer walking past the piano doesn't bring it up.
4. Make an executor that sets the PARs' colour (e.g. a warm white), and press it before the show.
5. FOLLOW on, bring the spots up. The front light now walks with the performers.



During the show the areas light up on the plan as their washes come up, with each wash's level next to it.

During the show

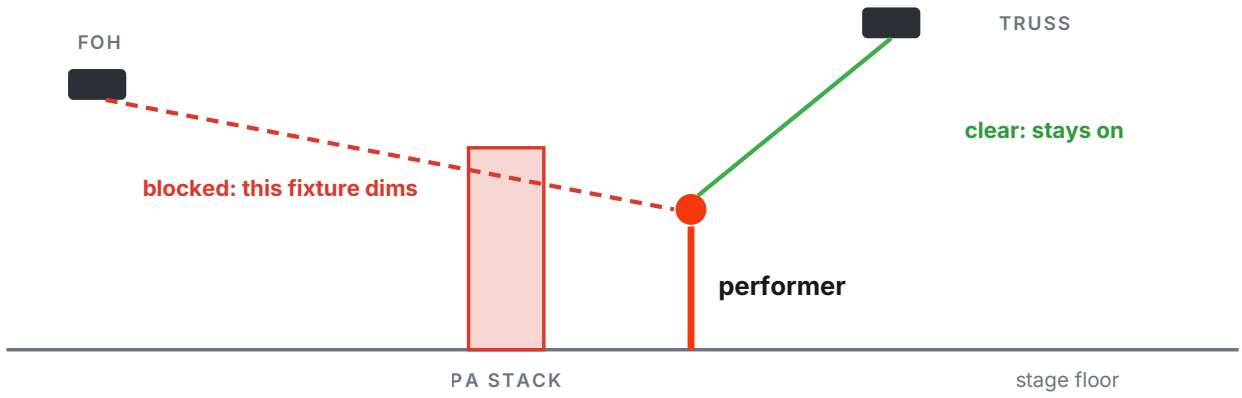
- The Follow tab draws each area dotted. It fills in brighter as its wash comes up, with the fixture's level next to it, so you can see at a glance which washes are on.
- **Follow washes** in Options (or a fader) is the master: pull it down to keep only the movers.
- ALL SPOTS OUT, Space and spot faders take the washes with them, because a wash follows its spot's intensity.
- BLACKOUT and the grand master work on washes too.
- While you work on a wash in the Alignment tab (Light this wash, test levels), that wash is paused from following, so you can adjust it with the show running.

TIPS

Draw the areas where the light lands at *performer height*, not on the floor: a front light hits a standing person further downstage than its pool on the floor. Overlap neighbouring areas by about a third of their width. Keep the soft edge generous (50 % or more) unless you want a hard switch from one zone to the next.

Solid objects

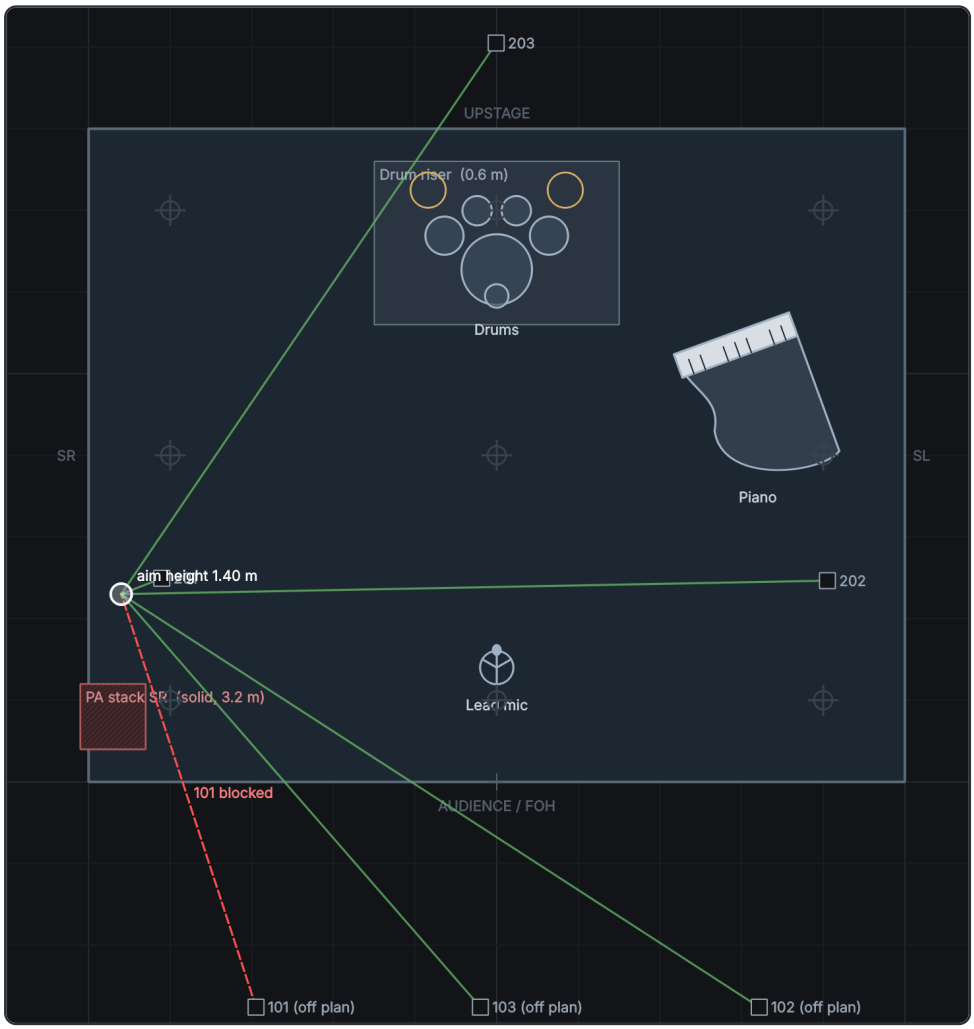
A solid object is anything light can't go through: a speaker stack, a pillar, a set wall, a screen. If the straight line from a moving head to the performer passes through one, **that fixture** dims out, and comes back when the view is clear. The other fixtures on the same spot stay on, so the performer is still lit from the fixtures that can see them.



Height matters: a beam from a high truss passes over a low object, while a lower front fixture may not.

Setting them up

1. Go to **Alignment → Solid objects & off-stage** and press **Add solid object**.
2. Fill in the **Label**, **X**, **Y** (the centre), **Width**, **Depth** and **Height** in metres, or drag the box on the plan.
3. Click the plan where a performer might stand behind it. Every aligned fixture gets a line to that point: **green** = it can see the performer, **red** with “blocked” = it will dim. The test uses the active spot's aim height.
4. Set **Dim / return time**: how quickly a blocked fixture dims and comes back (0.3 s is a good start).



Testing a position behind the PA stack: fixture 101 is blocked (red), the others can still see the performer (green).

During the show, **Fixture status** says *Blocked (dimmed)* for a fixture that is dimmed because of a solid object:

```
101 FOH T1 L: Blocked (dimmed)
102 FOH T1 R: OK - beam size: narrowest possible here is 1.9 m
103 FOH T1 C: OK
```

- Fixtures only appear in the test once they are aligned (see Alignment), because FollowYou needs to know where they hang.
- Untick **Dim a fixture while a solid object is in its way** to switch blocking off without deleting the objects.
- Solid objects are part of stage layouts, so a set change can bring its own walls.
- Things performers *stand on* are risers, set up in the Stage tab. Things that *block light* are solid objects. A drum riser with a screen in front of it can be both.

KEEP IT SIMPLE

Only add objects that really block a fixture you use: a low monitor wedge rarely matters for fixtures on a truss. Get the height right, since that decides whether a beam passes over.

Off-stage fade

When a spot moves past the edge of the stage (a performer walking off, or the joystick pushed too far), the spot and its washes fade out instead of lighting the wings or the audience.

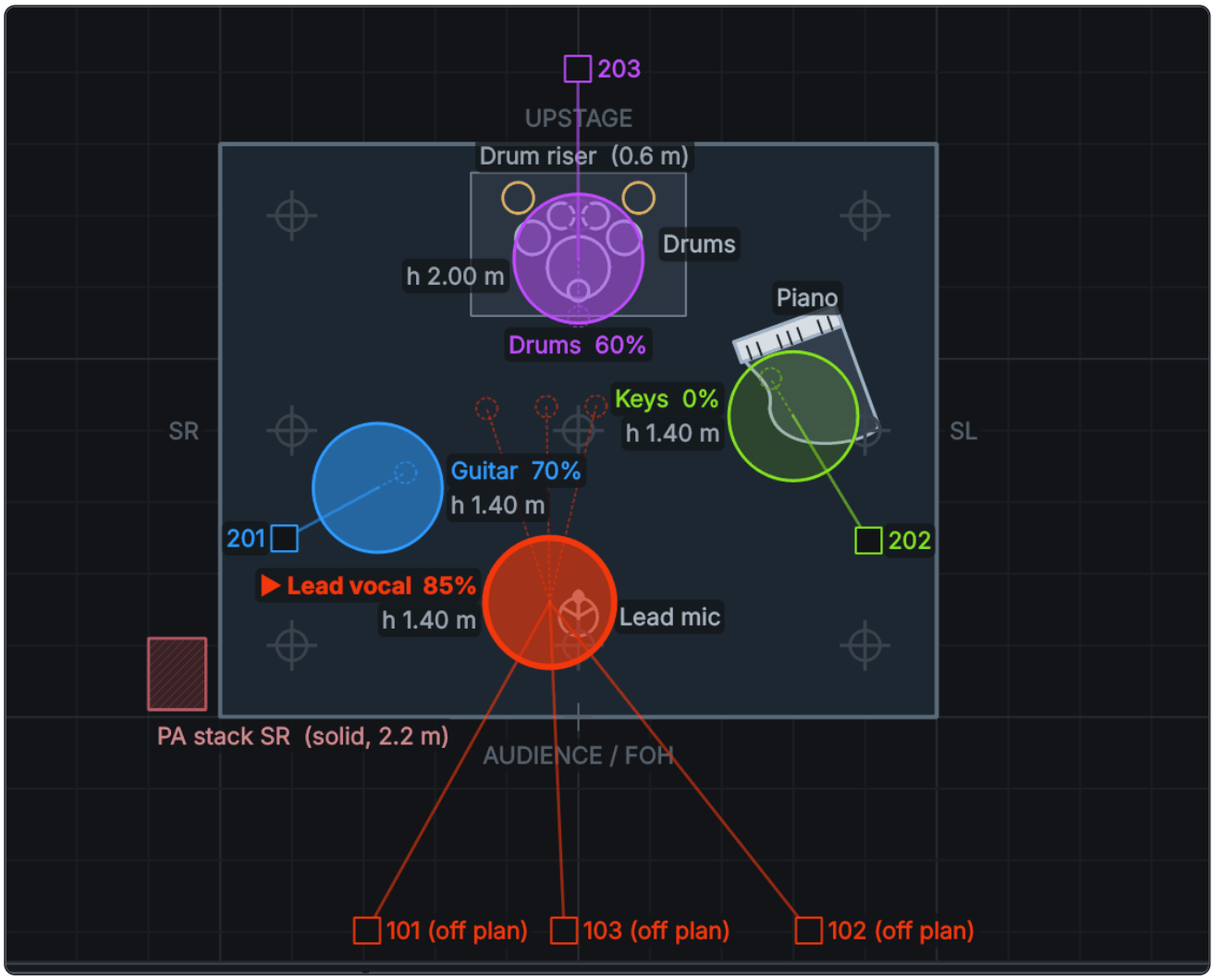
- **Fade a spot out when it leaves the stage** switches it on or off.
- **Starts this far past the edge**: some leeway for the lip of the stage or a performer leaning out (0.3 m by default).
- **Fully out after another**: how gradual the fade is (1.0 m by default). The spot is at 0 % once it is this far beyond the starting line.

Walking back on brings the spot back up to where it was.

10

Following: show time

The Follow tab is where the show runs: the stage plan with spots, settings, executors, faders and safety in panels around it, arranged on a grid you can change (views).



The stage plan. Each circle is a spot; lines run to the fixtures on it. Dotted rings show where each beam would hit the empty floor.

Spots

Each **spot** is one performer. The **Spots** panel lists them: **Add spot**, **Rename**, **Colour** and **Remove**. The spot's colour is used on the plan, the video ghosts, the spot strip and the phones.

The **active spot** is the one you are driving: it's highlighted in the list and drawn with ▶ on the plan. Pick it with 1–9, by clicking it in the list or the spot strip, or by right-clicking near it on the plan.

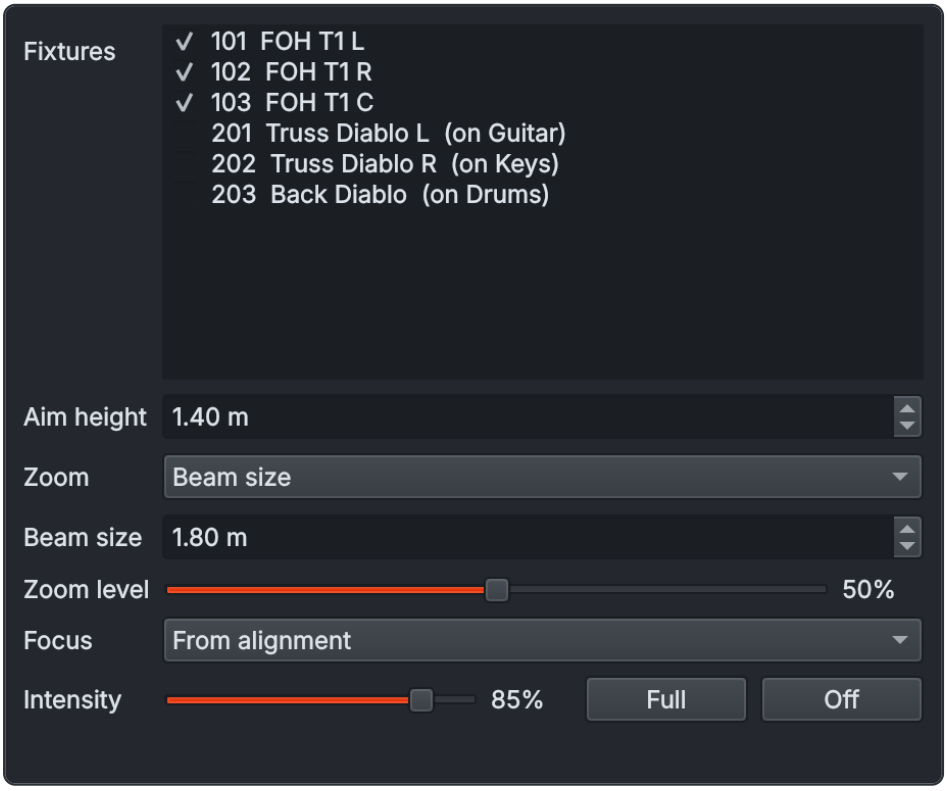
In **Spot settings**, tick the fixtures that belong to the active spot. A fixture can only be on one spot at a time. **Fixture status** shows each one: green *OK*, amber *OK – …* with a warning (a zoom it can't reach, say), red when it can't follow (not aligned, or the point is out of its reach).

Driving a spot on the plan

DO THIS	TO
Click / drag on the plan	Move the active spot
Shift-drag	Move it finely
Arrow keys	Nudge it
Mouse wheel	Beam size (zoom level in Manual zoom)
Ctrl+wheel	Aim height
1–9	Pick a spot
Space	Active spot on/off over the master fade
Right-click	Pick the nearest spot
Double-click an icon	Send the active spot to it (glides over the master fade)
M	Multi-spot on/off

Turn **FOLLOW ON** in the top bar first. FollowYou always starts dark: FOLLOW off and every spot at 0.

Spot settings



Aim height

Where on the performer to aim: 1.4 m is about chest height. Ctrl+wheel changes it. On an **empty stage** this makes the light land behind the dot: a front-of-house fixture aimed at 1.4 m hits the floor several metres further upstage, and the dotted rings on the plan show where. That's correct: with someone standing on the dot, it's on them.

Floor test

In **Options**, tick **Floor test** to aim at the floor instead, so the beam lands exactly on the dot. Use it to check the alignment on an empty stage, then untick it for the show. It isn't saved with the show.

Zoom

- **From alignment** blends the zoom you stored at each mark.
- **Beam size** keeps the beam the same width in metres anywhere on stage. The wheel changes the size. This needs the zoom angles in the profile (see Measure zoom angles); without them, Spot settings says so and the zoom is left alone. A size the fixture can't reach from where it hangs (e.g. 1 m from 15 m away with a 15° narrowest zoom) stays at the narrowest or widest, and the status says what the limit is.
- **Manual (zoom level slider)** gives a **Zoom level** slider (0–100 %) that sends the zoom channel directly. The wheel changes it too, and so can a fader (*Spot zoom level*) or an executor. Moving the slider switches the spot to Manual.

Focus

From alignment blends the focus stored at each mark, or **Manual**.

Intensity

The spot's dimmer. When it's above 0, the shutter opens using the shutter channel's Highlight value from the profile. Underneath it shows **what last changed it**: “Joystick Z axis”, “MIDI CC 48”, “Executor ‘Spot ON’”, a phone's name...

> **A SPOT WON'T GO OFF, OR KEEPS JUMPING BACK?**
> Look at the line under Intensity first: it names whatever is fighting you. MIDI faders that keep re-sending the same value are ignored until the value actually changes, so a controller can't force a level back after you changed it.

Smoothing

In **Options**. Makes mouse movement less jerky: 50–150 ms feels natural; 0 = instant.

Fades

- Space turns the active spot on/off over the master fade time. **Full** and **Off** in the spot panel fade too.
- The intensity slider and faders are always instant.
- Grabbing a control while it's fading takes over straight away. For example, dragging the spot during a position fade stops the fade.

> **FOLLOW WASHES ON THE PLAN**
> If you use follow washes, their areas are drawn dotted on the plan. An area fills in as its wash comes up, with the level next to it. **Follow washes** in Options is their master.

Multi-spot

Multi-spot (in the bar above the plan, or M) drives several spots at once.

- Ctrl+click a spot tile, Ctrl+right-click a spot on the plan, or press Ctrl+1–9 to add a spot to the group or take it out. The button shows how many spots are in it; dashed lines join them to the active spot on the plan.
- The **active spot leads**. When it moves (mouse, joystick, phone, auto-track, a position preset), the others keep their distance to it, so a formation moves as one. They copy its level, beam size, aim height and zoom.
- Space, Full/Off and the intensity fader work on the whole group.
- Executors for the **active spot** act on every spot in the group (a colour preset colours them all). A position preset moves the lead and the others follow.
- Picking another active spot keeps the group and adds the new one to it.

The Safety panel

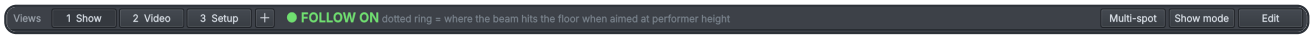


- **ALL SPOTS OUT** fades every spot (and the follow washes with them) out over the master fade. Press it **again within 3 s to cut instantly**. Each spot remembers its level for the next “on”.

- **FREEZE POSITIONS**: every spot stays exactly where it is. Mouse, joystick, executors, phones and operator stations can't move them until you click it again. Useful if a joystick plays up or someone grabs the wrong phone.
- It shows the **output health**: every output, with a warning when an output sends a universe with nothing patched in it, fixtures on a spot that aren't aligned, BLACKOUT, and the phones and operator stations that are connected.

Views: arranging the Follow page

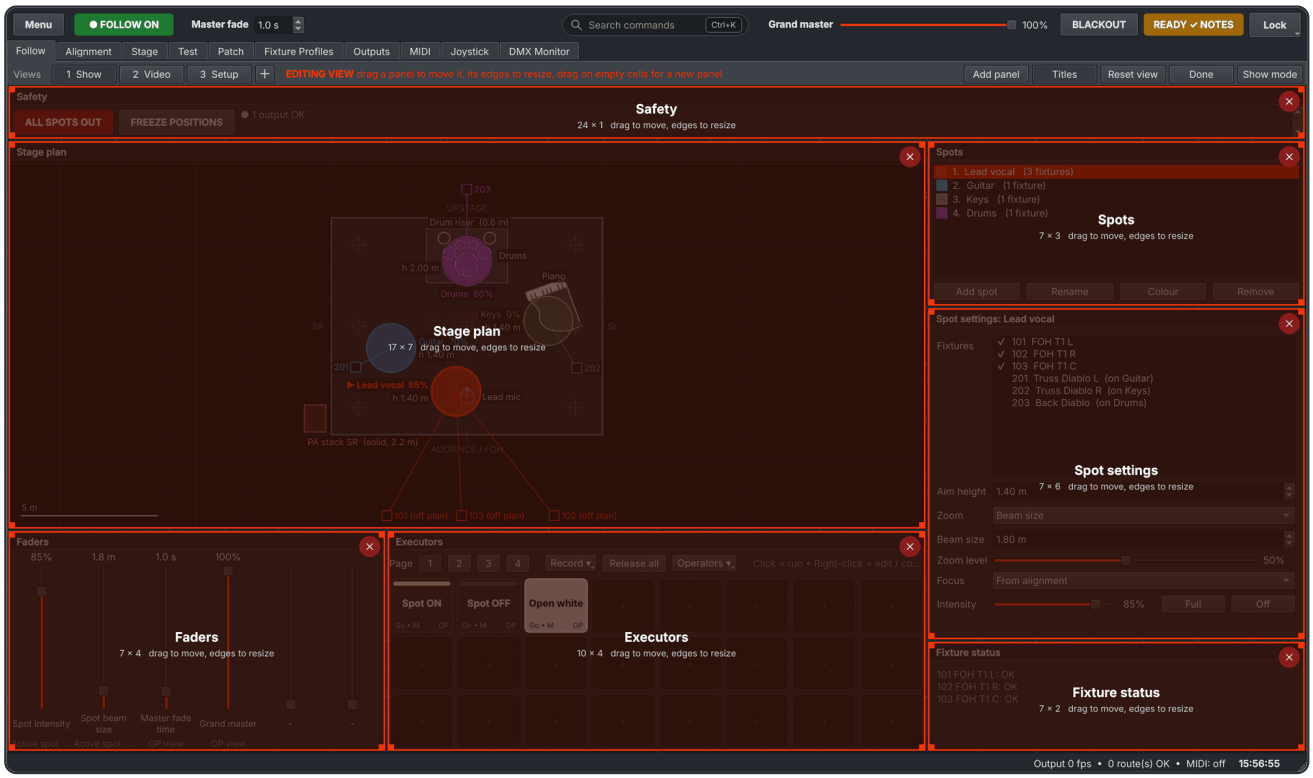
The Follow page is a **grid** of 24 × 12 cells, like the views on an MA or Avolites desk. Every part of it is a **panel** covering some of the cells: Stage plan, Safety, Spot strip, Spots, Spot settings, Fixture status, Options, Faders, Executors, Keys and mouse help, Video, Lamps and Recordings. A **view** is one arrangement.



The bar above the Follow page: the views (Alt+1-9), **+** for a new view, what FOLLOW is doing, Multi-spot, Show mode and Edit.

- Three views to start with: **Show** (plan, spots, settings, faders, executors), **Video** (the camera picture with the plan beside it) and **Setup** (a big plan, spot settings and options).
- Click a view, or press Alt+1–9, to switch. The panels keep working while they're not on screen.
- **+** makes a new view: a copy of the one you're on, ready to change. Right-click a view to **rename**, copy, move, **reset** or delete it.
- Views are remembered per computer, not per show, so the laptop and the FOH screen can each have their own.

Edit a view

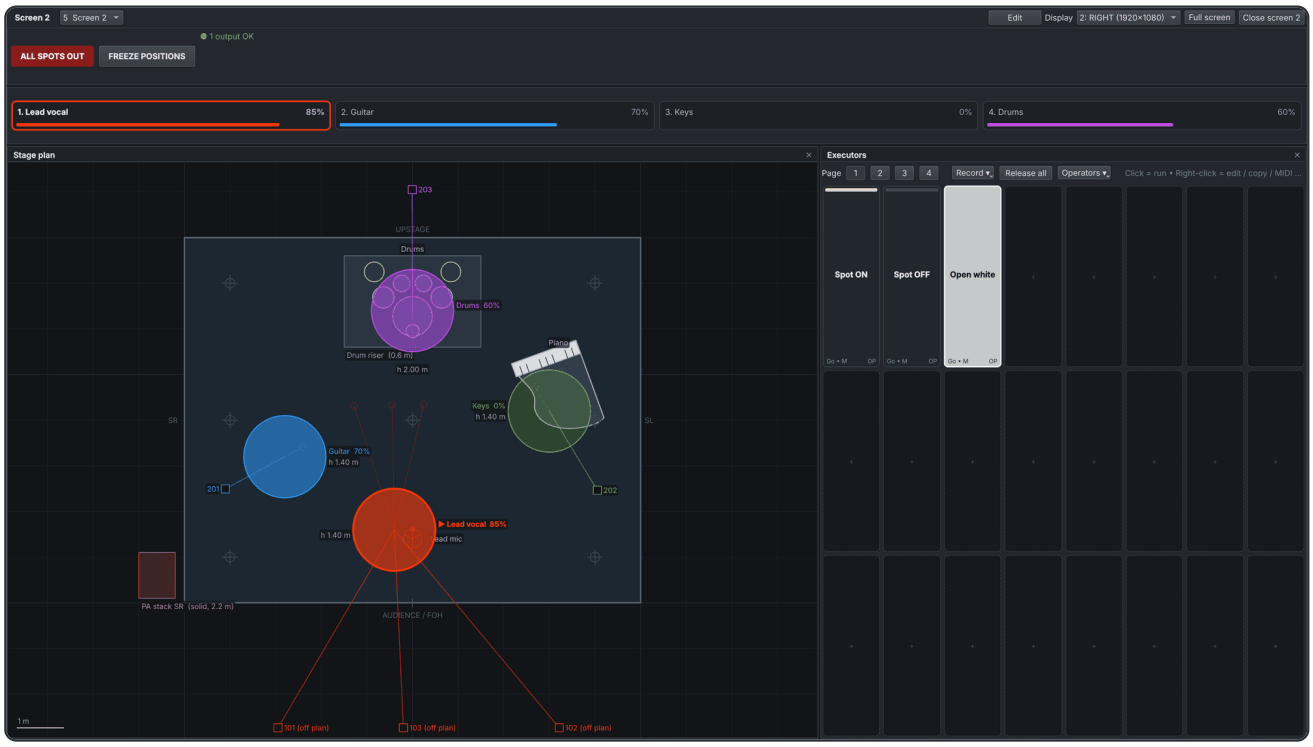


Edit: every panel shows its name and size; drag to move, drag an edge or corner to resize. A red outline means it would land on another panel.

1. Press **Edit** (top right of the page). The grid appears and the panels stop working until you press **Done**.
2. **Drag a panel** to move it; drag its **edges or corners** to resize it. Everything snaps to the grid.
3. **Drag across empty cells** to draw a new panel and pick what goes in it, or press **Add panel**. The **×** removes a panel from this view (it stays in the others).
4. **Titles** turns the panel title bars off for more room. **Reset view** puts the standard layout back.
5. **Done**. The view is saved at once.

A panel smaller than its content gets a scroll bar instead of covering its neighbours. Opening **Lamps** or **Recordings** from the Menu puts that panel in the view you're on (it shares the space of the biggest panel), and its × gives the space back.

Second screen (F12)



Screen 2 on its own display, here with the safety bar, the spot strip, the plan and the executors (the same panels are on the main screen too). The bar along the top: which view, Edit, which display, Full screen and Close.

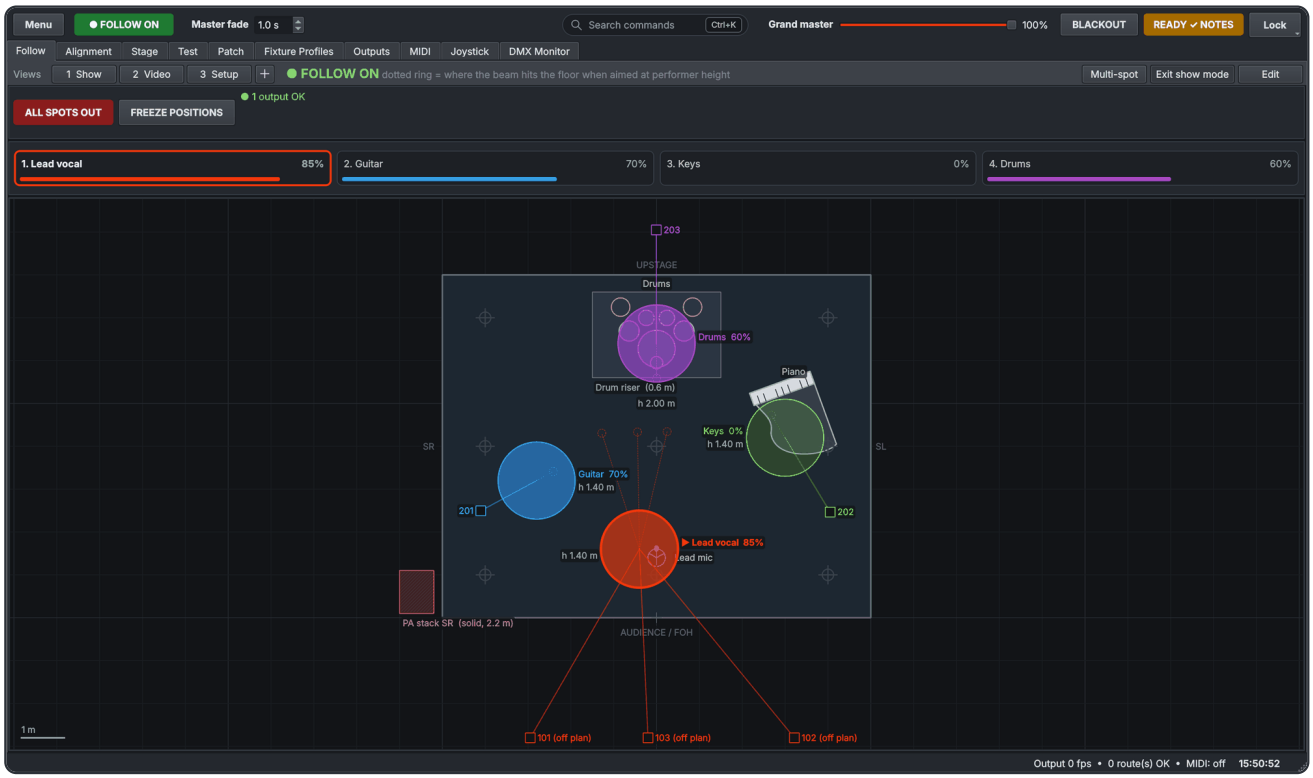
With two monitors on the operator PC, **Menu → Screen → Second screen** (F12) opens **screen 2**: a second Follow page, full screen on the other display, like the second screen on a lighting desk. The main window shows one view and screen 2 another, for instance the camera picture big on screen 2 and the plan with the executors on the main screen.

- Screen 2 picks from the **same views** as the main window (the list top left). The first time it gets a view of its own, **Screen 2**, with the camera picture full size. Change it with **Edit** on screen 2, exactly as on the main window.
- **The same panel can be on both screens**: a plan on each, executors on each, the Safety bar on each. Both work and show the same thing, so you can pick a spot or fire an executor on whichever screen is nearest your hand.
- **Display** picks which monitor it goes on. FollowYou avoids the display the Presentation screen is on when there is a choice. With only one monitor, screen 2 opens as a normal window.
- Keys and shortcuts work on screen 2 as on the main window (spot keys, Space, Ctrl+K, the F-keys). **Lock** locks screen 2 too.
- Screen 2, its view and its display are remembered on this computer: it comes back by itself the next time FollowYou starts. F12 or **Close screen 2** closes it.

LIGHT CONSOLE WORKFLOW

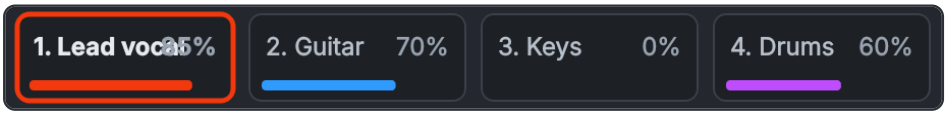
Put the same view on both screens when you want the plan under both hands, or Show mode on the main screen and the Video view on screen 2 for a camera operator feel.

Show mode



Show mode (F10): by default just the safety bar, the spot strip and the plan.

Show mode (button, or F10) is a view of its own: by default the safety bar, the **spot strip** and the plan. Edit it like any other view (add the Video panel, say). The spot strip has one tile per spot: pick it, see its level, switch it on/off. Press Show mode again, or pick a view, to get your view back. F11 = full screen.



Lamps (bulb and discharge fixtures)

Fixtures with a lamp instead of LEDs have to be switched on (“struck”) and off with a DMX value on a control channel, often held for a few seconds. Set the lamp channel and values in the profile first (Light source).

1. Open **Menu → Lamps** : a Lamps panel appears in the Follow view you are on. Every lamp fixture gets a **Lamp ON** and a **Lamp OFF** button.
2. Press one: FollowYou keeps sending that value until you press it again (or the time runs out). Then the lamp channel goes back to its default value, so the fixture doesn't keep seeing the command (on many fixtures that channel also does resets).
3. **All lamps ON**, **All lamps OFF…** (asks first) and **Stop sending** work on the whole rig. While a lamp command is being sent, the Safety panel says so.

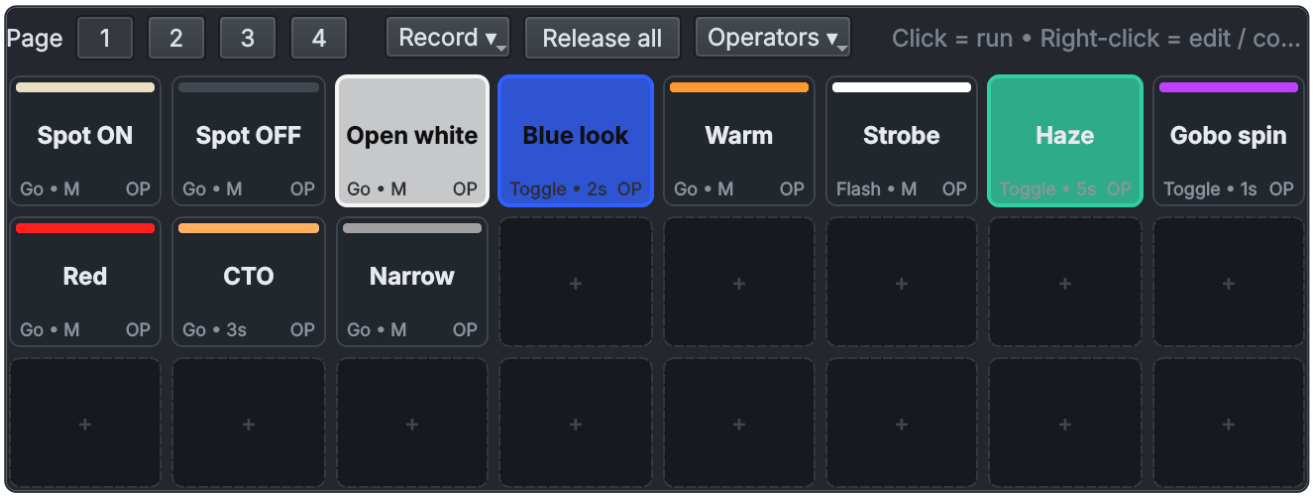
> **COOL-DOWN**
> Lamps need to cool down (often minutes) after being switched off before they strike again. Don't switch lamps off between songs.

Operator stations can use the Lamps panel too; the main station sends the DMX.

11

Executors and faders

Executors are the buttons under the stage plan: presets for colour, position, beam and anything else. Faders sit next to them for levels and sizes.



The Executors panel: pages 1–4, Record ▾, Release all and Operators ▾ above the buttons.

What an executor is

There are **4 pages of 24** executors. Each one is a list of lines of the form *"set this parameter to this value on these things"*. You can mix anything in one button.

APPLIES TO	MEANING
Active spot	Whichever spot is selected when you press it. Use this for colour and position presets you want to reuse on any performer.
Spot: *name*	Always that spot.
All spots	Every spot.
Fixtures…	Exactly the fixtures you pick (click anywhere on a fixture's line to tick it).
All fixtures	Everything patched.

Parameters

- **Spot parameters**: *intensity*, *position X/Y*, *aim height* and *beam size*. A preset that sets position X/Y is a **position preset**: the spot glides there and the fixtures follow.

- **Fixture parameters**: anything in the profile, e.g. cyan, colour wheel, gobo, prism, frost. If the channel has named ranges, you can pick a slot (e.g. “Red”) next to the value.

While FOLLOW is on, a spot controls pan, tilt, zoom, focus, dimmer and shutter of its fixtures. Use the spot parameters (intensity, beam size, aim height) for those. The editor warns you if a line would clash.

Button types

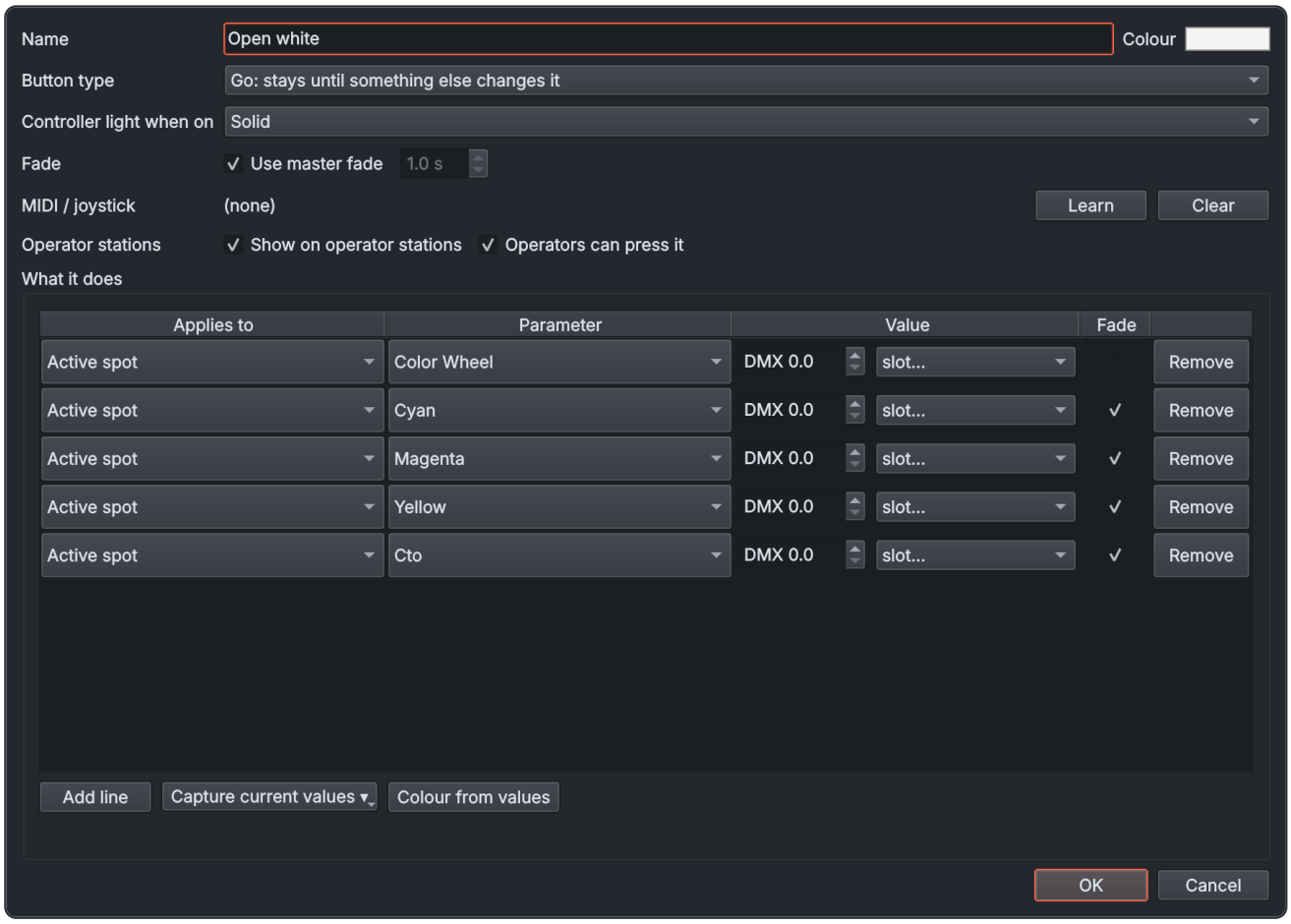
TYPE	BEHAVIOUR
Go	Sets the values. They stay until something else changes them. The button lights up while its values are live.
Toggle	Press to apply, press again to go back to how it was before.
Flash	Applies the values only while held.

Fades

- An executor uses the **Master fade** (top bar) or its own fade time.
- Each line has a **Fade** tick box. Colour wheels, gobo wheels, prisms and shutters snap by default, because fading a wheel scrolls through every slot in between.
- Position presets glide with an eased start and stop.

Making executors

- **Record ▾**: one click captures the active spot's *position*, *colour* or *beam* (gobo, prism, frost and so on) into the next free button. *Custom…* lets you pick fixtures and parameters. The editor then opens so you can name it.
- **Click an empty slot** to build one from scratch.
- **Right-click** a button to edit, learn MIDI or a joystick button, duplicate, copy or delete it.
- **Release all** turns off every toggle and flash executor.

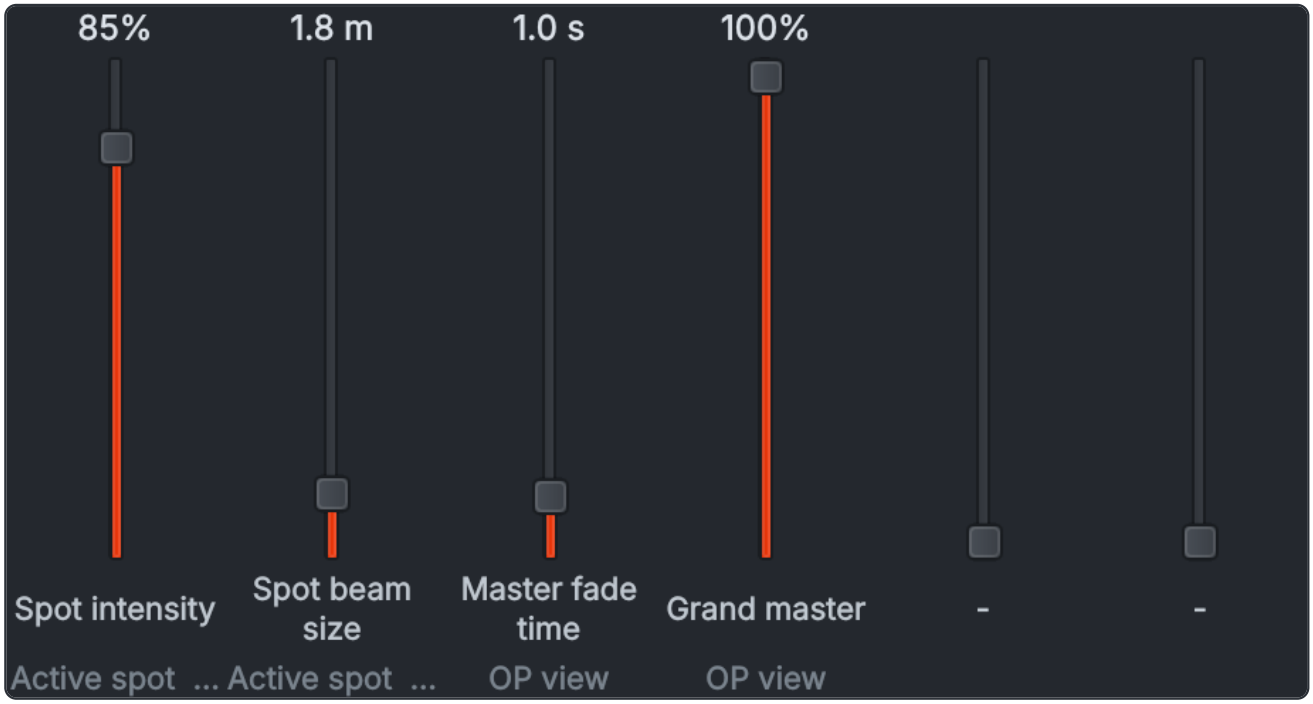


The executor editor. Each row is one line: what it applies to, the parameter, the value and whether it fades.

The editor

SETTING	MEANING
Name, **Colour**	What the button says and its colour. **Colour from values** colours the button from its CMY/RGB lines.
Button type	Go, Toggle or Flash.
Controller light when on	Solid, Blink or Pulse on a MIDI controller with lights, in the executor's colour.
Fade	**Use master fade**, or its own time.
MIDI / joystick	**Learn** a pad, key or joystick button for it; **Clear** removes it.
Operator stations	**Show on operator stations** and **Operators can press it**. See Executors for operator stations.
What it does	The lines. **Add line**, or **Capture current values ▾** to pull in live values.

Faders



There are **6 faders** next to the buttons. Double-click or right-click a fader to choose what it controls:

- Grand master
- Master fade time
- Spot intensity, beam size, zoom level (Manual zoom) or aim height: of the active spot, a named spot, or all spots
- Any fixture parameter (for example frost on the active spot's fixtures)
- The follow-wash master

Right-click → *Learn MIDI fader/knob* and move a fader or knob on your controller to put it on hardware.

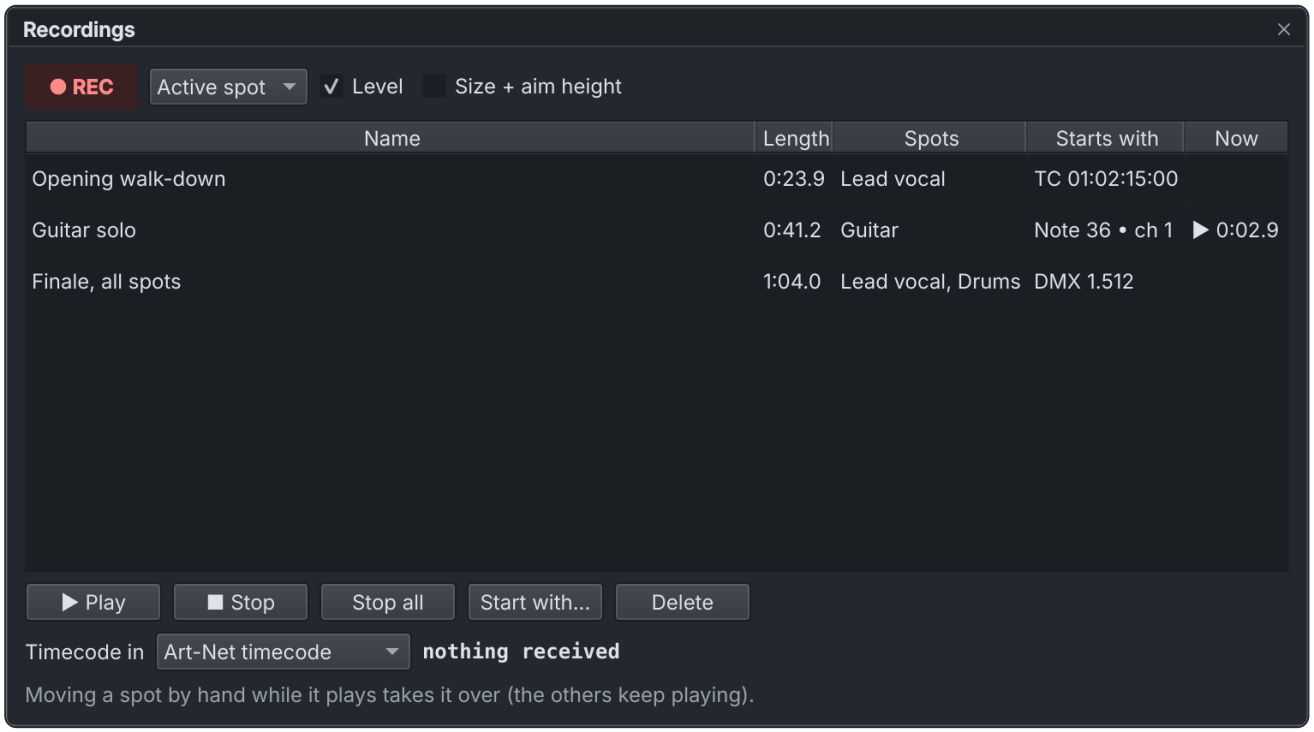
A GOOD STARTING SET

Fader 1 active spot intensity, 2 active spot beam size, 3 aim height, 4 master fade time, 5 follow washes, 6 grand master. Put the key presets of each song on page 1 and leave pages 2–4 for specials.

12

Record and play back

Record the spots while you follow a rehearsal, then play the moves back in the show: by hand, from the lighting desk, or locked to timecode. Very useful for theatre and for shows that repeat night after night.



The Recordings panel on the Follow page (**Menu → Recordings** puts it in the view you are on). "Guitar solo" is playing, started from MIDI note 36.

Record

1. Pick what to record: **Active spot** (with its multi-spot group) or **All spots**. Position is always recorded; tick **Level** and/or **Size + aim height** for those too.
2. Press ● **REC** and follow the rehearsal as usual. Anything that moves the spots is recorded: the mouse, the joystick, operator stations, phones, auto-track, executors.
3. Press ■ **STOP REC** and give the recording a name.

- Only what actually moved is kept. Spots that stood still and values that didn't change are left out, so a recording never pins a spot it doesn't need.
- Recordings are saved in the show file (25 samples a second, about 1 MB for 10 minutes of four spots).

- If timecode is running when you press REC, the recording is linked to it straight away, starting at that timecode.

Play

▶ **Play** (or double-click) plays the selected recording from the start; ■ **Stop** stops it, **Stop all** stops every recording. The **Now** column shows where each one is.

> **THE OPERATOR ALWAYS WINS.**
> The moment anyone moves a spot that is playing back (mouse, joystick, phone, operator station, an executor), that spot is let go and stays live. The other spots in the recording keep playing. FREEZE holds positions as usual. "Taken over from recording..." appears under Intensity in Spot settings.

Start from the desk or timecode

Select a recording and press **Start with...**:

TRIGGER	HOW IT WORKS
MIDI note / CC	Press **Learn**, then send the note or CC from the desk's MIDI out (or press a controller button). Each press starts or stops the recording. Desks with MIDI out: grandMA2/3, Avolites Titan, ChamSys MagicQ...
Desk DMX channel	Needs desk input. Patch a dummy 1-channel fixture on the desk at the universe and channel you choose. Channel at full = play from the start, back to 0 = stop. Put it in a cue and the recording starts with that cue.
Timecode	The recording runs while the timecode is between its start and its end, and **chases** it: jump back in the timecode and the spots jump back. When the timecode stops, the spots hold where they are.
Loop	Starts again at the end (manual, MIDI and DMX starts).

A MIDI binding can also stop everything: **MIDI tab → Recordings: stop all playback**.

Timecode input

At the bottom of the panel, **Timecode in** picks the source. It's a setting of this PC, not of the show.

- **MIDI timecode (MTC)**: on the same MIDI input as your controller (the MIDI tab). Works with any show-control software, QLab, a DAW or a timecode interface.
- **Art-Net timecode**: what grandMA, Avolites, ChamSys and most show-control software send on the lighting network. Send it as broadcast (or to this PC). With desk input on, FollowYou picks it up from there too.

The live timecode is shown next to the source, with ▶ while it runs. The Ready check tells you if a recording waits for timecode that isn't coming in.

> **OPERATOR STATIONS**
> Recordings live and play on the main station; operator stations see the spots move like any other change.

13

Video and auto-track

Press **Video** (top right of the plan) to open the Video panel. Instead of moving a dot on the plan, you drag on the performer in a camera picture, and **auto-track** can follow someone for you.

Which camera

CAMERA	NOTES
Webcams and HDMI-to-USB capture cards	Show up by name in the camera list. The Elgato Facecam is a good one: 1080p60, fixed focus that works from a few metres to the back of a stage, low delay.
GoPro (HERO9 and newer) over USB	On the GoPro set *Preferences → Connections → USB Connection* to **GoPro Connect** (not MTP), plug it in and pick **GoPro over USB (webcam mode)**. FollowYou starts the webcam stream itself. Pick the **lens** next to the camera list: **Linear** (default, no fisheye), **Narrow** or Wide (fisheye, avoid). Open the firewall once (**Tools → Windows Firewall**), because the picture arrives as network video.
Virtual cameras (OBS Virtual Camera, the GoPro Webcam app, NDI Webcam, vMix, Camo, XSplit…)	Show up **by name** with *(virtual camera)* after it. Start the virtual camera in its own app first (in OBS: **Start Virtual Camera**), then pick it and press Start. FollowYou takes the size the virtual camera sends, so set the output size in that app (1280×720 is plenty). Handy for a camera you already have in OBS, an NDI feed, or a picture with a crop.
DirectShow cameras	Other cameras that only Windows' older camera system can see are listed with *(DirectShow)* after the name.
Network stream	Any `rtsp://` or `http://` video address, e.g. an old phone with an IP-camera app. Cheap, but usually 0.2–0.5 s behind: too much for auto-track on fast movement.

- **720p** is plenty and lighter for the computer. Calibrate at the size you'll use in the show; another size of the same shape (720p ↔ 1080p) is fine.
- Long USB runs: use an *active* USB extension cable (passive ones stop at about 5 m).
- A virtual camera adds its own delay (often one or two frames from OBS). Calibrate on the picture the virtual camera sends, and keep the OBS scene the same afterwards: moving or cropping the source moves the picture, so calibrate again.
- If a virtual camera won't open: start it in its app first, close other programs using it, and press **Rescan**.

> **GOPRO OVER USB**
> This mode is new and hasn't been tested on a real GoPro yet. If it doesn't start, use the GoPro Webcam app and pick it from the list (*GoPro Webcam (virtual camera)*) instead. Calibrate again after changing the lens.

Where to put the camera

High, and looking down on the stage: on the FOH truss, a lighting stand at FOH above the audience's heads, or the front truss. A camera at eye height in front of the stage sees left/right very sharply but **front/back (depth) badly**: everybody's feet end up on nearly the same line of the picture.

The calibration tells you how good your position is, in cm per pixel, and warns if the camera is low. Rough guide for a 10 × 8 m stage, camera 12 m from the front edge:

CAMERA HEIGHT	FRONT/BACK ACCURACY
4 m	≈ 13 cm per pixel
6 m	≈ 8 cm per pixel
On a truss over the stage	far better

Left/right is around 2 cm per pixel anywhere. Mount it firmly. **If the camera moves, calibrate again.**

Calibrate (once per venue, about a minute)

1. Tape the stage marks on the floor: the same marks as for the alignment. The 3 × 3 grid is best.
2. Pick the camera, press **Start**, then **Calibrate**.
3. **Zoom in on the stage first** if it's small in the picture (wide GoPro, camera far back): it makes the clicks several times more precise.
4. FollowYou says which mark to click (“Click on mark: DSR”). Click the middle of that tape cross. It moves on to the next mark by itself. Drag a dot to move it, right-click a dot to remove it, and ◀ ▶ skip a mark you can't see.
5. From 4 marks on (6+ recommended, spread over the whole stage) it works out where the camera is and what the lens does.
6. Leave **Lens** on *Auto*. Type the field of view only if you have very few marks (Facecam ≈ 82°, GoPro Linear ≈ 87°).
7. Save the show. The calibration is stored in it, with the camera's name. On an operator station it's stored on that station instead, since its camera is its own.

Reading the calibration

- *Clicks fit within X px*: under 3 px is good. A mark listed under **Check** is probably clicked on the wrong cross.
- Where it thinks the camera is (metres in front of the stage, across, how high). Compare with reality: that's the quickest sanity check.
- **cm per pixel** left/right and front/back at centre stage.
- Blue crosses show where the calibration puts each mark, and the stage outline and 1 m grid are drawn over the picture. They should sit on the real floor.

Zoom and framing

- **Zoom slider**, **+ / –** buttons or keys, or the **mouse wheel** (zooms around the pointer), up to ×8.
- **Move the picture**: Alt +drag (works on a touchpad) or middle-drag.
- **Fit** or Home = the whole picture again.
- The framing is saved with the camera setup, in the show.

Zooming only changes what you see: the calibration and clicks stay exact at any zoom, and auto-track always looks at the whole picture.

Following on the picture

Every spot is drawn as a **ghost**: a ring on the floor where the performer stands, a 1.8 m line (a person), a **dot at the spot's aim height** and the spot's name. Solid = the spot is on, dashed = off. The active spot is drawn thicker.

- **Drag on the performer at the dot's height** (their chest, if aim height is 1.4 m), not anywhere on the body. Where you click on a person changes how far away FollowYou thinks they are, so click consistently at that height.
- **Click at their feet** (option at the top) is the most accurate in depth when you can see the floor. With feet hidden (monitors, audience heads), use aim height.
- Ctrl -drag or **Lock depth**: only move left/right and keep the spot's distance from the front. That's the sharp direction for a front camera, and great for a singer walking along the front edge.
- **Right-click** a ghost to make it the active spot; 1–9 pick spots; Space = spot on/off; **Stage grid** shows or hides the floor grid.
- The line under the picture shows **how many cm one pixel is** at the active spot (green = sharp, orange = OK, red = rough).
- Clicks on a riser use its height automatically.

Auto-track

1. Put the spot's ghost on the performer (feet in the ring, dot on the chest), by dragging on the picture or on the plan, and press **Auto-track** or T. Or simply **double-click the performer** in the picture: the active spot goes to them and locks on.
2. The spot follows. Drag on the picture and let go to lock onto someone else.

How it follows

Every camera picture, a body model finds the people in it (up to 6) with their joints: head, shoulders, elbows, hips, knees, ankles. Tick **People** to see them drawn as skeletons; the tracked one is drawn in its spot's colour. Each spot picks “its” performer by combining:

- **where they should be now** (last position plus walking speed and direction),
- **what their clothes look like** (the colour of the chest between shoulders and hips),
- **whether the body has the right size** for that place on stage.

The position comes from the performer's **feet** when the ankles are seen, otherwise from their hips or shoulders at that performer's own measured heights. Several tracked spots are matched together, so two performers walking side by side keep their own spots, and two spots never take the same person. If the

body points are lost (behind a monitor, very dark), it switches to a colour tracker, labelled “(colours)”, and back again as soon as the performer is found.

What the states mean

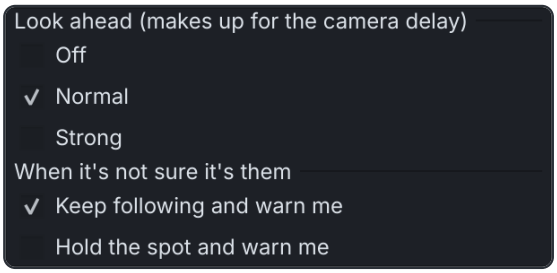
STATE	MEANING
TRACKING (body) TRACKING (colours)	It's following.
HOLDING	It isn't sure (two people close together, someone walks in front, a sudden jump). The spot stays still and carries on by itself once it's sure again.
SEARCHING	It lost them (hidden, left the picture, a blackout, a big light change). The spot stays where it was, and it keeps looking within the distance the performer could have walked. It locks on again by itself when someone clearly has the performer's clothes and build. **Double-click them** to help it, or press T to stop.
LOST	The tracker stopped answering and was restarted (after about 2 s). The spots held still meanwhile: drag or double-click onto the performers to lock on again.

How sure it is

While it tracks, a small bar under the box shows how sure it is that it's still on the right performer: **green** = sure, **amber** = fairly sure, **red** = not sure. The line under the picture says it in words with a percentage (“Anna: TRACKING (body), fairly sure 62%”). It looks at how well the body fits where they should be, how well the clothes match, and how clearly they stand out from the others nearby.

When it stays **not sure** for a moment (someone in the same clothes walks close, two performers cross), the box turns into NOT SURE IT'S THEM , FollowYou beeps once, and the same warning shows on the plan (an amber **?** on that spot) and in the Safety panel. Look at the picture: if it's on the wrong person, drag onto the right one. If it's right, do nothing and the warning goes away when it's sure again.

The Tracking menu



The **Tracking** button next to Auto-track has two settings, remembered on this computer:

SETTING	CHOICES
Look ahead	A camera picture is always a little late, so a running performer outruns the spot. Look ahead aims the spot a bit ahead of where they're going to make up for it. **Normal** (default) suits webcams and capture cards. **Strong** leads more, for slow cameras (GoPro, network streams) and fast runs. **Off** follows exactly where the camera saw them. It only leads when they move steadily in one direction, and it eases off as they slow down, so the spot doesn't overshoot when they stop.

SETTING	CHOICES
When it's not sure it's them	**Keep following and warn me** (default): the spot carries on, and you get the warning. **Hold the spot and warn me**: the spot stops where it is (NOT SURE IT'S THEM - HOLDING) until it's sure again, or until you drag onto the performer.

Rules it always keeps

- **It never switches a spot on or off** and never touches intensity. You stay in charge of the light.
- It would rather hold than guess.
- The spot moves **at most 4 m/s**, so a glitch can't whip the light across the stage.
- **Any other move of that spot stops auto-track at once**: plan, joystick, executors, phones, operator stations. **FREEZE** makes it hold.
- Esc stops all auto-tracking.

> **IT'S AN ASSIST**
> At most 6 people are found per picture. Two performers in the same clothes who cross or hug can fool it (it usually holds). Haze, heavy strobes and blackouts make it hold or switch to colours. Performers small in the picture (under about 50 pixels tall) are found less reliably. Keep your hand near the mouse.

Speed: the body model takes about 20–40 ms per picture on a normal computer, shared by all spots (the line under the picture shows it). The colour tracker adds 20–35 ms per spot while it's in use. The body model is MoveNet MultiPose by Google (Apache 2.0).

Shared cameras: several operators on one camera

A camera on the **server** (side stage, in the rig and wired back to the rack, a network camera) or on **any station** can be used by the other stations linked to the same server. Every operator follows, and auto-tracks, **their own spot** on it, so several spots can run on one camera. Handy when FOH has no good view.

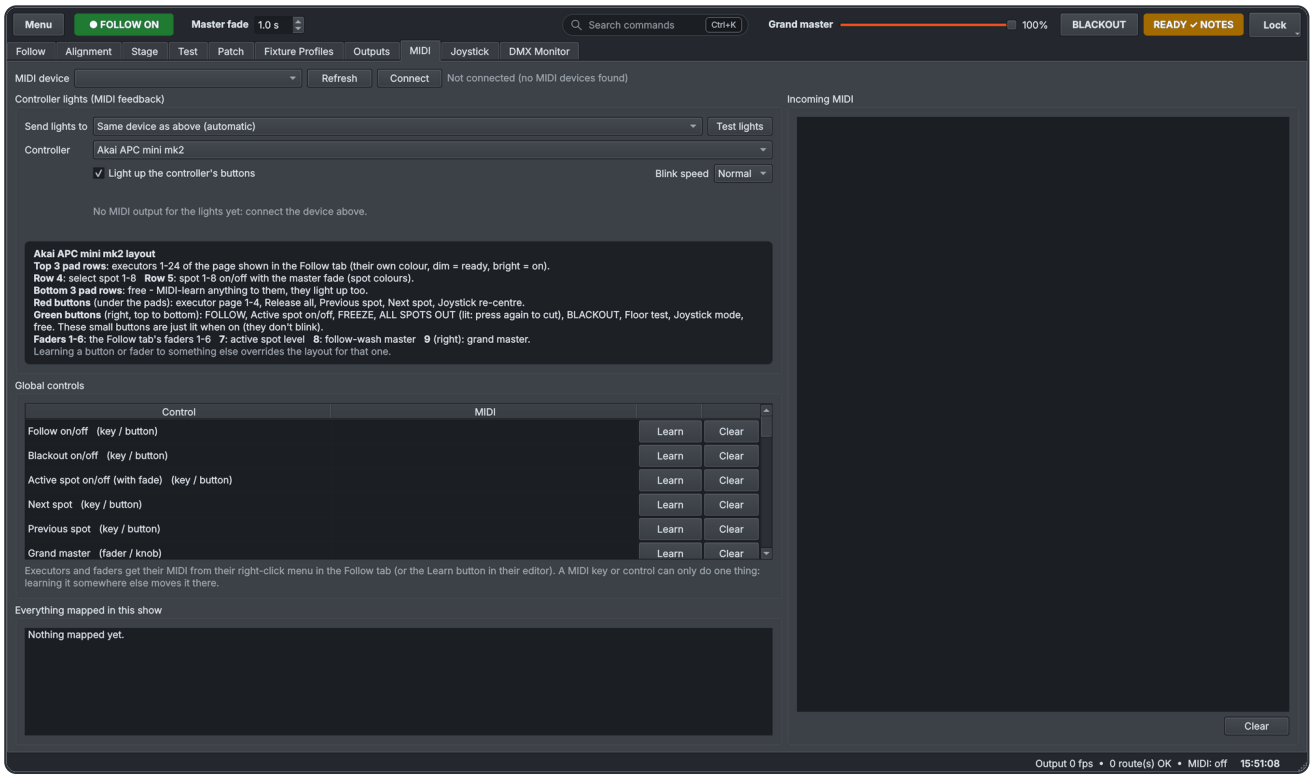
1. On the PC with the camera: start it in the Video panel, calibrate it as usual and press **Share**.
2. On the other stations: the camera list shows **Shared: <camera> (on <PC>)**. Pick it and press **Start**. The picture comes through the server with the camera's calibration, ready to follow on.

- The arrow next to **Share**: **who may use it** (every linked station, until you untick one; unticking cuts it off at once), who is **watching now**, and **Start this camera when FollowYou starts** for a rack PC nobody sits at.
- The picture is sent up to 15 times a second, 960 pixels wide. Auto-track runs on each operator's own PC, so the camera's PC isn't slowed down by more operators.
- Your **zoom** on the picture is your own. **Calibrate** on a station that uses a shared camera sends the calibration back to the camera's PC, for everyone.
- Shared cameras need the server: a station working on its own has nobody to share with.

14

MIDI controllers

A MIDI controller puts executors, faders and the important switches under your fingers, with lights that show what is on.



The MIDI tab: device and controller lights at the top, the controller's layout, global controls, and incoming MIDI on the right.

Connecting

1. Plug the controller in, go to the **MIDI** tab, pick it under **MIDI device** and press **Connect**. Next time it reconnects automatically if it's plugged in.
2. Known controllers are recognised by name and get their ready-made layout straight away (**Controller**: *Auto-detect*, or pick one).
3. Press a pad: it shows under **Incoming MIDI**, so you can check the controller is talking.

On Windows, MIDI uses the built-in Windows MIDI system, so nothing extra needs installing. **Only one program can use a MIDI device at a time**, so close other software that has the controller open.

Learning buttons and faders

- **Executor**: right-click it → *Learn MIDI / joystick button*, then press a pad or key.
- **Fader**: right-click it → *Learn MIDI fader/knob*, then move a fader or knob.
- **Global controls** (MIDI tab): press **Learn** next to a control and press or move the control on your controller. **Clear** removes it.

Notes and CC both work for buttons (CC: 64 and above = pressed). Each MIDI control can only do one thing; learning it somewhere else moves it. **Everything mapped in this show** lists all of it. Learning a button or fader overrides the controller's ready-made layout for that one control only.

Global controls

CONTROL	TYPE
Follow on/off	button
Blackout on/off	button
Active spot on/off (with fade)	button
Next spot / Previous spot	button
Grand master	fader
Active spot intensity	fader
Master fade time	fader
Joystick: re-centre (fix drift)	button
Joystick: toggle speed / position mode	button
Joystick: fine control (hold)	hold
Freeze positions on/off	button
ALL SPOTS OUT (press twice = cut)	button
Release all executors	button
Floor test on/off	button
Select spot 1–8	button
Spot 1–8 on/off (with fade)	button

Controller lights

FollowYou lights up the controller's buttons to show what is on (**Controller lights** in the MIDI tab, **Light up the controller's buttons**).

- **Send lights to**: normally *Same device as above (automatic)*; it finds the controller's MIDI output by itself. *Nowhere* turns lights off.

- **Controller**: *Auto-detect* picks the right preset. *Generic* works with most controllers: a lit button gets note-on velocity 127, an unlit one 0, on the same note and channel the button sends. Some cheap controllers only light a button while it's pressed and can't be lit from outside.
- **Dim** = ready, **bright** = on. FOLLOW and Floor test light when on; FREEZE, BLACKOUT and ALL SPOTS OUT (while “press again to cut” is armed) **blink**. Spot buttons use the spot's colour.
- Each executor has **Controller light when on: Solid / Blink / Pulse** in its editor, in the executor's own colour.
- **Blink speed**: Slow / Normal / Fast (half a blink, one, or two blinks a second).
- **Test lights** runs a rainbow over the controller to check it's connected.
- While the desk is locked, the pads slowly fade red up and down; a green wave runs over them when it's unlocked. The controller goes dark when FollowYou closes.

Akai APC mini mk2 (recommended)

Plug it in, pick it in the MIDI tab and press Connect. It's detected automatically and gets this layout, in exact colours:



APC mini mk2: what each part of the controller does in FollowYou.

WHERE	WHAT
Top 3 pad rows	Executors 1–24 of the page shown in the Follow tab
Pad row 4	Select spot 1–8
Pad row 5	Spot 1–8 on/off with the master fade
Bottom 3 pad rows	Free: MIDI-learn anything to them (they light up too)
Red buttons (under the pads)	Executor page 1–4, Release all, Previous spot, Next spot, Joystick re-centre
Green buttons (right, top to bottom)	FOLLOW, Active spot on/off, FREEZE, ALL SPOTS OUT, BLACKOUT, Floor test, Joystick mode, free
Faders 1–6	The Follow tab's faders 1–6
Fader 7 / 8 / 9 (right)	Active spot level / Follow-wash master / Grand master

The executor page on the controller and on screen are the same: change it on either. On the APC mini the small single-colour buttons (above the faders and on the right) don't blink: they're simply lit when on.

Other ready-made controllers

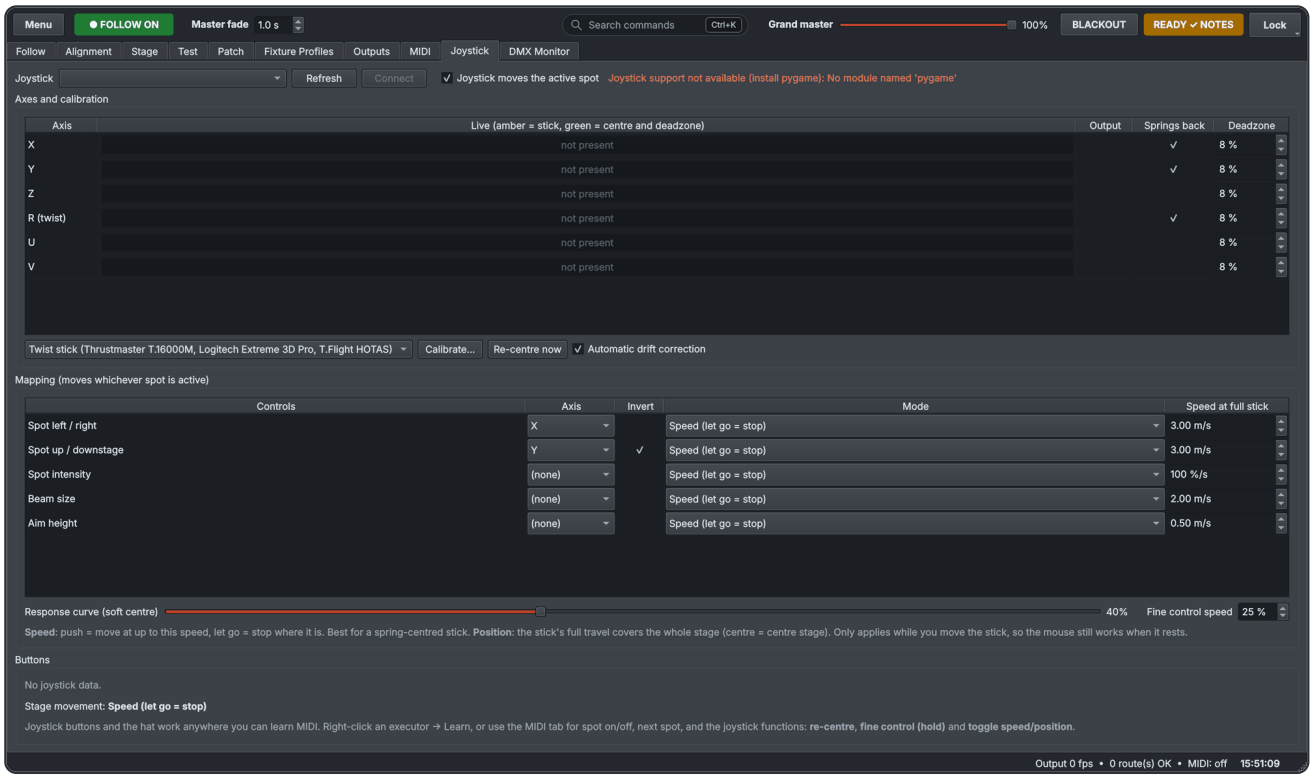
CONTROLLER	LAYOUT
Akai APC mini (mk1)	The same layout as the mk2.
Novation Launchpad Mini MK3 and **Launchpad X**	The same 8 × 8 grid layout as the APC mini. The top row of round buttons: page 1–4, Release all, Previous spot, Next spot, Joystick re-centre. The right-hand column: the same switches as the APC's green buttons. FollowYou puts it in Programmer mode itself. No faders.
Korg nanoKONTROL2	Faders 1–6 = the Follow tab's faders, 7 = active spot level, 8 = grand master; knobs 1 and 2 = follow-wash master and master fade. S buttons = executors 1–8, M = select spot 1–8, R = spot 1–8 on/off. Transport: play = FOLLOW, stop = ALL SPOTS OUT, record = BLACKOUT, cycle = FREEZE, ◀◀ / ▶▶ = previous / next spot, track ◀ / ▶ = executor page, marker set / ◀ / ▶ = Release all / Joystick re-centre / Floor test. For the button lights, set *LED Mode* to External once in the KORG KONTROL Editor.

The APC mini mk2 layout is tested on the real controller; the other layouts are made from the makers' MIDI documentation.

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Joystick

A joystick is the most natural way to follow by hand: push to move, twist for beam size, throttle for intensity.



The Joystick tab: axes with live bars and deadzones at the top, the mapping below.

Connecting and calibrating

FollowYou works with any USB joystick, flight stick or gamepad that Windows sees (check in Windows' *Set up USB game controllers*). Nothing extra needs installing.

1. In the **Joystick** tab, pick it and press **Connect**. It reconnects automatically, including if the cable gets pulled mid-show.
2. A stick FollowYou knows loads its preset by itself. To load one by hand: **Load a preset...**.
3. **Calibrate...**: let go of the stick (it measures the centre), then move the stick, twist and throttle to all their limits and press **Finish**.
4. Check the **Mapping** with the live bars. Windows numbers the axes differently for some models, and any axis can be changed in the table.

By default X moves the spot left/right and Y moves it up/downstage, with pushing forward going upstage. Untick **Joystick moves the active spot** to ignore the stick without disconnecting it.

Ready-made presets

- **Twist stick**: Thrustmaster T.16000M, Logitech Extreme 3D Pro, Thrustmaster T.Flight HOTAS.
- **Xbox controller** (and other XInput gamepads).
- **PlayStation controller** (DualShock 4 / DualSense).

What the axes can do

Each of these can be put on an axis: **Spot left / right**, **Spot up / downstage**, **Spot intensity**, **Beam size** and **Aim height**. Each mapping has an **Invert** tick, a **Mode** and a **Speed at full stick**.

MODE	HOW IT WORKS	BEST FOR
Speed (let go = stop)	Push = move, how far you push = how fast (up to *Speed at full stick*), let go = it stops where it is. **Response curve** makes small movements extra fine.	A self-centring stick (default).
Position (full stick = full range)	The stick's full travel = the whole stage, so stick centre is centre stage. It only takes over while you move it, so the mouse still works when the stick is resting.	A throttle used for intensity.

- A **lever that stays where you leave it** (throttle, slider: *Springs back* unticked) always works in Position mode. In Speed mode it would never stop pushing.
- In Position mode the lever only takes control when you **move it on purpose** (about 2.5 % of its travel). As soon as anything else changes that value (Off button, MIDI, a fader, an executor, the mouse), the lever lets go until you move it again. A lever resting at the top can't hold a spot on, and noise from a worn lever never yanks the spot back.

Drift at centre

- **Deadzone** per axis: small movements around the centre are ignored. The green band in the live view shows it. 8 % is a good start; raise it for a worn stick.
- **Automatic drift correction**: while the stick rests inside the deadzone, its centre quietly follows the real resting position, so slow drift never builds up.
- **Re-centre now**: if the stick rests *outside* the deadzone and the spot creeps, let go and press this. Better: map a joystick button to *Joystick: re-centre* in the MIDI tab, so you can fix it mid-show without touching the mouse.
- **Springs back**: tick for sticks that return to the middle, untick for throttles that stay where you leave them.

Buttons and the hat

Joystick buttons and the hat are learned exactly like MIDI: right-click an executor → *Learn MIDI / joystick button* and press the button. The MIDI tab's global controls include joystick-only functions:

- **Joystick: re-centre**

- **Joystick: fine control (hold)**: everything moves at the *Fine control speed* (25 % by default) while held. Great on the trigger.
- **Joystick: toggle speed / position mode**

> **WHERE IT'S SAVED**
> Joystick settings are saved on this PC, not in the show file, because they belong to the hardware. Button mappings to executors are saved in the show.

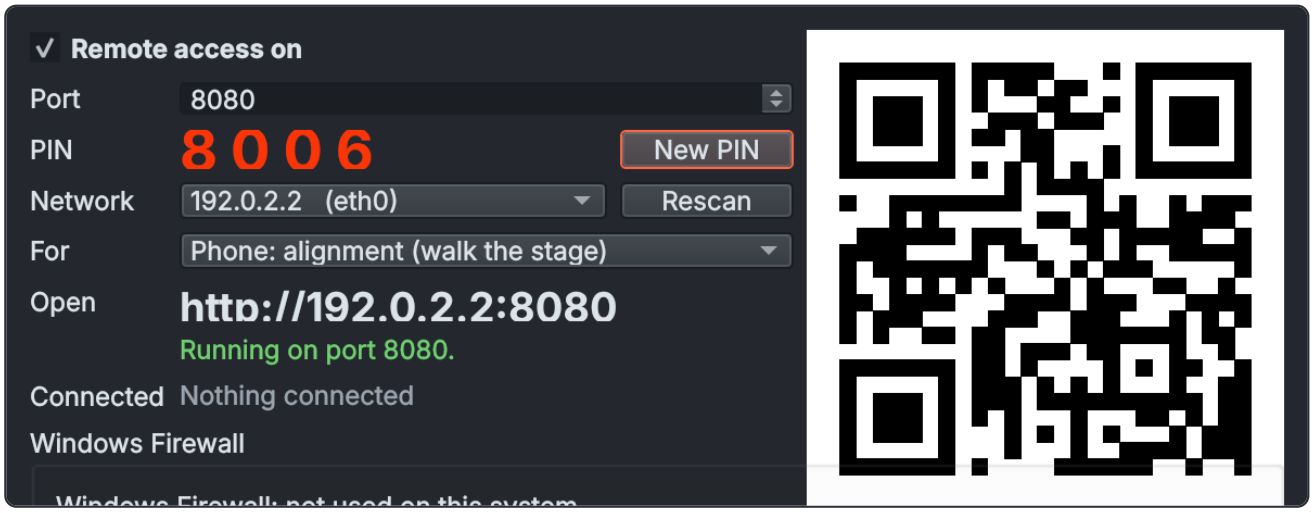
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Phones, tablets and operator stations

One station does the DMX output: the **main station**. Phones, tablets and other PCs can drive spots through it.

Remote access

Turn on **Menu → Phones and remote access** on the main station and note the PIN.



Remote access: the PIN, the network, what the QR code opens, and who is connected.

- **Remote access on**: starts it. It remembers being on and starts again with FollowYou.
- **Port**: default 8080. After changing it, open the firewall again.
- **PIN**: 4 digits. **New PIN** locks out phones that knew the old one.
- **Network**: the network the phones are on (**Rescan** after joining one).
- **For**: what the QR code opens: *Phone: alignment (walk the stage)*, *Phone / tablet: follow spot* or *Another computer as operator station*.
- **Connected**: every phone and station that's connected.

Everyone can work on the same spots; the last change wins, and every screen shows who is driving which spot (e.g. "Singer ← Station-2").

NO WI-FI AT THE VENUE?

Turn on Windows **Mobile hotspot** on the main station, join it with the phones, then pick the hotspot network in the Remote access window (usually 192.168.137.1).

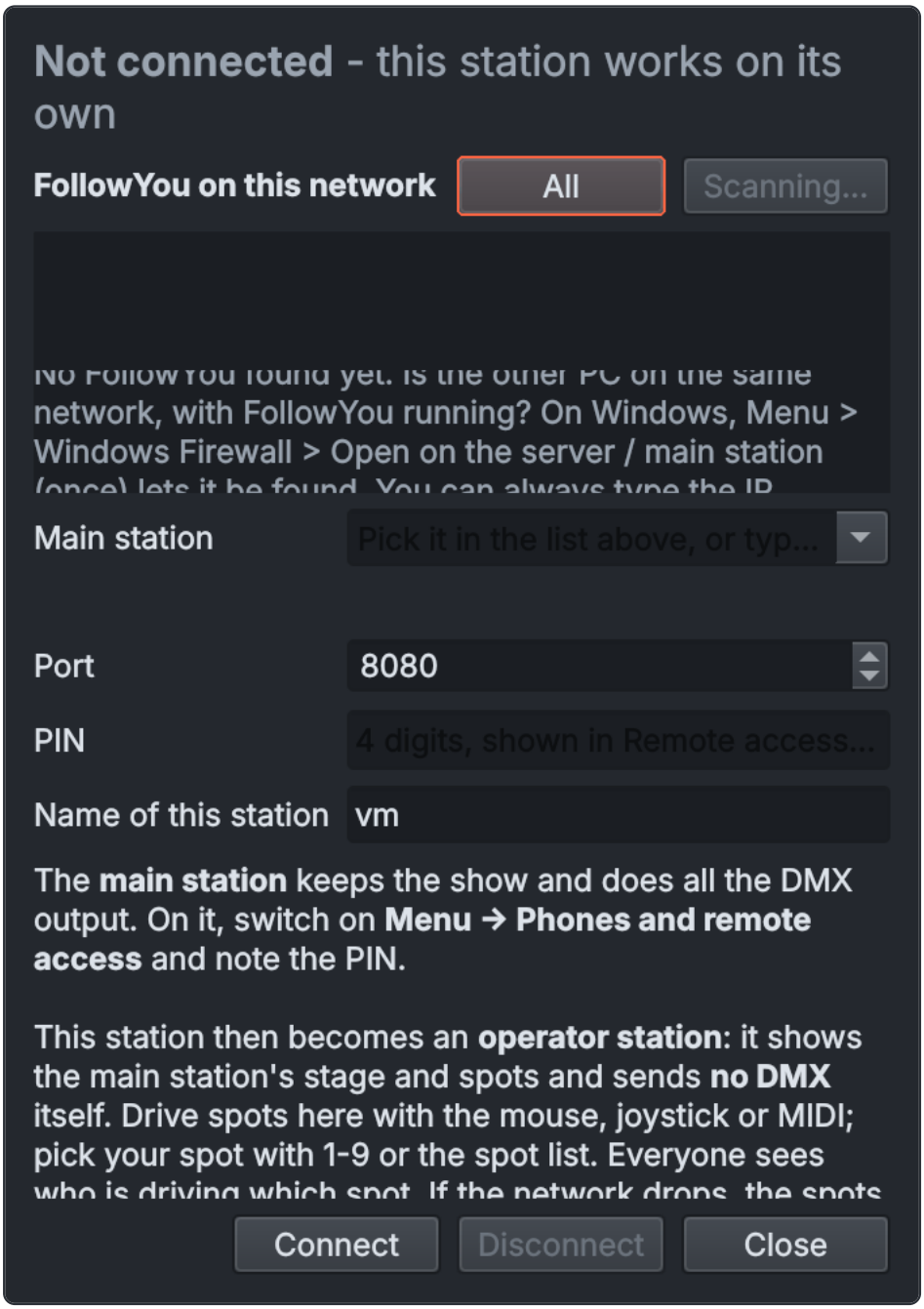
Follow spot from a phone or tablet

In Remote access pick *Phone / tablet: follow spot* and scan the QR code, or open `http://<address>:8080/follow`. This page is separate from the alignment page.

- Tap a spot at the top, then drag on the stage plan.
- **Trackpad** (default): drag anywhere; Slow / Normal / Fast sets the speed and two fingers make it 4× finer. **Touch = position**: the spot goes where your finger is.
- **ON/OFF** uses the master fade, **FULL** fades to full, plus a level slider, beam size and aim height.
- Options: turn the plan round (audience at the top), the name shown on the main station, and ALL SPOTS OUT.
- Phone browser menu → **Add to Home screen** gives a full-screen app icon.

Operator stations

A second (third…) PC runs FollowYou too and drives spots with its own mouse, joystick and MIDI, while the main station keeps doing all the DMX output.



1. Main station: **Menu → Phones and remote access**, tick it on.
2. Operator station: **Menu → Connect to a main station**, click the main station in the list of FollowYou on the network (or type its IP), enter the PIN and a **Name of this station**, then **Connect**.
3. The operator station gets the main station's stage, spots and alignment. Pick your spot (1–9, the spot list or the spot strip) and follow. FOLLOW ON/OFF, Space, ALL SPOTS OUT and FREEZE all work from here too.

On an operator station

- It sends **no DMX**: its outputs are switched off while connected.
- Setting up (patch, alignment, stage, outputs, adding spots) happens on the main station, and so does editing executors. The show is saved there too.

- **"Active spot" means the operator's own spot**: "Spot ON" pressed on an operator station that's on the Singer turns the Singer on. Buttons light up when they're live on the main station. An APC mini on the operator station presses (and lights) its executors too.
- Spot faders (intensity, beam size, aim height, zoom) work on the operator's own spot straight away; the others (e.g. grand master) are moved on the main station.
- **Multi-spot** works too if the main station allows it (**Operators ▾ → Operators may control several spots at once**). Each station has its own group.
- If the network drops, a **red bar** says so and it reconnects by itself. On the main station the spots **hold where they are**, and the Safety panel shows the station as LOST.
- **Disconnect** (same window) returns the station to working on its own, with no show loaded and no DMX output.
- Operator stations don't need a licence of their own.

> **NETWORK**
> Both stations must be on the same network, by cable or Wi-Fi. A cable or a small switch is the most reliable for shows.

Executors for operator stations

On the main station, **Operators ▾** in the executor panel chooses what operator stations get:

- **Operators use the main executors**: they get the main executors. Each executor has two options (right-click → *Operator stations*, or in its editor):
  - **Show on operator stations**: they see it, and see it light up.
  - **Operators can press it**: off = they see it, marked *main*, but only the main station can run it.

  On the main station, buttons operators can press are marked **OP**, view-only ones **OP view**. Both are on for new executors.
- **One executor bank for all operators**: every operator station gets the bank *All operators*.
- **A separate bank for each operator**: an operator station gets the bank with its name (the name it connects with), or *All operators* if it has none.

Building banks

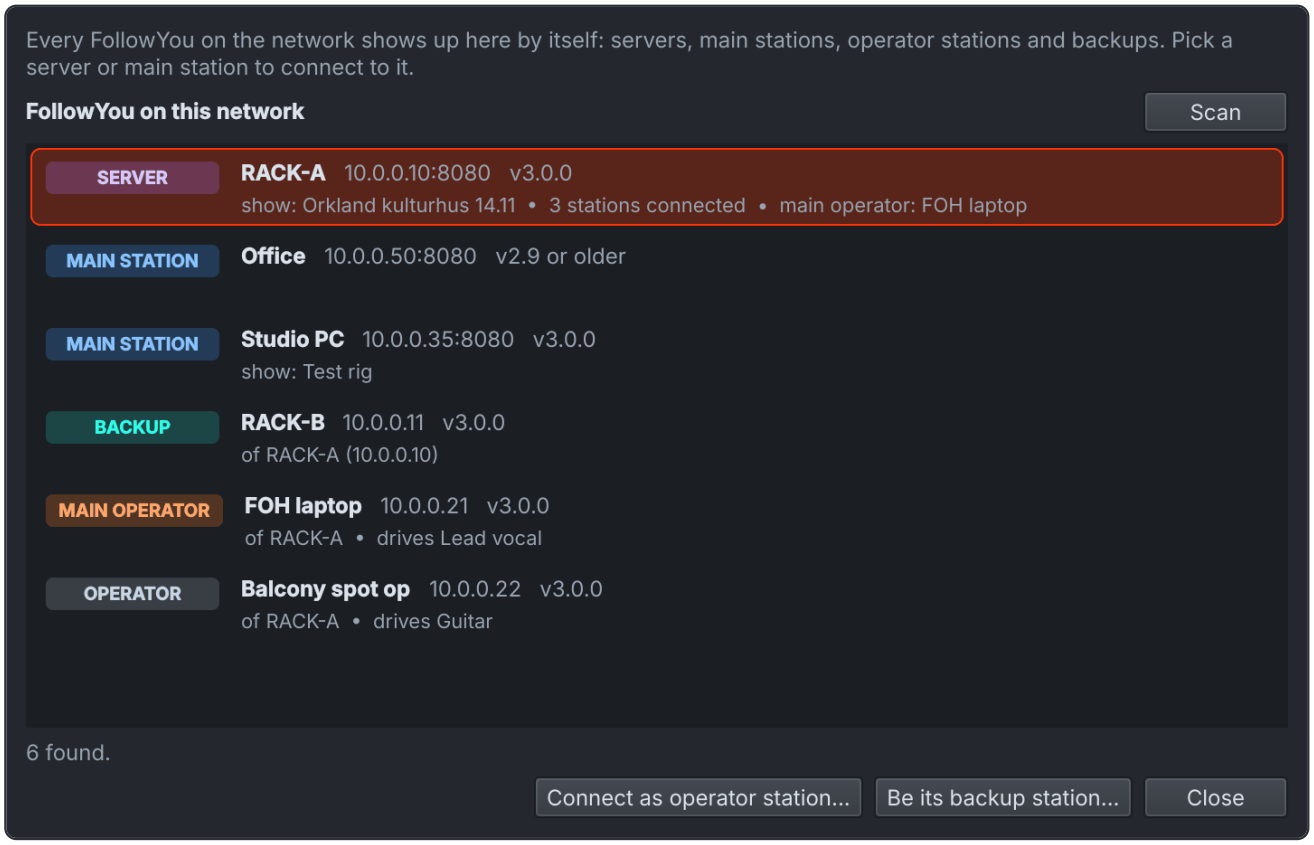
- **Operators ▾ → Show / edit** picks which bank the executor grid shows (it says *Editing bank: …* above the buttons). Make executors there as usual. Pressing them on the main station runs them with the main station's active spot, so you can try them.
- **New bank for an operator…**: pick a connected operator station or type its name; it can start as a copy of *All operators*.
- **Copy / Paste**: right-click an executor → *Copy*, then right-click a slot in any bank → *Paste*. **Copy to bank** puts a copy straight into another bank.
- **Copy '…' to** copies a whole bank to another operator, or to every operator bank. From the main bank it copies the executors marked *Show on operator stations*.
- **Rename** / **Delete** a bank in the same menu.

Faders work the same way. With *Operators use the main executors*, each fader has **Show on operator stations** and **Operators can move it**; spot faders can be moved by operators, the others only shown,

unless you change it. In an operator bank the six faders are that bank's own; a new bank starts with the operator's spot intensity, beam size and aim height.

Banks are saved in the show. Each operator station has its **own toggles and flashes**, even in a shared bank: one operator's press never turns another operator's toggle off.

FollowYou on the network



Menu → FollowYou on the network: every FollowYou found, with what it is and what it's doing.

Every FollowYou tells the local network once a second what it is: **server**, **main station**, **backup**, **main operator**, **operator** or a station on its own. So nobody needs to carry an IP address around: the connect windows list them to pick from.

- **Connect to a main station** and **Backup station** show the servers and main stations you can connect to. Click one: its address and port are filled in and the cursor waits in the PIN box. **All** shows the others too.
- **Menu → FollowYou on the network** shows everyone, with the show, how many stations are connected, the main operator, which station drives which spot and the version. Pick a server and **Connect as operator station** or **Be its backup station**.
- **Scan** asks the network straight away (and finds FollowYou 2.9 and older too). Otherwise the list fills by itself.
- It only says who is there. Connecting still needs the PIN, and phones aren't listed (they use the QR code).

> **NOTHING FOUND?**
> The other PC must be on the same network with FollowYou running. On Windows, **Open firewall for FollowYou** once on the server / main station lets it be found. You can always type the IP address.

Windows Firewall

Phones and operator stations have to get through the main station's firewall. In **Menu → Phones and remote access** (or **Menu → Windows Firewall**):

- **Open firewall for FollowYou** asks Windows for administrator approval, then allows FollowYou's remote-access port (TCP) and *FollowYou on the network* (UDP 47821). Only **devices on the local network** are let in, on every network type (venue networks are often “Public”). It also lets in the picture from a GoPro on USB (UDP 8554, local only).
- If someone once pressed *Cancel* on Windows' “allow this app?” prompt, Windows made a rule that blocks it. That rule beats everything else, so it is switched off too (and remembered).
- **Put firewall back to normal** removes FollowYou's rules and switches those old block rules on again.
- The window shows whether the firewall is open, and warns if it was opened for a different port.

Operator stations don't need this: they only connect out. After updating to 3.0, open the firewall once more on the main station, so it can be found on the network.

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Server, backup station and server mode

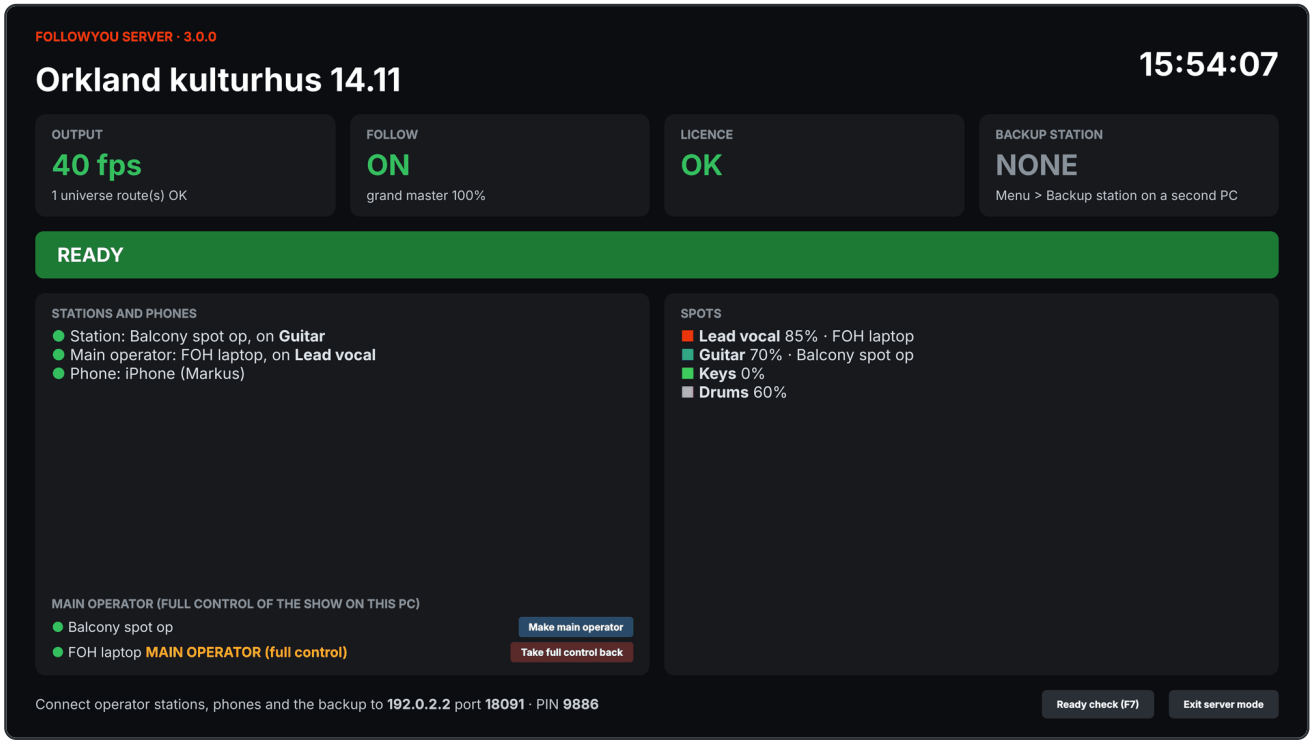
For shows that can't go dark: a rack PC as the show's server (it keeps the show, the licence and the DMX output, while you work on a laptop at FOH), plus a second PC standing by that takes over if it dies.

The setup

- **Main station (server)**: a rack or desktop PC near the network switch. It keeps the show and does all the DMX output. It runs in server mode.
- **Backup station**: a second PC on the same network with FollowYou installed. It copies the show and follows everything live.
- **Operator stations, phones, controllers**: connect to the main station as usual (Operator stations). If the main station dies, they move over to the backup by themselves.

> **OUTPUT SERVER**
> The *Output server* of 2.9.1 (a rack PC doing the output for a laptop that kept the show) is gone in 3.0. A server with a main operator does the same job, with the show, the licence and the output all on the rack PC.

Main operator: the server is in charge

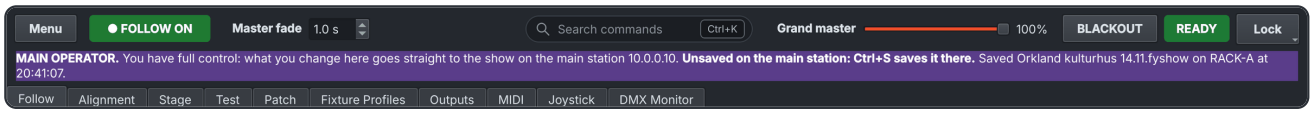


The server picks the main operator (bottom left). Here the FOH laptop has full control.

The usual way to run a rack PC: the **server** (the main station) keeps the show, the **licence** (the USB key goes in the server) and the DMX output. Everyone who connects (operator stations and phones) runs on the server's licence, so laptops don't need their own key.

The server then picks one operator station as the **main operator**. That station can change **everything** in the show on the server, as if it were sitting at the server: patch, stage and marks, alignment, spots, executors, faders, outputs and recordings. It can also save the show there.

1. On the server: start server mode with the show (or an empty show) and Remote access on.
2. On the laptop: **Menu → Connect to a main station**, pick the server in the list and connect.
3. On the server screen, under **Main operator**, press **Make main operator** next to that laptop.

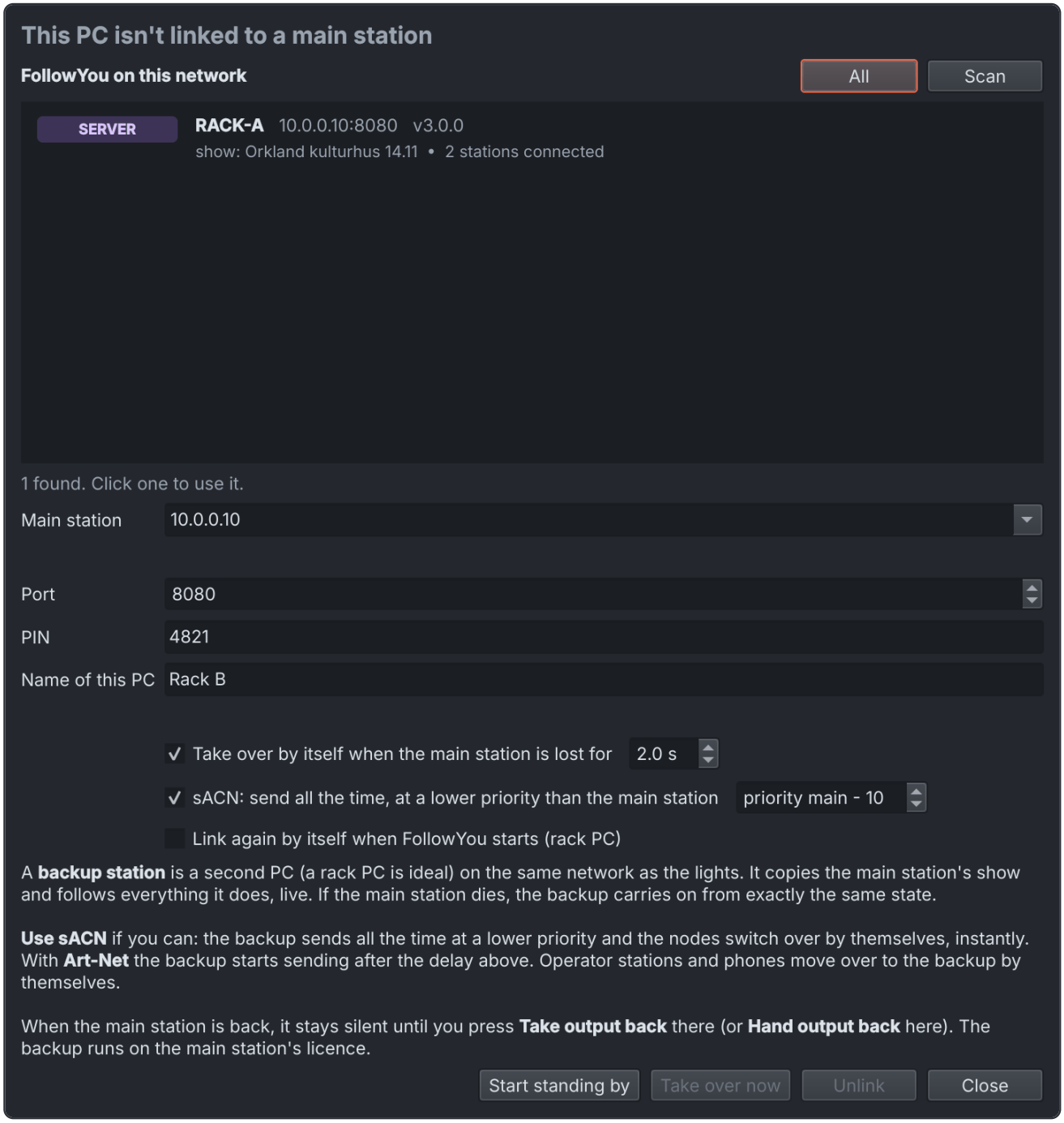


On the laptop: every tab opens up, and a purple bar says it has full control.

- **Changes go straight to the server.** Every edit is sent within half a second. The server swaps it in without the lights noticing: spots, FOLLOW, executors that are on, recordings that play and every DMX value carry on.
- **Save** (Ctrl + S) saves the show **on the server**. If the server's show has never been saved, it goes to *Documents\FollowYou* on the server (**Save as** asks for the name). The bar says when it was last saved.
- **Open show** / **New show** on the main operator replace the show on the server (it asks first).
- **Grand master**, **Blackout** and **Recordings** (REC, play, timecode input) work on the server.

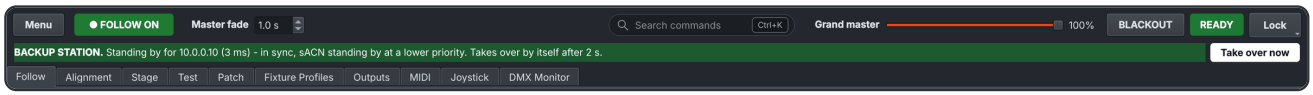
- **Alignment, Test and the Wash tab move the real lights**: what you do by hand on the laptop is sent to the server straight away. **Phone alignment** works from the laptop too: turn on Remote access on the laptop and scan its code.
- **Lock all** locks every station, phone and the server; unlocking on the main operator unlocks them all again.
- Only one main operator at a time. It keeps full control when it reconnects. **Take full control back** on the server makes it a normal operator station again.
- Each PC keeps its own camera setup (video). A camera on the server can be shared with the operator stations.

Backup station



Menu → Backup station on the backup PC.

1. On the main station: turn on **Menu → Phones and remote access** and note the PIN.
2. On the backup PC: open **Menu → Backup station**, click the main station in the list (or type its IP), enter the PIN and press **Start standing by**.
3. The backup loads the main station's show (patch, outputs, alignment, executors, recordings) and shows a green bar. From now on it mirrors everything 40 times a second: every spot, FOLLOW, Freeze, grand master, blackout and every DMX value.



While standing by, the backup's controls are greyed out: nothing should be changed there. Changes to the show are made on the main station and copied over automatically.

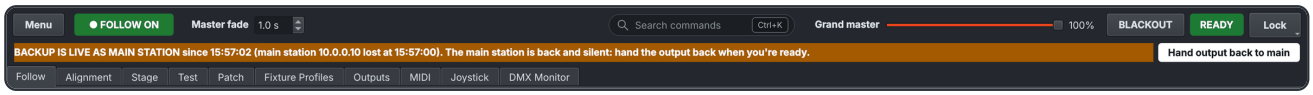
sACN or Art-Net

	SACN (RECOMMENDED)	ART-NET / USB DMX
Standing by	The backup sends all the time, at a **lower priority** than the main station (main − 10). Receivers use the highest priority they hear, so they ignore it.	The backup stays silent.
Main station dies	Receivers switch to the backup by themselves, at once. The backup also goes live after the delay.	The backup starts sending after the delay (2 s by default).

Take over by itself... after sets the delay. Untick it to only ever take over by hand (**Take over now**, in the window or the bar).

> **USB DMX**
> can't be shared between two PCs. For a backup, use network nodes, preferably on sACN.

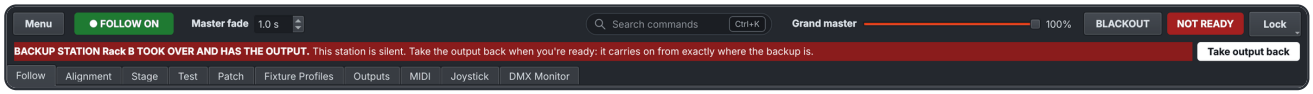
When the backup is live



On the backup: it has the output. It is a full main station now, with all controls back.

- It carries on from exactly the state the main station was in: positions, levels, colours, FOLLOW.
- Operator stations and phones that were linked to the main station move to the backup within a few seconds (the main station's PIN works there too).
- Its sACN priority goes **above** the main station's, so a main station that is restarted can't take the lights back by surprise.

Giving the output back



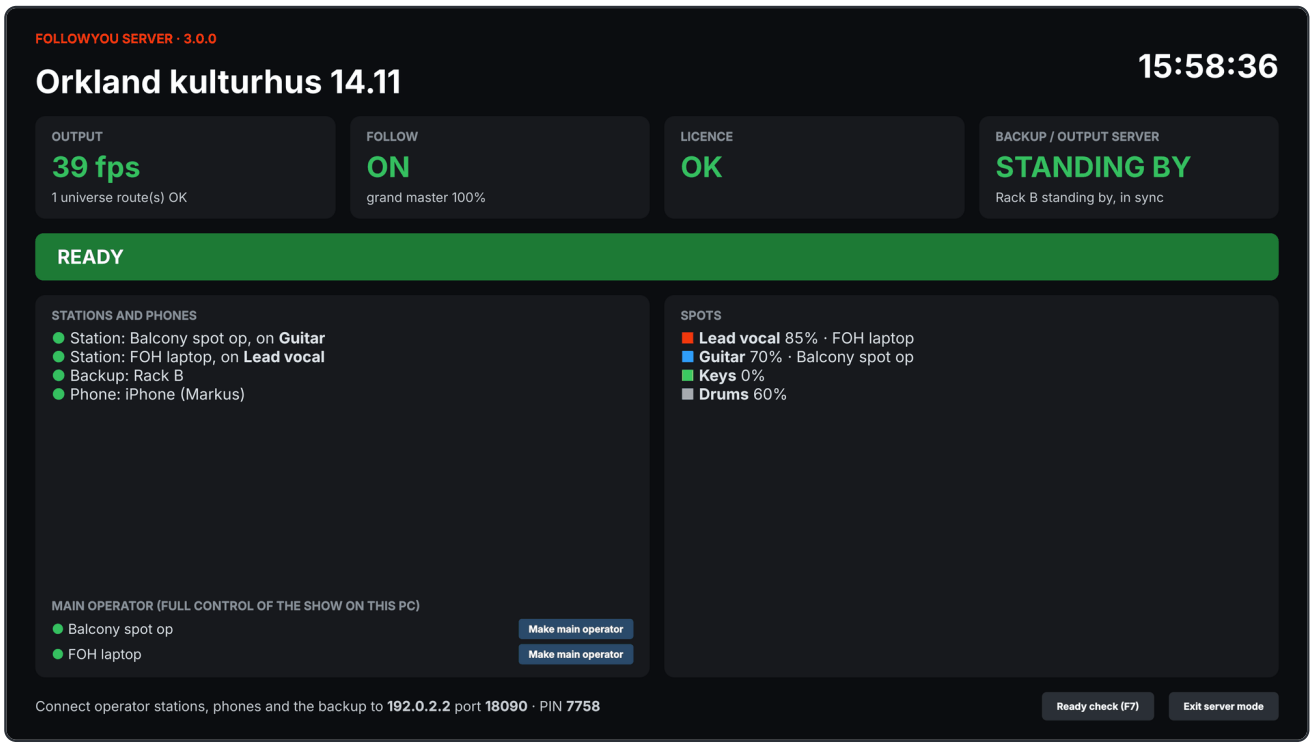
On the restarted main station: it stays silent while the backup has the output.

When the main station is running again, either press **Take output back** on the main station or **Hand output back to main** on the backup. The main station first takes over the backup's live state, so nothing jumps. Then the backup goes back to standing by, and the operator stations move back to the main station.

LICENCE

The backup only links to a licensed main station and runs on its licence until FollowYou is closed. It doesn't need a USB key of its own. If the backup stops answering while it has the output, the main station takes the output back after 3 seconds: two stations sending is better than none.

Server mode



The server screen: output, FOLLOW, licence, backup, the Ready check, who is connected and who drives which spot, and the address and PIN to connect to.

Menu → Server mode (rack PC) turns the main station into a screen made for a rack PC's monitor: big, readable from a distance, and nothing to click by accident. FollowYou carries on running and sending as normal behind it.

- **Show the server screen now**. **Exit server mode** (bottom right) goes back to the normal window. Esc does nothing on purpose.
- **Start FollowYou in server mode**: FollowYou opens the last show, turns on Remote access and shows the server screen. `FollowYou.exe --server` does the same.
- **Start FollowYou when Windows starts**. On a rack PC, also set Windows to log in by itself and never sleep.
- F7 opens the full Ready check.

A TYPICAL RACK

Two small PCs (main + backup), a network switch and the sACN nodes in one rack. Operators bring laptops with FollowYou as operator stations, or just phones. Nothing on the operator side can stop the show: if a laptop crashes, its spots hold where they are.

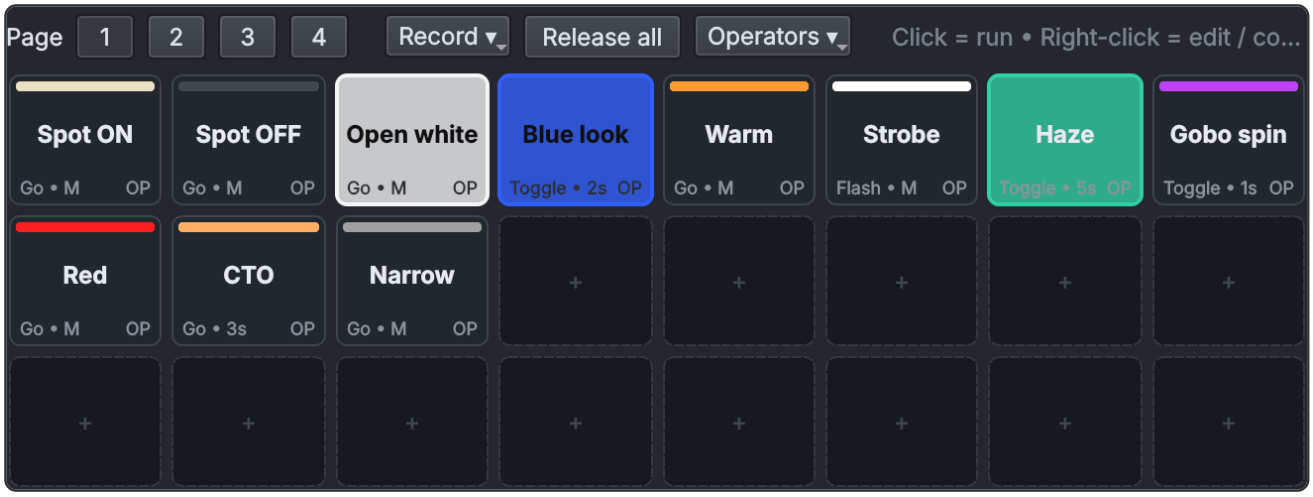
18

Console looks, themes and the presentation screen

Make FollowYou look like part of the desk next to it, and give a client or the audience a clean view of what the spots are doing.

Console looks

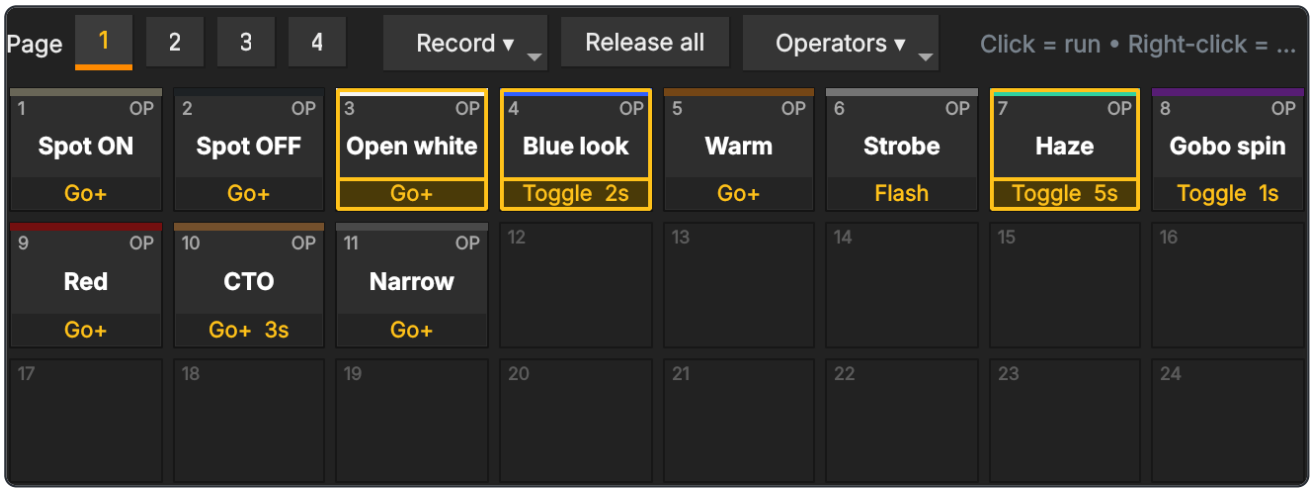
Menu → Customise → Console look dresses FollowYou like the lighting desk next to it. A console look changes the panels, buttons, tabs, the stage plan, the corners and the font, and each look draws its own **executor buttons and faders** the way that desk does.



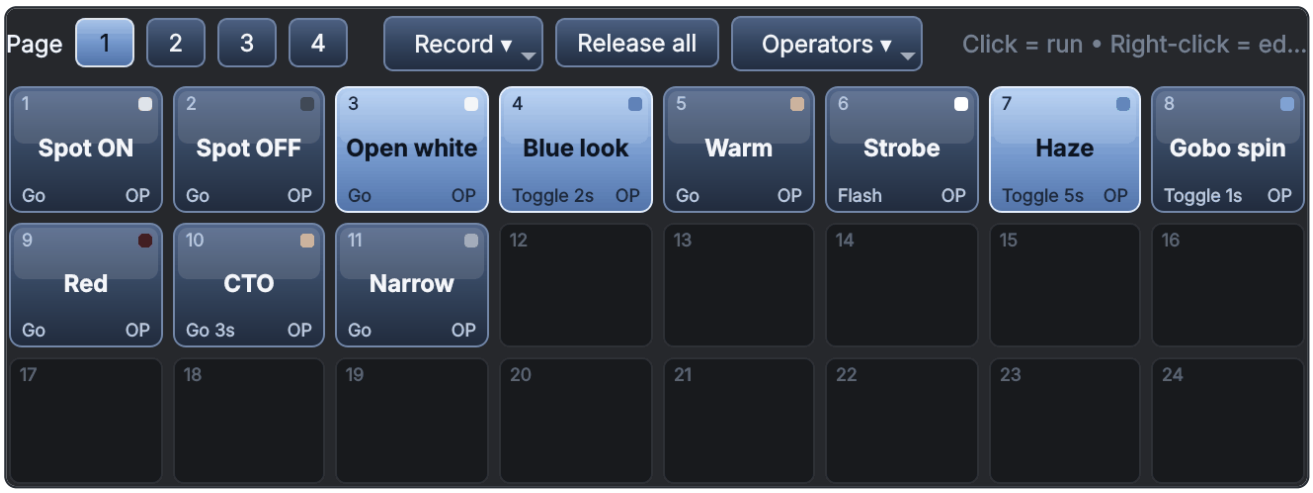
FollowYou (standard)



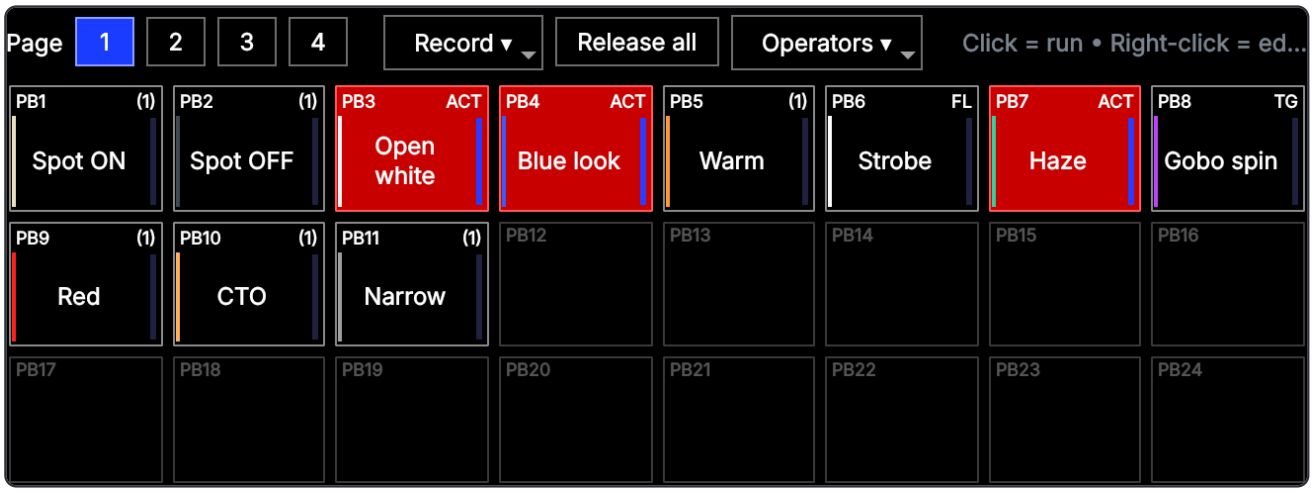
grandMA2 style: black tiles with a thin outline, number and type on top, the function in yellow under a small LED (green = on); empty = "Empty" with a red mark. Amber-outlined buttons, purple when on, deep-blue title bars.



grandMA3 style: flat dark tiles with a coloured band on top (bright when on), "Go+" / "Toggle" / "Flash" in yellow; on = yellow frame. Selected = yellow text with an orange underline.



Avolites Titan style: glossy navy touch buttons with rounded corners, light blue when on. Grey title bars.



ChamSys MagicQ style: square black playback boxes “PB1”, red with “ACT” when on, a level bar on the right. Blue for the current item, blue title bars.

The looks copy colours, shapes and layout only: no makers' logos, icons or artwork. Each console look brings its own accent colour (*Console look's colour* at the top of **Menu → Customise → Theme colour**); pick any other accent on top if you like.

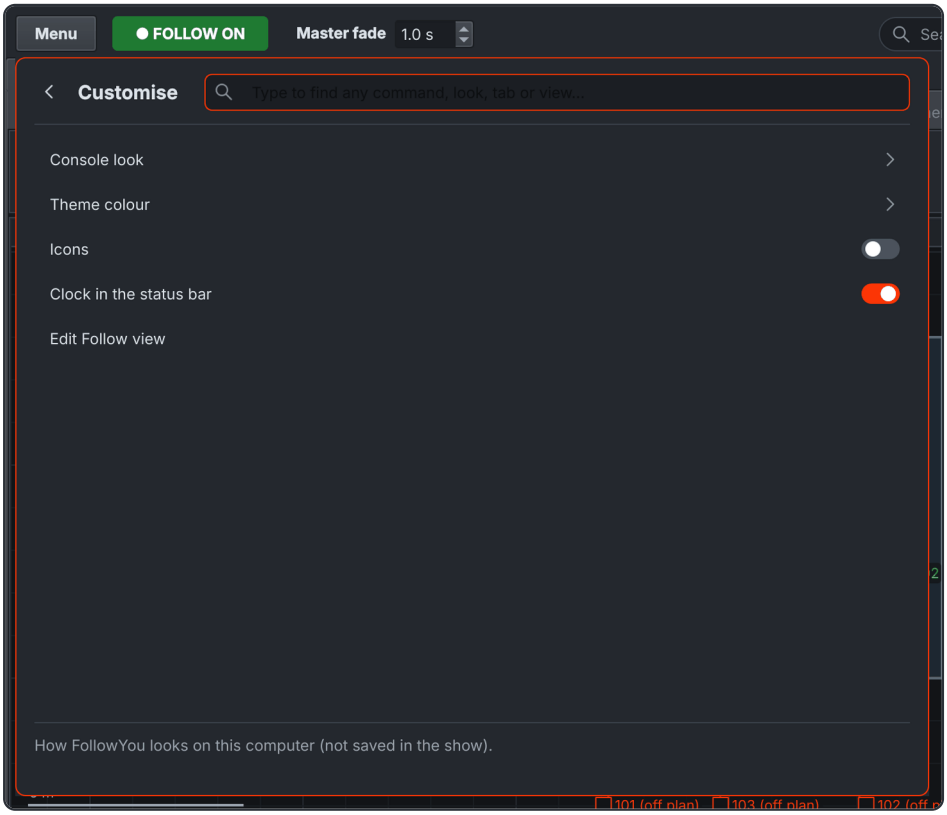


The whole window in grandMA2 style.

Theme (accent colour)

Menu → Customise → Theme colour changes the accent colour: selected rows, slider fills, the selected item on the plan, the joystick pad and the phone pages. Pick *Sceneproff red* (standard), *Amber* (the classic FollowYou look), orange, blue, teal, purple, pink, white, or **Custom colour...** for any colour. It's remembered per computer and changes straight away (phones on their next page load). Status colours never change: green, amber and red always mean the same.

Customise: icons and the clock

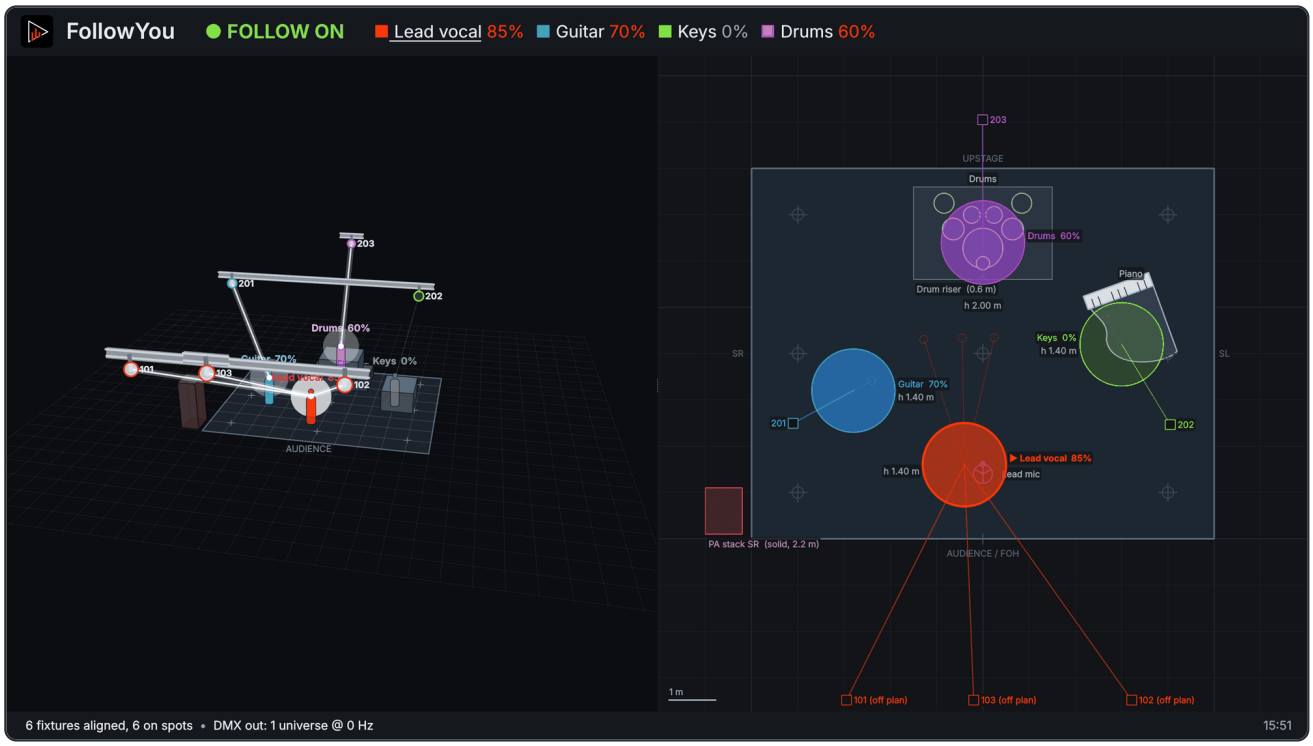


Menu → Customise holds everything about how FollowYou looks on this computer (none of it is saved in the show): Console look, Theme colour, **Icons**, **Clock in the status bar** and **Edit Follow view**.

Icons puts small line icons on the tabs, in the Menu and on the Follow panels. It's **off by default** for a clean, text-only look like a desk; buttons that are only an icon (+, ×) keep theirs.

Presentation screen

Menu → Presentation screen (F9) opens a clean full-screen view on the second screen or projector: a **3D view of the rig**, the stage plan and/or the camera picture with the spot ghosts. The header shows FOLLOW, every spot's level, its auto-track state and who is driving it; the status line shows fixtures aligned, DMX output, desk input, camera, connected phones and operator stations, and the time. Nothing on it changes the show, so it can face a client or an audience.



The presentation screen in 3D + plan view (6).

KEY	VIEW
1	Plan
2	Camera
3	Plan + camera
4	3D
5	3D + camera
6	3D + plan
F	Full screen on/off
O	Slow side-to-side sway of the 3D view on/off
Esc or F9	Close

Without a camera running, the camera is simply left out. With only one screen it opens as a normal window. The camera picture uses the same zoom as the Video panel.

The 3D view

- Every aligned fixture where the alignment worked out it hangs, on a truss. Fixtures at about the same height and depth share one truss bar automatically.
- Each beam as a line in the fixture's colour (from its CMY or RGB) to where it hits: the performer (a glow on them), or the floor or a riser (a pool the size of the beam). A fixture at 0 % shows a faint dotted line.
- The performers as figures in their spot's colour, with a trail of the last few seconds; risers and solid objects as blocks, and the marks.

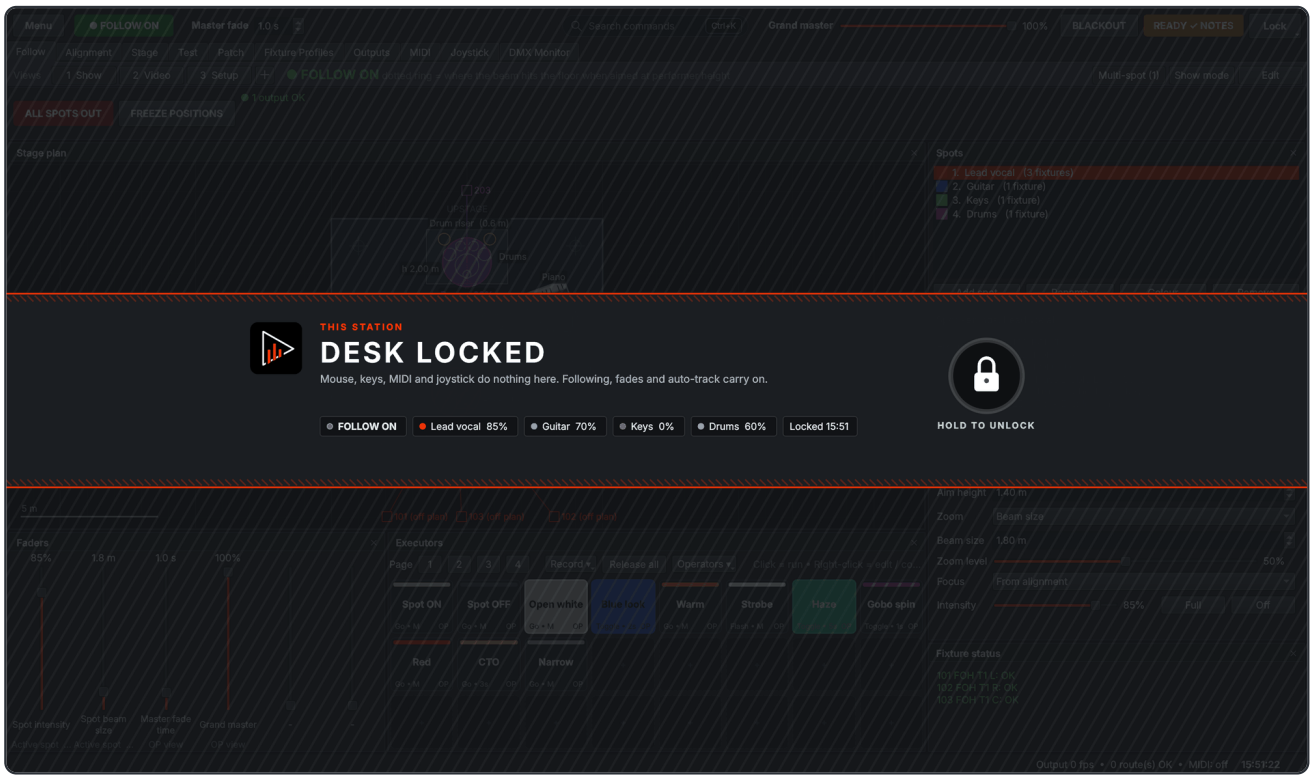
- Drag with the mouse to turn it, wheel to go closer, double-click for the front view again.

19

Lock and show files

Lock the desk during a break, and keep each venue's setup in its own show file.

Lock



The lock screen: a band across the window with the show status and the hold-to-unlock ring.

Lock (top bar, or Ctrl+L) stops anything changing by accident, e.g. during a break or with people around the desk.

- **Lock this station**: mouse clicks, keys, the wheel, MIDI and the joystick do nothing on this station. Following, fades and auto-track carry on. FollowYou can't be closed while it's locked.
- **Lock all** (main station): this station, every operator station and every phone are locked. Only the main station can unlock it.
- While locked, the band shows what the show is doing: FOLLOW, each spot's level and when it was locked.
- **Unlock**: without a lock password, hold the ring until it fills. With a password, type it and press Enter.

- **Lock ▾ → Lock password…** sets, changes or removes the password. It's saved on this station (as a hash, not the password itself), not in the show, so each station can have its own. Leave it empty to unlock by holding.
- A controller with lights (APC mini): the pads slowly fade red up and down while locked, and a green wave runs over them when it's unlocked.
- The lock screen follows the colours of your console look.

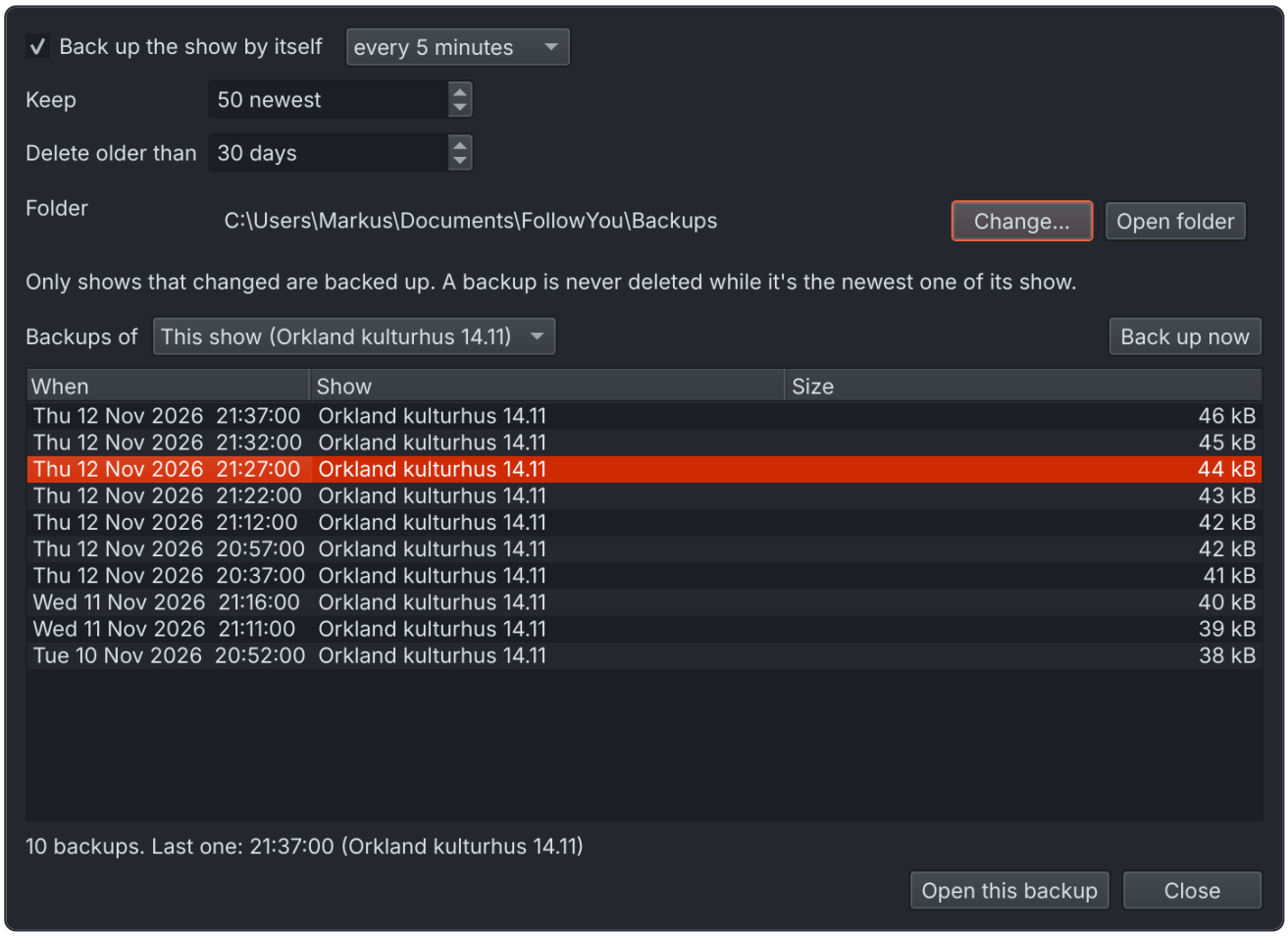
> **EMERGENCIES**
> ALL SPOTS OUT is locked too. Unlock first in an emergency, or use the desk.

Show files

Menu → Save show (Ctrl+S) writes a `.fyshow` file containing everything: patch, outputs, stage, alignment, washes, solid objects, spots, executors, faders, banks, MIDI map, camera calibration and a copy of every profile used.

- Show files have their own icon: the FollowYou logo with blue bars. **Double-click a show file** to open it. If FollowYou is already running, that window opens it (it asks to save first), so there is never a second FollowYou sending DMX.
- The alignment is stored in the show, so the next night at the same venue you just open it. A different venue, or a rig that has been moved, needs a fresh alignment.
- `.nfshow` files from the Pre-Dev versions open fine. Saving one writes a new `.fyshow` next to it and leaves the old file untouched.
- Moving a show to another PC: see Profiles and show files.

Automatic backups



Menu → Show → Backups... : the settings on top, the backups of this show below.

FollowYou backs up the show by itself while you work, so a crash, a power cut or a wrong change never costs more than a few minutes. Every **5 minutes** (settable from 1 to 30), if the show changed since the last backup, a copy goes to

```
Documents\FollowYou\Backups\<show name>\<show name> 2026-11-12 21-14-05.fyshow
```

- It is written in the background, so even a slow USB stick never makes the light stutter. Nothing is backed up while the show doesn't change.
- Old backups are cleared out by themselves: the **50 newest** per show are kept, and backups older than **30 days** are deleted. Change both in the Backups window (0 = keep all). The newest backup of a show is never deleted.
- **Open this backup** (or double-click it) opens it as the show. **Save show** then saves over the show file it belongs to, so a backup is a quick way back to how it was at 20:15. A show that was never saved asks where to save.
- **Back up now** makes one right away, for instance before a big change. **Change...** picks another folder (a second disk or a synced cloud folder), **Open folder** shows them in Explorer.
- Operator stations don't back up: the show is backed up on the main station (or the server). DEMO mode can't save shows, so it doesn't back up either.

What is saved where

IN THE SHOW FILE	ON THIS COMPUTER
Patch, outputs, desk input, stage, marks, risers, icons, stage layouts, alignment, washes, solid objects, spots, executors, faders, operator banks, MIDI and joystick-button map, master fade time, smoothing, camera calibration and framing, a copy of the profiles	Panel layout of the Follow page, console look and theme, joystick calibration and axis mapping, lock password, remote-access port and PIN, update settings, second screen, Tracking menu settings, backup settings and the backups, the profile library, the licence

ONE SHOW PER VENUE

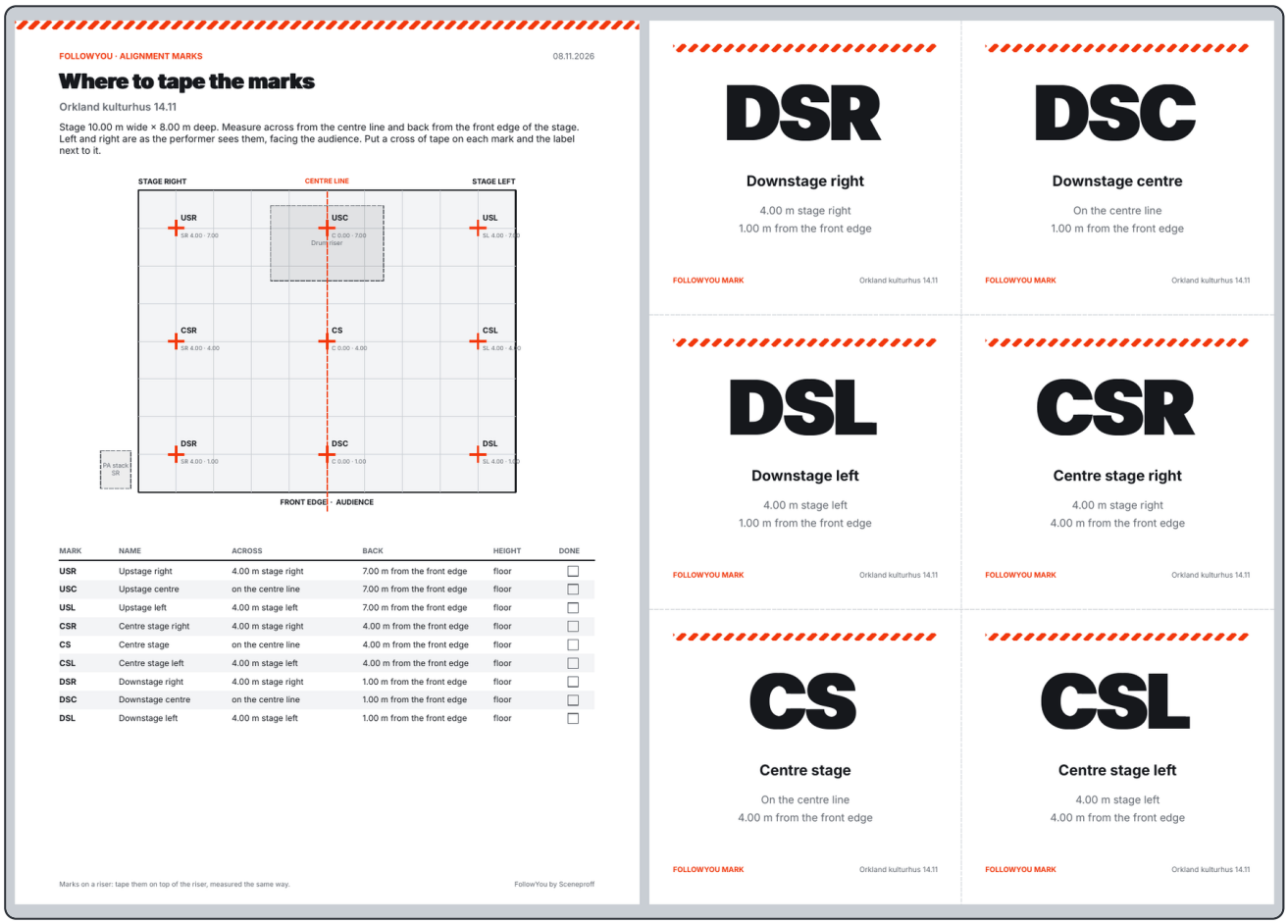
Use *Save show as…* to keep one show file per venue (“Olavshallen 2026.fyshow”). Keep a copy on a USB stick or in the cloud: a show file is all you need to rebuild the setup on another PC.

20

Show-day tools

Print the marks for the crew, train the operators with a virtual performer, and check everything with one button before doors.

Print the marks



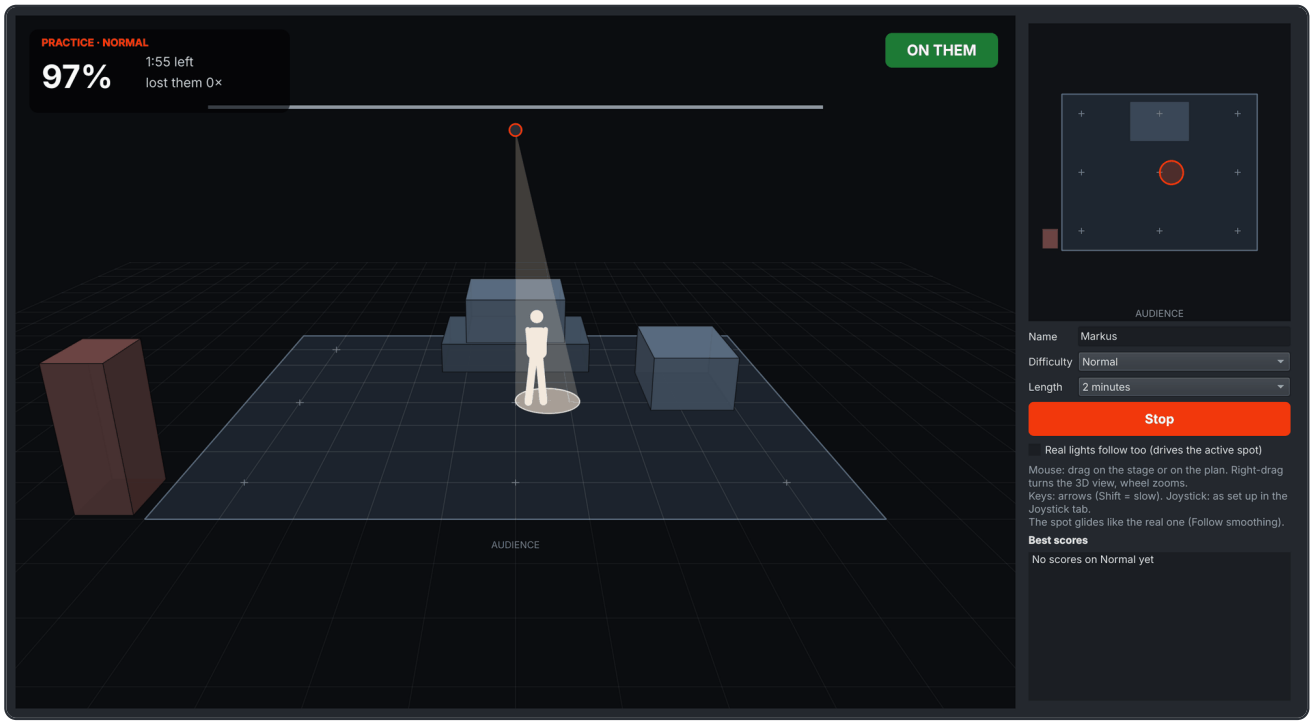
Page 1: where to tape every mark. Then six labels per page to cut out and put next to the tape.

Print marks… in the Stage tab (or **Menu → Print marks sheet**) saves an A4 PDF and opens it:

- **Page 1**: the stage with every mark, and a table to tick off. Each mark is measured the way a crew measures: **across from the centre line** (stage left/right as the performer sees it) and **back from the front edge**.
- **Label pages**: one big label per mark (DSL, Downstage left, with its measurements), so nobody mixes up DSL and DSR on a dark stage.

Hand the sheet to the crew while you patch, and the stage is taped by the time you start aligning.

Practice mode

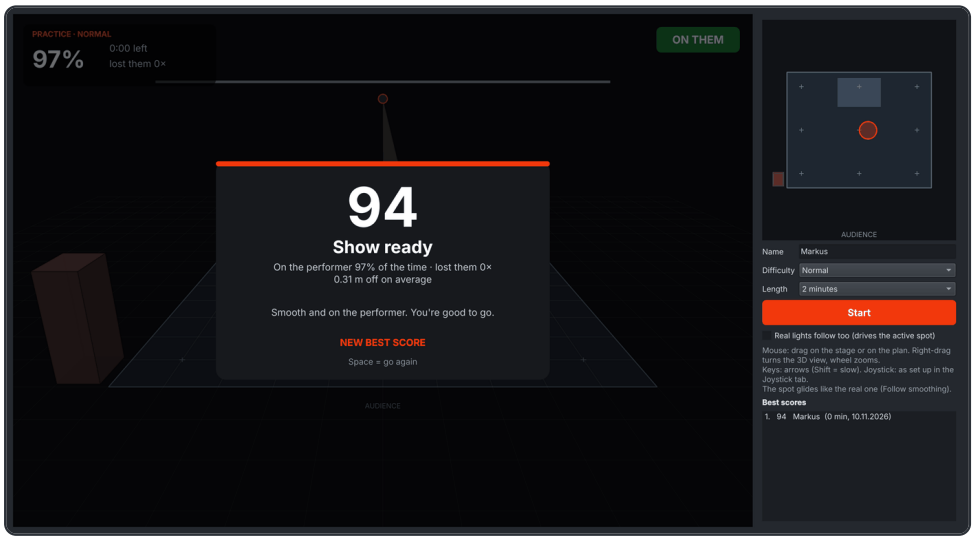


Practice mode (F8): the performer walks the real stage; you keep the spot on them.

Menu → Practice mode (F8) puts a virtual performer on your stage, with its real size, risers and solid objects. They walk somewhere, stop, turn and sometimes hurry, like a real performer. You follow them with what you'll use in the show:

- **Mouse**: drag on the 3D stage, or on the small plan (like the Follow tab: you watch the stage and steer on the plan). Right-drag turns the 3D view, the wheel zooms.
- **Joystick**: as set up in the Joystick tab.
- **Arrow keys** (Shift = slow).

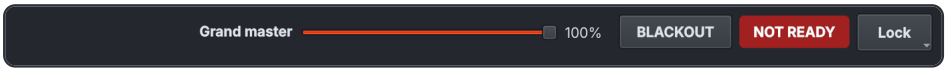
Pick a **Difficulty** (Easy, Normal, Hard: faster walking, shorter pauses, sudden runs, a smaller beam) and a **Length**, then press **Start** or Space. The spot glides with the same smoothing as the real spots.



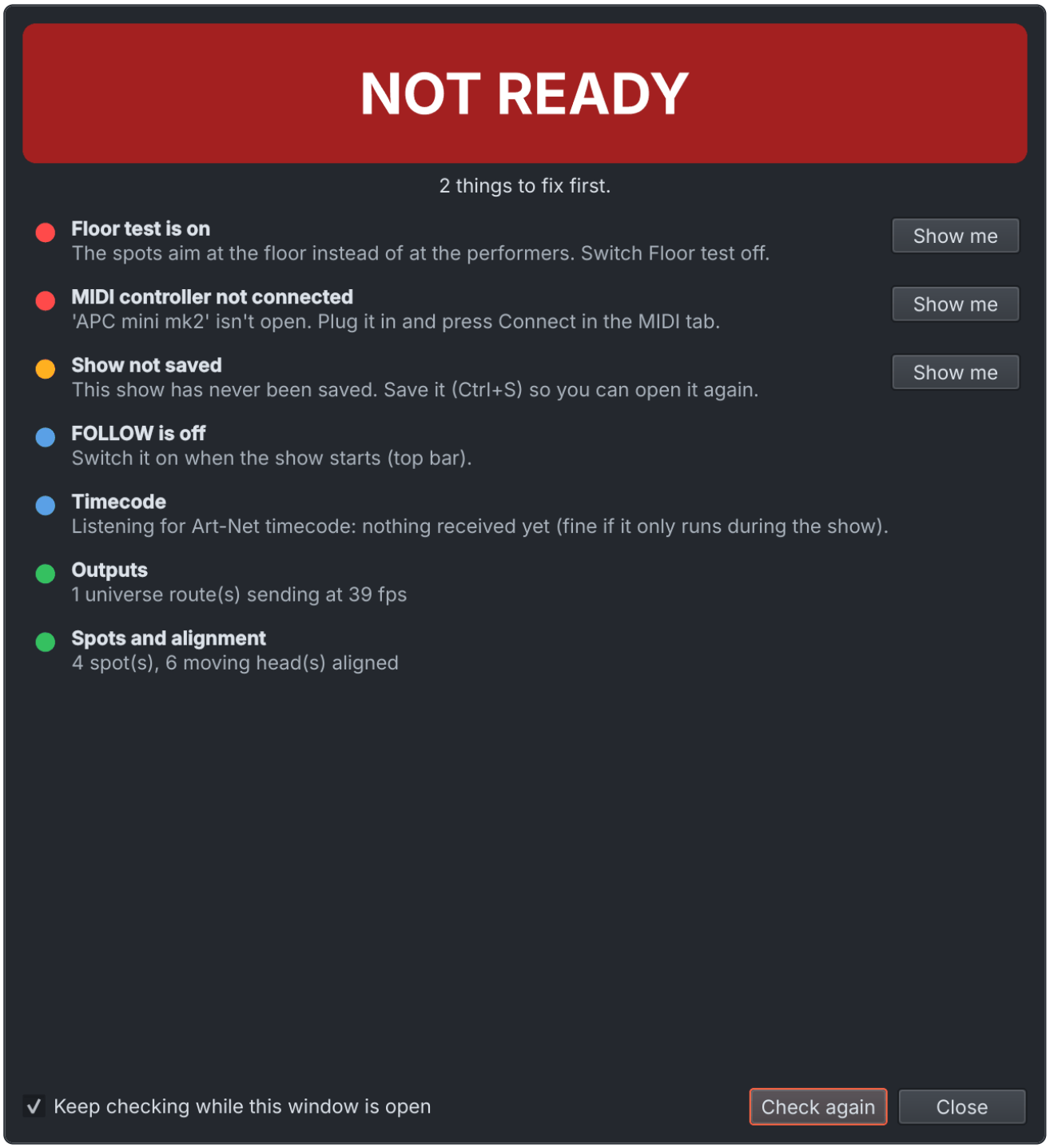
The score: mostly time on the performer, a little for staying close and never losing them. Best scores are kept per difficulty.

- **No lights needed**: the show's spots and the DMX output are left alone. It works on a laptop on its own and in DEMO mode, so it's also a good demo on a stand.
- **Real lights follow too** makes the active spot copy your practice spot, for a live demo with real fixtures.

Ready for show



The **READY** button on the top bar checks everything that matters once a second and turns **green** (ready), **amber** (ready, with notes) or **red** (not ready). Hover over it to see the first problem; click it (or press F7) for the full list.



Every check, problems first. **Show me** opens the right tab.

CHECKS	RED (NOT READY) WHEN…
Licence	DEMO mode. A pulled-out USB key is amber: licensed until FollowYou closes.
Outputs	A route has an error, the output isn't running, or this station is silent because a backup has the output.
Patch, spots, alignment	Nothing patched, no spots, or a moving head on a spot isn't aligned. Over 0.5° is amber.

CHECKS	RED (NOT READY) WHEN…
Floor test, Freeze, Blackout	Floor test is on. Freeze, blackout and a low grand master are amber.
Joystick, MIDI controller	One that was set up isn't connected.
Stations, backup	A backup station has the output. A lost station or backup, or Remote access off, is amber.
Timecode, show file	Amber: recordings wait for timecode but no input is chosen; unsaved changes.

FOLLOW being off is only a note: switch it on when the show starts. On an operator station the check covers its own link, spot and controllers.

21

Recommended hardware

FollowYou runs with a mouse alone, but the right hardware makes following easier and faster. Sceneproff recommends, and FollowYou has ready-made setups for:

WHAT	RECOMMENDED	ALSO READY-MADE
MIDI controller	**Akai APC mini mk2**: RGB pads, 9 faders	Akai APC mini (mk1), Novation Launchpad Mini MK3 / Launchpad X, Korg nanoKONTROL2
Joystick	**Thrustmaster T.16000M FCS**: precise, twist for beam size, throttle for intensity	Logitech Extreme 3D Pro, Thrustmaster T.Flight HOTAS, Xbox controller, PlayStation controller
DMX	An Art-Net / sACN node, or an ENTTEC DMX USB Pro	ENTTEC Open DMX / FTDI cables
Camera (auto-track)	Elgato Facecam	Other webcams, HDMI cameras through a USB capture card, GoPro HERO9+ over USB, virtual cameras, network streams

The show PC

- Windows 10 or 11, 64-bit. Any recent laptop runs the follow itself easily.
- For **auto-track**, a reasonably recent CPU: the body model takes about 20–40 ms per picture on a normal computer.
- A wired network port (or a USB network adapter) for the DMX node. Keep the lighting network off the venue's Wi-Fi where you can.
- Turn off sleep, screen savers and Windows Update restarts for show days.

Custom console case

Sceneproff builds custom FollowYou consoles: a road case with the controller, joystick and a mount for the laptop or screen, cut to fit. Contact Sceneproff for a quote.

22

Troubleshooting

The usual problems, and what fixes them.

PROBLEM	WHAT TO CHECK
Nothing comes out of the fixtures	Is **FOLLOW ON**, the spot above 0 and BLACKOUT off? Is the Grand master up? Does the Safety panel show the output OK? Check the **DMX Monitor**, then the patch addresses against the fixtures' menus.
Red bar under the top bar	An output has a problem: USB interface unplugged, network cable out, wrong network card in **Send from network card**.
USB interface: “device is in use”	Close QLC+ or other lighting software. Pick the **FTDI direct** entry for Enttec interfaces. Check you picked Pro vs Open DMX correctly.
Light lands behind the performer on an empty stage	That's correct: the spot aims at chest height. Tick **Floor test** to check the alignment on the floor.
The follow is off in one area of the stage	Check the fixture's Result: re-store the mark with the biggest error, or store more marks there. Check the tape is where the Stage tab says.
Result says **Suspicious**	One mark was stored aimed at the wrong spot. Re-store or clear the mark with the biggest error.
A spot won't go off, or keeps jumping back	Look at the line under **Intensity** in Spot settings: it names what last changed it (a joystick axis, a MIDI fader, an executor, a phone).
The spot creeps by itself with a joystick	Let go and press **Re-centre now**, raise the **Deadzone**, or map *Joystick: re-centre* to a button.
Beam size does nothing	The profile has no zoom angles. Add them, or use **Measure zoom angles…**. If the size is out of the fixture's reach, the status says so.
A phone or operator station can't connect	Same network? Right PIN and port? Press **Open firewall for FollowYou** on the main station. On a venue network that blocks devices from seeing each other, use the Windows Mobile hotspot.
MIDI controller doesn't respond	Close other software using it, press **Refresh**, then **Connect**. Check **Incoming MIDI**. In DEMO mode MIDI is ignored.
Controller lights don't work	Check **Send lights to** and **Controller**; press **Test lights**. nanoKONTROL2: set LED Mode to External.

PROBLEM	WHAT TO CHECK
Auto-track holds or searches a lot	Raise the camera, zoom in on the stage, calibrate again. Haze, strobes, look-alike costumes and small performers in the picture make it hold. Double-click the performer to help it.
Lights dip every few minutes, or go dark after 30 minutes	FollowYou is in DEMO mode. Plug in the USB key (before starting) or load the licence file.
A show opens with different fixture behaviour	The show was saved with other profile versions. Choose **Use the show's versions** when asked.
Something else	Look in `logs\FollowYou.log` and send it to Sceneproff support.

APPENDIX A

Show-day checklist

Print this page and tick it off at every venue.

Before you leave

- [ ] USB licence key with the show PC
- [ ] Show file for this venue (or last time's), plus a copy on a stick
- [ ] FollowYou updated on a prep day, not today
- [ ] Controller, joystick, cables, DMX node or USB interface
- [ ] Camera, mount and active USB extension (for auto-track)
- [ ] Tape (two colours), tape measure, the mark sheet (Stage tab → Print marks…)

Setup

- [ ] USB key in **before** starting FollowYou
- [ ] Outputs green in the Safety panel
- [ ] Stage size entered, marks generated and taped
- [ ] Every follow fixture aligned, Result under 0.5°
- [ ] Follow-wash areas drawn where the light lands, tested
- [ ] Solid objects tested (green/red lines)
- [ ] Floor test: beams land on the dots everywhere
- [ ] Floor test **off** again
- [ ] Spots named, fixtures ticked, colours set
- [ ] Camera calibrated (if used), under 3 px

Line check

- [ ] MIDI controller connected, Test lights OK
- [ ] Joystick connected and calibrated, no creep
- [ ] Phones / operator stations connected, PIN known
- [ ] Executors and faders do what you expect
- [ ] ALL SPOTS OUT and FREEZE tested
- [ ] Show saved (Ctrl+S)
- [ ] Backup station standing by (if you use one)
- [ ] **READY** is green (F7)

Show

- [ ] Sleep and screen saver off on the show PC
- [ ] Show mode (F10) or your show view
- [ ] Lock (Ctrl+L) during breaks
- [ ] Hand near the mouse when auto-tracking
- [ ] Save the show at the end of the night

APPENDIX B

Keys and mouse

Anywhere

F1	User manual, at the chapter for this tab
Ctrl + K	The Menu, ready to search for any command
Ctrl + N	New show
Ctrl + O	Open show
Ctrl + S	Save show
Ctrl + Shift + S	Save show as
Ctrl + L	Lock this station
F7	Ready for show check
F8	Practice mode
F9	Presentation screen
F10	Show mode
F11	Full screen
F12	Second screen on/off
Alt + 1 – 9	Follow page views

Follow tab (stage plan)

Click / drag	Move the active spot
Shift -drag	Move finely
Arrows	Nudge
Wheel	Beam size (zoom level in Manual)
Ctrl +wheel	Aim height
1 – 9	Pick a spot
Ctrl + 1 – 9	Add / remove a spot (multi-spot)
Space	Active spot on/off (master fade)
M	Multi-spot on/off
Right-click	Pick the nearest spot
Ctrl +right-click	Add / remove a spot (multi-spot)
Double-click an icon	Send the active spot there

Alignment

Drag the pad	Aim the fixture
Shift -drag	10× finer
Arrows	Nudge
Enter	Store at this mark
G	Alignment gobo on/off

Video panel

Drag on a performer	Move the active spot there
Ctrl-drag	Left/right only (lock depth)
Double-click a performer	Go there and auto-track
T	Auto-track on/off for the active spot
Esc	Stop all auto-tracking
Right-click a ghost	Make it the active spot
1–9	Pick a spot
Space	Active spot on/off
Wheel, + / –	Zoom the picture
Alt+drag, middle-drag	Move the picture
Home or 0	Fit the whole picture
◀ ▶	Skip a mark while calibrating

Presentation screen

1–6	Plan, camera, plan+camera, 3D, 3D+camera, 3D+plan
F	Full screen on/off
O	3D sway on/off
Drag / wheel / double-click	Turn / zoom / front view (3D)
Esc, F9	Close

Phone

Two fingers	Finer (10× aligning, 4× following)
Hold an arrow	Repeat the nudge

APPENDIX C

Files and folders

FILE	WHAT IT IS
`.fyshow`	A show file (blue bars icon). Double-click to open.
`.nfshow`	A show file from the Pre-Dev versions. Opens fine; saving writes a new `.fyshow`.
`.fylicence`	A licence file (green key icon). Double-click to install.
`.json` in `profiles\`	Fixture profiles.

The installed FollowYou folder:

```
FollowYou.exe      the program
manual\            this manual (Menu → User manual, F1)
profiles\          your fixture profile library (kept on updates)
profiles\backup\   old profile versions replaced by a show's versions
assets\            icons
models\            body-pose model for auto-track (MoveNet, Apache 2.0)
ui\remote\         the phone pages
setup\firewall.ps1 used by Menu → Windows Firewall
logs\              FollowYou.log (errors)
```

APPENDIX D

Glossary

Active spot
The spot you are driving right now. Executors set to *Active spot* act on it. On an operator station, the operator's own spot.

Aim height
How high above the floor a spot aims: 1.4 m is about chest height.

Alignment
Aiming each fixture at taped marks so FollowYou can work out where it hangs. Done once per venue, saved in the show.

Auto-track
The camera follows a performer and moves their spot. It never changes intensity.

Backup (show)
A copy of the show that FollowYou saves by itself every few minutes while it changes. **Menu → Show → Backups…**

Bank
A set of executors and faders for operator stations.

Backup station
A second PC that mirrors the main station live and takes over the DMX output if the main station dies.

Beam size
The beam's width in metres at the performer, kept the same anywhere on stage. Needs the profile's zoom angles.

Executor
A button that sets parameters: Go, Toggle or Flash. 4 pages of 24.

FOLLOW
The main switch: while on, fixtures on a spot are driven by FollowYou.

Follow wash
A static fixture (PAR, fresnel, LED wash) tied to an area of the stage. It fades up when a spot walks into that area, by how central the spot is and the spot's intensity.

Ghost
A spot drawn on the camera picture: a ring on the floor, a person-height line and a dot at aim height.

Look ahead
Auto-track aims a little ahead of a moving performer to make up for the camera delay. In the Tracking menu of the Video panel.

Main station
The PC that does the DMX output and keeps the show. Phones and operator stations connect to it.

Mark
A taped cross on the stage floor at a known position, used for alignment and camera calibration.

Multi-spot
Several spots driven together, led by the active spot.

Operator station
Another PC running FollowYou, connected to the main station. It drives spots but sends no DMX.

Main operator
The operator station the server gives full control: it can change and save the whole show on the server.

Panel
One part of the Follow page (stage plan, spots, executors…), placed on the grid of a view.

Practice mode
A virtual performer to follow, with a score. No lights needed.

Profile
A description of a fixture type: channels, ranges, pan/tilt range, zoom angles.

Recording
Spot moves recorded in rehearsal, played back by hand, from the desk (MIDI or a DMX channel) or locked to timecode.

Riser
Something performers stand on. A spot on it aims higher by the riser's height.

Screen 2
A second Follow page on another monitor, with a view of its own (F12). The same panel can be on both screens.

Server mode
The main station's screen for a rack PC: big status, nothing to click by accident.

Shared camera
A camera on the server or a station that other stations use to follow and auto-track their own spots.

Solid object
Something that blocks light. A fixture whose view is blocked dims out.

Spot
One performer, with the fixtures that follow them.

View
One arrangement of panels on the Follow page grid (Show, Video, Setup, your own). Alt + 1 – 9.

Virtual camera
A camera made by software (OBS Virtual Camera, GoPro Webcam, NDI Webcam). FollowYou lists it by name and uses it like a webcam.

Timecode
A running clock (MTC or Art-Net) from the desk or show control. Recordings can follow it.

Stage layout
A stored set of risers, solid objects and icons, for scenery changes.

APPENDIX E

Version history

3.1	**Second screen** (F12) with a view of its own, and the same panels on both screens. Auto-track **looks ahead** to make up for the camera delay, shows **how sure it is**, and warns (or holds) when it's **not sure it's them**. **Automatic show backups** every few minutes. **Virtual cameras** (OBS Virtual Camera and others) by name.
3.0	A new look: the **Menu** with Ctrl+K search replaces the menu bar; the Follow page is a grid of **views** you arrange yourself; **Customise** (icons off by default). **FollowYou on the network**: stations find each other, no more IP addresses. **Shared cameras**: several operators follow and auto-track on one camera. Plan labels no longer overlap, unlocking no longer lags, recent shows, Legend 300E Spot zoom and alignment gobo fixed. The output server is gone (the server with a main operator does that job).
2.9.3	The main operator moves the real lights from Alignment, Test, the Wash tab and phone alignment, and can lock all stations.
2.9.2	**Main operator**: the server keeps the show, licence and output, and gives one operator station full control of the show.
2.9.1	**Output server**: a rack PC does all the DMX output for the main station you work on (e.g. the laptop at FOH), and takes over if it dies. (Removed in 3.0.)
2.9	Show-day tools: **Ready for show** check (top bar, F7), **Print marks** (A4 mark sheet and labels), **Practice mode** (F8), **Record and play back** spots (MIDI, desk DMX channel, MTC or Art-Net timecode), **Backup station** with automatic takeover, and **Server mode** for a rack PC.
2.8	The user manual is built in: F1 or Help → User manual opens it at the chapter for the tab you are on, offline. Help → User manual online opens the newest version.
2.7.1	New lock screen: a locked band across the screen with the show status (FOLLOW, spot levels, when it was locked) and a hold-to-unlock ring.
2.7	Licence files (`.fylicence`) have their own icon and install with a double-click.
2.6	Console looks draw executor buttons, faders, buttons, tabs and title bars like each desk.
2.5	Console looks: grandMA2, grandMA3, Avolites Titan and ChamSys MagicQ style.
2.4.1	A clock in the status bar.
2.4	One compiled program (no Python needed), 19 fixture profiles, ready-made layouts for more MIDI controllers and joysticks.
2.3	A real DEMO mode. 2.3.1: updates signed with their own key.
2.2	Updates, with the blue bar (never during a show).
2.1	Licences: USB key or licence file. 2.1.1: licence types.

2.0	Multi-spot, faders on operator stations, stage icons and layouts, desk lock, show files with their own icon. 2.0.1: lock password, operator stations. 2.0.2: calmer controller lights.
1.8	Executors on operator stations, with banks.
1.7	Lighting desk input, presentation screen with 3D view, auto-track that searches and locks on again.
1.6	Auto-track with body points and clothes colour. 1.6.1–1.6.3: alignment gobo, Manual zoom level, profile versions in show files, Ayrton Diablo-S.
1.5	Lamp control, zoom warnings and Measure zoom angles.
1.4	Sceneproff logo and name, colour themes, spot colours.



FollowYou

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